The Complete Catechism Kit

Confirmation

233 Activities to Get Ready for Confirmation and the Gift of the Holy Spirit



The 7 Gifts of the Holy Spirit | The Ten Commandments | The Saints | The Creed | The Sacraments

Confirmation · Ages 10-12

A Note for Grown-Ups

How to Use This Book

This book walks with young people ages 10 to 12 on the road to Confirmation. It contains 233 ready-to-print activities in 11 parts: preparing for Confirmation, the Holy Spirit and Pentecost, the Creed, the sacraments, the Ten Commandments, the Beatitudes, the virtues, the works of mercy, the saints, the Church and its history, and finally a spiritual journal.

The activities speak directly to the young person ("you"). They alternate pages for learning (fact pages and pages on the gifts of the Holy Spirit, the commandments, the virtues, and the saints), games for remembering (crosswords, word searches, quizzes, true or false, fill-in-the-blank activities, matching), case studies and discussion questions for thinking things through, and writing pages for praying and looking back on life.

- **Printing:** Every page works in black and white on Letter paper (8.5 × 11 in). The saints' portraits and the illustrations can be colored.
- **Pick and choose:** You don't have to follow the order of the book. Each page stands on its own: pick the ones that fit your religious education class or your week.
- **The Answer Key:** It is at the end of the book, in the order of the activities. You can remove those pages before handing the book to the young person.
- **Discussion questions:** The discussion questions have no single "right answer." They invite young people to make their case, listen to others, and come back to the teaching of the Church.
- **The Bible:** Scripture quotations are taken from the New American Bible, revised edition (NABRE), the translation read at Mass in the United States. Keep a Bible within reach: many activities invite the young person to read the whole passage.

> **A Sample Session (About 1 Hour)**
> Prayer time (5 min) · one page to discover (15 min) · a game or activity to remember (15 min) · a case study or discussion (15 min) · a spiritual journal page and a closing prayer (10 min).

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Walking With a Young Person Toward Confirmation

Confirmation is, with Baptism and the Eucharist, one of the three sacraments of Christian initiation. It completes the grace of Baptism: the confirmed person receives the gift of the Holy Spirit in order to live as a witness to Christ, like the Apostles on the day of Pentecost (see CCC 1285).

In the United States, the age for Confirmation varies by diocese, often between 7th grade and high school. Between ages 10 and 12, young people ask real questions: "What is it for?" "Do I really believe?" "What will it change?" These questions are not an obstacle: they are the starting point of a more personal faith. This book gives them solid reference points and room to express themselves.

- **Listen:** Let the young person put doubts and desires into words. The reflection pages and the spiritual journal are designed for that; they are not meant to be graded.
- **Hand on the faith:** The pages sum up the teaching of the Church, in keeping with the Catechism. Feel free to share your own witness.
- **Connect it to life:** The case studies start from real situations (school, friends, screens, family). They help the young person link faith with everyday choices.
- **Involve the sponsor:** Several pages can be done together (the letter to the sponsor, the research on a patron saint, the chain of faith).
- **Pray together:** Confirmation is first of all a gift from God. End every meeting with a time of prayer, even a very short one.

> **After Confirmation**
> The journey doesn't end on the day of the celebration. The last pages of the spiritual journal help the young person make concrete resolutions: Sunday Mass, prayer, service in the parish and to those most in need.

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Answer Key 238

Why Am I Asking for Confirmation?

Take time to think about your request. Answer honestly: there are no wrong answers.

Name: _____



Confirmation is not a graduation ceremony at the end of religious education. It is a sacrament: a gift God gives you. Through it, the Holy Spirit comes to strengthen in you the life you received at Baptism, so that you become a true witness to Christ.

Who first talked to me about Confirmation?

What I already know about Confirmation:

What I would like to receive from the Holy Spirit:

What I wonder about or worry about a little:

I complete the sentence: "I am asking for Confirmation because..."

What Is Confirmation?

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

Confirmation is one of the seven sacraments. With Baptism and the Eucharist, it is one of the sacraments of Christian initiation: the ones that bring us fully into the Christian life.

1. **Confirmation is…**
   ☐ a sacrament ☐ an end-of-year party ☐ a religion test
2. **How many sacraments of Christian initiation are there?**
   ☐ two ☐ three ☐ seven
3. **Which ones?**
   ☐ Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist ☐ Baptism, Matrimony, Holy Orders
   ☐ Reconciliation, Confirmation, Anointing of the Sick
4. **Who usually celebrates Confirmation?**
   ☐ the catechist ☐ the bishop ☐ the sponsor
5. **What is the forehead of the person being confirmed marked with?**
   ☐ holy water ☐ sacred chrism ☐ incense
6. **How many times can you receive Confirmation?**
   ☐ only once ☐ every year ☐ as many times as you want
7. **Confirmation completes the grace of…**
   ☐ Matrimony ☐ Baptism ☐ Lent
8. **On the day of Pentecost, the Apostles received…**
   ☐ the Ten Commandments ☐ the Holy Spirit ☐ the keys of the Kingdom

The Rite of Confirmation

Here are the main moments of Confirmation, in order. Fill in the missing titles with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The laying on of hands · The Prayer of the Faithful · The anointing with chrism · The presentation of the candidates · The renewal of baptismal promises

The Liturgy of the Word
We listen to the readings from the Bible and to the bishop's homily.

↓

_____
Each one is called by name and answers: "Here I am!"

↓

_____
You reject evil and profess your faith in God the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

↓

_____
The bishop stretches out his hands over the candidates and prays that the Holy Spirit will come upon them.

↓

_____
The bishop traces a cross on your forehead and says: "Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit." You answer: "Amen."

↓

The sign of peace
The bishop offers you peace: a sign of your communion with him and with the whole Church (see CCC 1301).

↓

_____
The whole assembly prays for the newly confirmed, for the Church, and for the world.

↓

The Liturgy of the Eucharist
Mass continues: the newly confirmed receive the Body of Christ.

The Essential Rite: The Laying on of Hands and the Anointing With Chrism

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



At the heart of the celebration, two very old gestures show what God is doing for you. The Catechism of the Catholic Church explains that the essential rite of Confirmation is the anointing with sacred chrism on the forehead, done with the laying on of the hand, and these words: "Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit" (CCC 1300).

These gestures are not just symbols: through them, the Holy Spirit really acts.

- **The laying on of hands:** in the Acts of the Apostles, Peter and John lay their hands on the newly baptized in Samaria, and they receive the Holy Spirit (see Acts 8:14-17). The bishops, successors of the Apostles, repeat this gesture.
- **Sacred chrism:** olive oil mixed with perfume, consecrated by the bishop during Holy Week. The word "Christ" means "the Anointed One."
- **The cross on your forehead:** like a seal, it shows that you belong to Christ and that you are sent to be his witness.
- **Your "Amen":** with this word, you say "yes" to the gift God is giving you.

1. **What are the two gestures of the essential rite of Confirmation?**

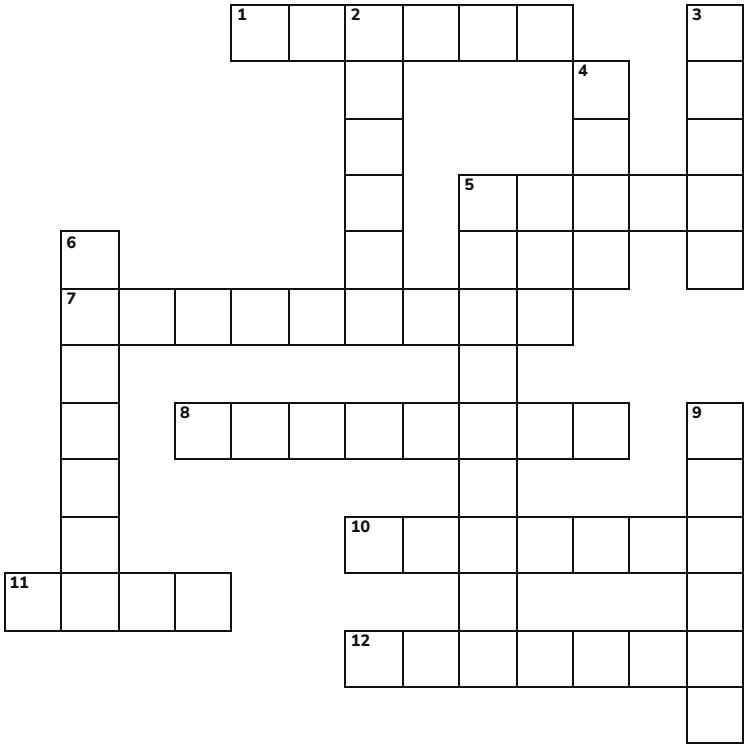
2. **What does the word "Christ" mean? What link do you see with sacred chrism?**

3. **A seal marks what belongs to someone. What does it mean to you to be "sealed" by the Holy Spirit?**

Confirmation Vocabulary

Find the words of Confirmation using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

1. He usually celebrates Confirmation. (6)

5. At the end of the rite, the bishop gives the sign of … (5)

7. The gesture of marking someone with oil. (9)

8. The bishop traces a cross here with sacred chrism. (8)

10. This person walks with you on the road of faith. (7)

11. The answer you give after the anointing. (4)

12. A confirmed Christian is called to be a … to Christ. (7)

Down ↓

2. The gift of God received at Confirmation: the Holy … (6)

3. The number of the gifts of the Holy Spirit. (5)

4. A mark that shows who something belongs to. (4)

5. The feast when the Apostles received the Holy Spirit. (9)

6. The first sacrament, which Confirmation completes. (7)

9. Perfumed oil consecrated by the bishop (sacred …). (6)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

The Role of the Bishop

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The bishop is a successor of the Apostles. He is the shepherd of a diocese, that is, a local Church that brings together many parishes. In the Latin Church, he is the one who usually celebrates Confirmation (see CCC 1312-1313).

When the bishop confirms you, he connects you to the Apostles, who received the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, and to the whole Church spread throughout the world. For a serious reason, the bishop can ask a priest to confirm in his place.

- **The miter:** the bishop's tall hat, worn for important celebrations.
- **The crosier:** a staff curved like a shepherd's staff. The bishop is the shepherd who cares for those Christ entrusts to him.
- **The ring:** it shows that the bishop is united to his Church, as if by a covenant.
- **Sacred chrism:** the bishop consecrates it at the Chrism Mass during Holy Week.

1. **What is the name of the bishop of your diocese? What is your diocese called?**

2. **Why is it usually the bishop who celebrates Confirmation?**

3. **The crosier recalls a shepherd's staff. Which Gospel passage does it make you think of?**

4. **What question would you like to ask your bishop?**

Choosing My Sponsor

Read what the Church asks, then think about your choice.

Name: _____

For Confirmation, you choose a sponsor. Your sponsor's role is to walk with you so that you live as a true witness to Christ. The Church recommends choosing, if possible, one of your godparents from Baptism.

According to Church law, a sponsor must be at least 16 years old, Catholic, and confirmed, must have received the Eucharist, and must live a life in keeping with the faith. Your mom or dad cannot be your sponsor.

My godparents from Baptism are:

The people I am thinking of asking to walk with me:

Why them? What do I admire in their faith?

I check:

- ☐ at least 16 years old
- ☐ Catholic and confirmed
- ☐ has received First Communion
- ☐ not my mom or dad

My choice, and what I hope for from my sponsor:

What Makes a Good Sponsor

Check the right answer, then answer the last question.

Name: _____

1. **A Confirmation sponsor must be at least…**
   - ☐ 12 years old ☐ 16 years old ☐ 30 years old
2. **A sponsor must be…**
   - ☐ a confirmed Catholic who has received the Eucharist ☐ just a fun friend
   - ☐ a member of the parish council
3. **Can you choose your mom or dad?**
   - ☐ yes, always ☐ no ☐ only if they are catechists
4. **The Church recommends choosing, if possible…**
   - ☐ one of your godparents from Baptism ☐ the oldest person in the family ☐ the pastor
5. **Above all, a sponsor's role is…**
   - ☐ to give a nice present ☐ to help you live as a witness to Christ ☐ to plan the party
6. **During the celebration, the sponsor…**
   - ☐ places a hand on your shoulder ☐ reads the Gospel ☐ does the anointing
7. **After Confirmation, the sponsor…**
   - ☐ has no role anymore ☐ keeps praying for you and encouraging you
   - ☐ must drive you to Mass every Sunday
8. **For you, what is the most important quality of a sponsor? Why?**

My Letter to My Sponsor

Write a letter to your sponsor to ask him or her to walk with you, or to say thank you.

Name: _____

A few ideas: tell your sponsor how your preparation is going, why you chose him or her, what you hope for, and ask for prayers.

Dear .....,

With love, ...

Choosing My Confirmation Name

Ask your parish what it does, then think about your choice.

Name: _____

On the day of Confirmation, the bishop calls you by name: "N., be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit." In most parishes in the United States, you choose the name of a saint as your Confirmation name: a model and a friend for your Christian life. It is a custom, not a rule, and many young people keep their baptismal name.

Whatever you choose, what matters is getting to know the life of this saint and asking for his or her help.

My baptismal name: _____ **The saint of my name:** _____

Feast day: _____ **What this saint did:** _____

The saints I like, and why:

The name I choose (or keep):

What I would like to imitate in this saint:

My prayer to my patron saint:

Investigating My Patron Saint

Find out about the saint whose name you carry: in a book, on your parish website, or by asking an adult.

Name: _____

Name: _____ **Dates:** _____

Country: _____ **Feast day:** _____

Work or state of life: _____ **Symbol:** _____

The great moments of this saint's life:

_____

_____

_____

_____

How did this saint show love for God and for others?

_____

_____

_____

Something this saint said, or something said about this saint:

_____

_____

I draw my patron saint with his or her symbol:

"Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

At the anointing, the bishop calls you by name and says: "Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit." You answer: "Amen." These few words sum up the whole meaning of Confirmation.

- **"Be sealed":** long ago, people put a seal on what belonged to them. You are sealed by Christ: you belong to him forever. That is why you receive Confirmation only once.
- **"the Gift":** Confirmation is not earned: it is a free gift. You prepare so you can welcome it as well as you can.
- **"of the Holy Spirit":** not a magic power, but God himself, the third Person of the Trinity, who comes to live in you.
- **"Amen":** this Hebrew word means "yes, it is true, I believe it." It is your own "yes" to God.

> **Remember**
> Confirmation leaves on the soul a spiritual mark that can never be erased, called the "character." You receive it only once in your life (see CCC 1304).

1. **Copy the words the bishop says at the anointing.**

2. **Why can we say that Confirmation is a "gift"?**

3. **What do you want to tell God with your "Amen"?**

The Baptismal Promises I Renew

On the day of your Confirmation, the bishop asks you to renew the faith of your Baptism. Prepare your answer.

Name: _____

On the day of your Baptism, your parents and godparents answered for you when you were a baby. At Confirmation, you answer for yourself. The bishop first asks if you reject evil, then if you believe in God the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, and in the Church. You answer each question personally.

What I reject (evil, what pulls me away from God)	What I choose instead

I say in my own words what I believe:

I believe in God the Father, who...

I believe in Jesus Christ, who...

I believe in the Holy Spirit, who...

I believe in the Church, which...

True or False About Confirmation

Mark each statement T (true) or F (false). Then rewrite the false ones to make them true.

Name: _____

1	You can receive Confirmation several times.	**T**	**F**
2	Confirmation is one of the three sacraments of Christian initiation.	**T**	**F**
3	Sacred chrism is a perfumed oil consecrated by the bishop.	**T**	**F**
4	The mom or dad of the person being confirmed can be the sponsor.	**T**	**F**
5	At the anointing, the bishop says: "Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit."	**T**	**F**
6	You have to be an adult to be confirmed.	**T**	**F**
7	The Apostles received the Holy Spirit on the day of Pentecost.	**T**	**F**
8	After Confirmation, you don't need to go to Mass anymore.	**T**	**F**
9	Confirmation gives you the strength to bear witness to Christ in words and actions.	**T**	**F**

My corrections:

The Signs of Confirmation and What They Mean

Draw a line from each item on the left to its match on the right.

Name: _____

The laying on of hands	The fire of the Spirit, as at Pentecost
Sacred chrism	You are sealed as belonging to Christ
The cross traced on the forehead	God calls you personally
Being called by name	You are in communion with the bishop and the whole Church
The sign of peace	The Holy Spirit comes down upon you
The color red	The oil that strengthens and spreads the fragrance of Christ

1. **Which sign touches you the most? Explain why.**

My Letter to the Bishop

In many parishes, each candidate writes to the bishop to ask for Confirmation. Write your letter.

Name: _____

A few ideas: introduce yourself, tell the story of your faith journey (your Baptism, your First Communion, your preparation), explain why you are asking for Confirmation and how you want to live afterward.

Dear Bishop .....,

....., date: .....

The Chain of Those Who Handed the Faith On to Me

The faith has been handed on from person to person, from the Apostles all the way to you. Fill in each link of the chain with names.

Name: _____

Jesus Christ
He calls the Apostles and sends them the Holy Spirit.

↓

The Apostles and the first Christians
They proclaim the Gospel to the ends of the earth.

↓

The saints and witnesses of every century

_____

↓

Those who brought me to Baptism (parents, godparents, priest)

_____

↓

Those who taught me to pray and to know Jesus

_____

↓

Me

_____

↓

Those I can hand the faith on to in my turn

_____

1. **Choose one person in your chain and write him or her a thank-you note.**

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Being Confirmed: What Does It Change in My Life?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Some people say: "Confirmation is the end of religious ed. After that, you're free." Others say: "It's the beginning of an adult Christian life." What do you think?

What the Church Says

In Confirmation, the Holy Spirit gives you a special strength to share your faith and stand up for it, in words and in actions, as a real witness to Christ (see CCC 1303).

1. **In your opinion, what will change after your Confirmation? What won't change?**

2. **Being a "witness to Christ" at your age: what does that look like in real life?**

3. **Why do some young people stop going to church after their Confirmation? What would you tell them?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

My Commitment in My Parish

A confirmed Christian is called to serve. Find out what you could do in your parish.

Name: _____

The Church is not just a building: it is a living community where everyone has a place. The Holy Spirit gives each person talents to serve others. Many parishes ask candidates for service hours: choose a service you can keep doing after Confirmation.

What my parish offers (find out):

- ☐ altar servers
- ☐ reading at Mass (lector)
- ☐ Scouts
- ☐ food pantry or help for the poor
- ☐ choir or music ministry
- ☐ youth group
- ☐ visiting the elderly
- ☐ helping with parish events

The talents God has given me:

The service I would like to try, and why:

The person I will talk to about it:

My concrete commitment (what? when? with whom?):

The Day of My Confirmation

Fill in this keepsake page on the day of your Confirmation or right after.

My name: _____ **Date:** _____

Parish: _____ **City:** _____

Bishop: _____ **Sponsor:** _____

What I felt during the anointing:

The word or moment that touched me the most:

My photo of the day, or my drawing:

A message from my sponsor:

Who Is the Holy Spirit?

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The Holy Spirit is not a thing or just a force: he is a divine Person, the third Person of the Holy Trinity. He is God with the Father and the Son. In the Creed, we call him "the Lord, the giver of life."

Before he died, Jesus promised his disciples that he would send them an Advocate who would always stay with them (see John 14:16-17). This promise came true at Pentecost. Since then, the Holy Spirit has never stopped acting in the Church and in the hearts of believers.

- **The Paraclete or Advocate:** the one called to our side to help us and comfort us.
- **The Spirit of truth:** he helps us understand everything Jesus said.
- **The Breath of God:** in Hebrew, the same word means "wind," "breath," and "spirit."
- **The gift of God:** he is given to us freely at Baptism and at Confirmation.

1. **Why can we say that the Holy Spirit is a "Person" and not a "thing"?**

2. **Which name for the Holy Spirit do you like best? Why?**

3. **At what moments in your life do you need an Advocate or a Comforter?**

The Symbols of the Holy Spirit: Dove, Fire, Wind, Water, Oil

We cannot see the Holy Spirit, but the Bible uses images to help us understand how he acts. Read, then answer.

Name: _____

- **The dove:** at the baptism of Jesus, the Holy Spirit comes down upon him like a dove (see Matthew 3:16). It also recalls Noah's dove, which announced peace after the Flood.
- **Fire:** at Pentecost, tongues as of fire come to rest on the disciples (see Acts 2:3). Fire warms, lights up, and transforms: that is what the Spirit does in our hearts.
- **Wind or breath:** at Pentecost, a noise like a strong wind fills the house (see Acts 2:2). We cannot see the wind, but we can see what it does.
- **Water:** at Baptism, water is the sign of the new life given by the Spirit. Jesus compares the Spirit to living water that flows from within (see John 7:38-39).
- **Oil:** anointing with oil strengthens and consecrates. At Confirmation, sacred chrism marks the one being confirmed.
- **The seal:** it leaves a mark. The Holy Spirit marks us forever as belonging to God.

1. **Choose two symbols and explain what they tell us about the Holy Spirit.**

2. **Which symbol of the Holy Spirit will you see on the day of your Confirmation?**

3. **Invent your own symbol of the Holy Spirit and explain it.**

The Story of Pentecost (Acts 2:1-13)

Read the beginning of the story, then the whole passage in your Bible (Acts 2:1-13). Then check the right answer.

Name: _____

When the time for Pentecost was fulfilled, they were all in one place together. And suddenly there came from the sky a noise like a strong driving wind, and it filled the entire house in which they were. Then there appeared to them tongues as of fire, which parted and came to rest on each one of them. And they were all filled with the holy Spirit and began to speak in different tongues, as the Spirit enabled them to proclaim.

(Acts 2:1-4)

1. **Where are the disciples?**
   ☐ by the lake ☐ all in one place together ☐ in the Temple
2. **What noise do they hear?**
   ☐ a clap of thunder ☐ a noise like a strong driving wind ☐ trumpets
3. **What appears to them?**
   ☐ a star ☐ tongues as of fire ☐ a rainbow
4. **What do they begin to do?**
   ☐ speak in different tongues ☐ sing psalms ☐ run away
5. **The people who came from many countries…**
   ☐ understand nothing ☐ hear them speaking in their own language ☐ leave without listening
6. **What do some people say to make fun of them?**
   ☐ That they have had too much new wine ☐ That they are crazy ☐ That they are foreigners
7. **What changed in the disciples after they received the Holy Spirit?**

From Easter to Pentecost: The Fifty Days

Complete the timeline with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The word "Pentecost" comes from Greek and means "fiftieth": Pentecost is celebrated on the fiftieth day after Easter.

appears · Ascension · risen · red · pray · Pentecost · baptized

Day 1	Easter: Jesus is _____ from the dead.
The days that follow	Jesus _____ to his disciples: to Mary Magdalene, to the disciples on the road to Emmaus, to Thomas _____
Day 40	The _____ : Jesus is taken up to heaven before the eyes of the Apostles.
Days 40 to 50	The disciples gather in the Upper Room and _____ with Mary, the mother of Jesus.
Day 50	_____ : the Holy Spirit comes down upon the disciples.
The same day	Peter proclaims Jesus to the crowd; about three thousand people are _____ .
Today	Easter Time lasts fifty days and ends at Pentecost: that day, the priest wears _____ vestments.

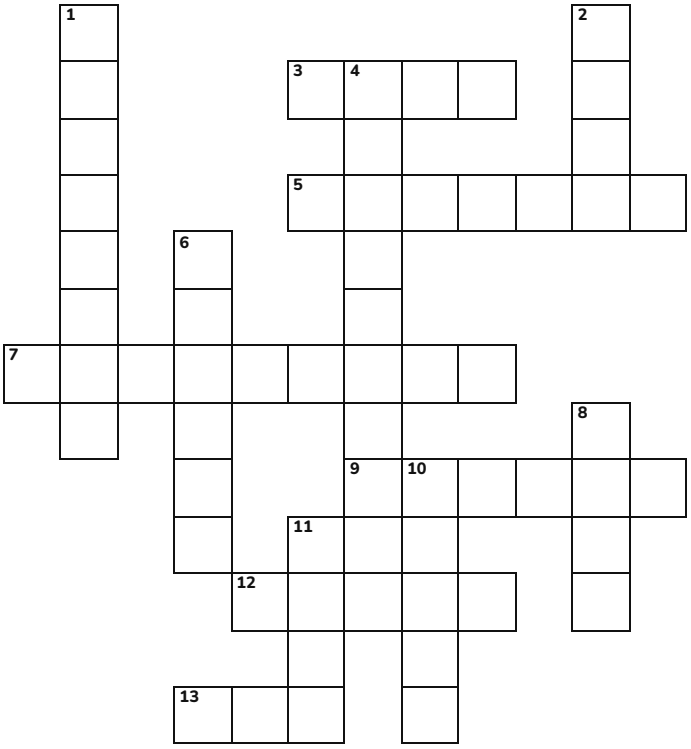
1. **Why did the disciples pray during the days before Pentecost?**

2. **How could you prepare, too, to receive the Holy Spirit?**

Pentecost

Read the story of Pentecost again (Acts 2:1-41), then fill in the grid with the right words.

Name: _____



Across →

3. The mother of Jesus, who prayed with the Apostles before Pentecost. (4)

5. "And they were all filled with the holy Spirit and began to speak in different ..." (Acts 2:4). (7)

7. "Now there were devout Jews from every nation under heaven staying in ..." (Acts 2:5). (9)

9. At Pentecost the disciples are all filled with the Holy ... (Acts 2:4). (6)

12. Pentecost comes ... days after Easter. (5)

13. The color of the priest's vestments at Mass on Pentecost. (3)

Down ↓

1. "Those who accepted his message were ..., and about three thousand persons were added that day" (Acts 2:41). (8)

2. The bird that stands for the Holy Spirit at the baptism of Jesus. (4)

4. The Twelve sent by Jesus to proclaim the Gospel. (8)

6. Pentecost is often called the birthday of the ... (6)

8. "Then there appeared to them tongues as of ..., which parted and came to rest on each one of them" (Acts 2:3). (4)

10. "Then ... stood up with the Eleven, raised his voice..." (Acts 2:14). (5)

11. "And suddenly there came from the sky a noise like a strong driving ..." (Acts 2:2). (4)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

Peter's Sermon (Acts 2:14-41)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



After the Holy Spirit comes, Peter, who had been afraid and had denied Jesus during the Passion, stands up before the crowd. With courage, he explains that what is happening was announced by the prophet Joel: God pours out his Spirit on all people.

Then he proclaims the heart of the faith: Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified, God raised from the dead, and the Apostles are his witnesses. The listeners are cut to the heart and ask Peter and the other Apostles what they should do.

Peter's Answer

"Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins; and you will receive the gift of the holy Spirit."

Acts 2:38

1. **What changed in Peter since the Passion of Jesus? Who transformed him?**

2. **What does Peter ask the crowd to do? What does he promise them?**

3. **How many people join the disciples that day (Acts 2:41)?**

4. **If you had to tell your friends about Jesus in one sentence, what would you say?**

The Wheel of the 7 Gifts of the Holy Spirit

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The prophet Isaiah announced that the Spirit of the Lord would rest upon the Messiah (see Isaiah 11:2). The Church recognizes seven gifts of the Holy Spirit: they make us open to his action (see CCC 1830-1831). Write the name of each gift.

Understanding · Fear of the Lord · Wisdom · Knowledge · Counsel · Fortitude · Piety

_____

Seeing everything the way God sees it.

_____

Understanding the Word of God from the inside.

_____

Making good choices and giving good advice.

_____

Having the courage to do good, even when it is hard.

_____

Seeing creation as a gift from God.

_____

Loving God as a Father, with the trust of a child.

_____

Being filled with wonder at God's greatness and not wanting to turn away from him.

And me?

The gift I need most right now: .....

1. **Why do we speak of "gifts" and not of "talents" or "qualities"?**

The Gift of Wisdom

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The gift of wisdom helps you see everything the way God sees it and enjoy what comes from him. People with wisdom know what really matters in life: love for God and for others, more than money, success, or appearances.

- **In the Bible:** King Solomon asked God for an understanding heart to rule with justice, instead of riches or a long life (see 1 Kings 3:5-12).
- **In my life:** You have to choose between a party where people make fun of others and a quiet evening with your family. Wisdom helps you sense where real happiness is.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Louis, King of France, governed by trying first to please God and to serve the poor.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of wisdom.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

The Gift of Understanding

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The gift of understanding is not about getting good grades! It helps you understand from the inside the truths of the faith and the Word of God. Thanks to it, a Gospel passage you know by heart can suddenly speak to you personally.

- **In the Bible:** On the road to Emmaus, the risen Jesus explains the Scriptures to two disciples, and their hearts burn within them (see Luke 24:13-35).
- **In my life:** At Mass, you listen to the Gospel, and one sentence touches you as if it were written for you. The Spirit is opening your understanding.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Thérèse of Lisieux never went to college, but she understood God's love so well that she became a Doctor of the Church.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of understanding.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

The Gift of Counsel

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The gift of counsel helps you make good choices and know what to do in a specific situation. It also helps you give good advice to others. It is like a quiet inner voice that guides your conscience.

- **In the Bible:** At the wedding at Cana, Mary gives the best advice there is: "Do whatever he tells you" (John 2:5).
- **In my life:** Your friend offers to let you copy his answers during a test. The gift of counsel helps you know what to say, without judging him.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint John Vianney, the Curé of Ars, counseled thousands of people who came to him for Confession.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of counsel.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

The Gift of Fortitude

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The gift of fortitude gives you the courage to do good even when it is hard, to resist temptation, and to stay faithful to Christ when people make fun of you. It is not the strength of your muscles, but of your heart.

- **In the Bible:** After Pentecost, Peter and John, who had been afraid, proclaim Jesus boldly before the leaders of the people (see Acts 4:13).
- **In my life:** At school, a classmate is left out by everyone. It takes courage to go over to him. The Holy Spirit gives you that strength.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Joan of Arc had the courage to stay faithful to God to the very end, even before her judges.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of fortitude.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

The Gift of Knowledge

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The gift of knowledge helps you see the created world as a gift from God. It lets you recognize the beauty of creation without worshiping it instead of God, and use the things of the earth in the right way.

- **In the Bible:** The psalmist is amazed: "When I see your heavens, the work of your fingers, the moon and stars that you set in place..." (Psalm 8:4).
- **In my life:** In front of a beautiful sunset or a starry sky, you want to say thank you to the Creator. The gift of knowledge helps you do that.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Francis of Assisi called the sun "brother" and the moon "sister" and praised God for all his creatures.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of knowledge.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

The Gift of Piety

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The gift of piety makes you love God as a very good Father, with the trust of a child. It helps you enjoy praying and helps you see others as your brothers and sisters.

- **In the Bible:** Jesus teaches his disciples to pray by saying "Our Father" (see Matthew 6:9).
- **In my life:** At night, instead of rushing through your prayers, you take time to talk to God like a Father who is listening. That is the gift of piety.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Bernadette prayed the rosary with a simplicity and a trust that touched everyone who saw her.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of piety.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

The Gift of Fear of the Lord

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Fear of the Lord is not being afraid of God! It is wonder and deep respect before God, who is so great and so good. It is also the fear of hurting him by turning away from his love, the way you are afraid of hurting someone you love.

- **In the Bible:** Before the glory of God, the prophet Isaiah hears the seraphim sing: "Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts!" (Isaiah 6:3).
- **In my life:** You walk into a church and become quiet; you genuflect before the tabernacle. You sense that God is there, very close and very great.
- **A saint who lived it:** Saint John Vianney spent long hours in adoration before the tabernacle, full of respect and love.

> **I Pray**
> Holy Spirit, come to me and give me the gift of fear of the Lord.

1. **Explain this gift in your own words.**

2. **Describe a situation in your life where this gift would help you.**

3. **Who around you has this gift, in your opinion? Why?**

Each Gift in a Real-Life Situation

Draw a line from each situation to the gift of the Holy Spirit that helps the most to live it.

Name: _____

I refuse to join the group making fun of a classmate.	understanding
I look at the ocean and thank God.	fear of the Lord
I don't know which activity to choose, so I ask God for advice.	fortitude
A Gospel sentence speaks to me personally.	wisdom
I talk to God with the trust of a child.	knowledge
I understand that love matters more than money.	counsel
I am silent with respect before the tabernacle.	piety

Which Gift Would Help Me Here?

Read the four situations. For each one, choose the gift of the Holy Spirit that would help the most and explain why.

Name: _____

Four Situations

A. Emma broke her sister's phone. Nobody saw her. She isn't sure whether to tell anyone.

B. Tyler is invited to a birthday party on Sunday morning, at Mass time. He can't decide what to do.

C. Sophia thinks praying is boring: she recites words without thinking about them.

D. Lucas is the only one in his class who goes to religious ed. Some kids call him a "baby."

The 7 Gifts

wisdom · understanding · counsel · fortitude · knowledge · piety · fear of the Lord

1. **Situation A: which gift? Why?**

2. **Situation B: which gift? Why?**

3. **Situation C: which gift? Why?**

4. **Situation D: which gift? Why?**

The Big Quiz on the 7 Gifts

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

1. **How many gifts of the Holy Spirit are there?**
   ☐ five ☐ seven ☐ twelve
2. **Which prophet announces that the Spirit will rest upon the Messiah?**
   ☐ Isaiah ☐ Jonah ☐ Daniel
3. **Fear of the Lord is…**
   ☐ being afraid of punishment ☐ wonder and respect before God ☐ never talking about God
4. **Which gift helps you make good choices?**
   ☐ counsel ☐ piety ☐ knowledge
5. **Which gift helps you love God as a Father?**
   ☐ fortitude ☐ piety ☐ understanding
6. **The gift of understanding helps you above all…**
   ☐ get good grades ☐ understand the Word of God ☐ win games
7. **Which gift helped Joan of Arc stay faithful before her judges?**
   ☐ fortitude ☐ knowledge ☐ counsel
8. **When do we receive the gifts of the Holy Spirit?**
   ☐ only at Confirmation ☐ at Baptism, and they are strengthened at Confirmation ☐ only at the end of life
9. **Which gift will you ask the Holy Spirit for first? Why?**

The 12 Fruits of the Holy Spirit

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

When we let the Holy Spirit act in us, he produces good fruit, like a well-nourished tree. Saint Paul lists several of them in his Letter to the Galatians (see Galatians 5:22-23). The tradition of the Church counts twelve (see CCC 1832).

- **Charity:** loving God and others.
- **Joy:** a deep joy, even in hard times.
- **Peace:** a calm heart that settles arguments.
- **Patience:** putting up with difficulties without getting upset.
- **Kindness:** being nice in what you do and say.
- **Goodness:** wanting what is good for others.
- **Generosity:** giving freely, without keeping score.
- **Gentleness:** being gentle, even with those who hurt us.
- **Faithfulness:** keeping your promises.
- **Modesty:** not showing off.
- **Self-control:** being able to master yourself.
- **Chastity:** respecting your body and the bodies of others.

1. **What is the difference between a "gift" and a "fruit" of the Holy Spirit?**

2. **Which fruits do you already see growing in your life?**

The Tree of the Fruits of the Spirit

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Write the name of each fruit from its definition. Then color the tree.



Chastity · Modesty · Faithfulness · Joy · Generosity · Charity · Patience · Self-control · Goodness · Peace · Gentleness · Kindness

_____ Loving God and others.	_____ Being happy in God.	_____ A calm heart.
_____ Not getting upset.	_____ Being nice.	_____ Wanting good for others.
_____ Giving freely.	_____ Being gentle.	_____ Keeping your word.
_____ Not bragging.	_____ Mastering yourself.	_____ Respecting your body.

Which Fruit Do I Want to Grow?

A fruit takes time to ripen. Choose a fruit of the Spirit and make a resolution to help it grow.

Name: _____

The fruit I choose:

- ☐ charity
- ☐ peace
- ☐ kindness
- ☐ faithfulness
- ☐ joy
- ☐ patience
- ☐ gentleness
- ☐ self-control

Why this fruit? Where do I need it most (at home, at school, with my friends)?

What keeps it from growing in me:

My concrete resolution for this week:

At the end of the week, I look back:

My prayer to the Holy Spirit:

The Fruits of the Spirit

Find the words in the grid. They run left to right, top to bottom, or diagonally.

Name: _____

U	Z	K	X	P	G	S	J	T	R	D	G	P
B	G	R	C	A	U	I	S	W	W	F	B	E
K	E	K	K	Y	I	P	E	U	A	A	G	A
I	N	I	O	L	M	A	L	C	N	I	E	C
N	E	J	Z	T	O	T	F	H	U	T	N	E
D	R	G	H	D	D	I	C	A	C	H	T	P
N	O	O	S	Z	E	E	O	S	H	F	L	B
E	S	O	U	A	S	N	N	T	A	U	E	W
S	I	D	A	F	T	C	T	I	R	L	N	O
S	T	N	Y	H	Y	E	R	T	I	N	E	I
F	Y	E	I	B	X	T	O	Y	T	E	S	M
I	E	S	N	O	C	L	L	P	Y	S	S	D
K	S	S	O	H	S	C	G	D	E	S	O	A

CHARITY JOY PEACE PATIENCE KINDNESS GOODNESS GENEROSITY GENTLENESS FAITHFULNESS MODESTY SELFCONTROL CHASTITY

1. **Choose three fruits and write an everyday example for each one.**

"Come, Holy Spirit": I Pray to the Holy Spirit

Learn this traditional prayer to the Holy Spirit, then write your own prayer.

Name: _____

Prayer to the Holy Spirit

Come, Holy Spirit, fill the hearts of your faithful
and kindle in them the fire of your love.
Send forth your Spirit and they shall be created,
and you shall renew the face of the earth.

Traditional prayer (text: USCCB)

This prayer is often said at the beginning of a meeting, a class, or an important task. You can say it every morning during your preparation.

The times when I will say this prayer:

My own prayer to the Holy Spirit (ask for a gift, thank him, entrust someone to him):

I decorate my prayer (dove, flames, wind...):

Is the Holy Spirit Still at Work Today?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Lily says: "The Holy Spirit was for the Apostles. Today, nobody sees tongues of fire anymore!" Mateo answers: "I think he still acts, just in a different way."

To Help You

The Holy Spirit acts in the sacraments, in prayer, in the Bible, in the saints, and in everyone who does good. We cannot see him, but we can see what he does, like the wind.

1. **Who do you agree with: Lily or Mateo? Why?**

2. **Give an example of someone today in whom the Holy Spirit is at work, in your opinion.**

3. **How can we recognize that the Holy Spirit is at work?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

The Holy Spirit in the Bible

Mark each statement T (true) or F (false). Then rewrite the false ones to make them true.

Name: _____

1	On the Bible's first page, a mighty wind sweeps over the waters, and the Hebrew word for wind also means spirit.	**T**	**F**
2	At the baptism of Jesus, the Holy Spirit comes down in the form of an eagle.	**T**	**F**
3	Mary conceived Jesus by the power of the Holy Spirit.	**T**	**F**
4	Jesus never talked about the Holy Spirit.	**T**	**F**
5	At Pentecost, tongues as of fire come to rest on the disciples.	**T**	**F**
6	The prophets spoke under the action of the Holy Spirit.	**T**	**F**
7	The Holy Spirit is less important than the Father and the Son.	**T**	**F**
8	Saint Paul says that our body is a temple of the Holy Spirit.	**T**	**F**
9	After Pentecost, the Apostles stayed hidden out of fear.	**T**	**F**

My corrections:

The Holy Spirit, From Creation to the Baptism of Jesus

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The Holy Spirit does not appear only at Pentecost. He is at work in the whole history of salvation, from the very beginning.

- **At Creation:** the Bible speaks of "a mighty wind sweeping over the waters" (Genesis 1:2). In Hebrew, the word for wind also means breath and spirit: the Spirit gives life.
- **In the prophets:** Isaiah announces that the Spirit of the Lord will rest upon the Messiah (see Isaiah 11:1-2).
- **At the Annunciation:** the angel Gabriel tells Mary that the Holy Spirit will come upon her and that the child will be called Son of God (see Luke 1:35).
- **At the baptism of Jesus:** the Holy Spirit comes down upon Jesus in bodily form like a dove, and the voice of the Father is heard (see Luke 3:21-22).
- **In the life of Jesus:** the Spirit leads Jesus into the desert; then, in Nazareth, Jesus reads: "The Spirit of the Lord is upon me" (Luke 4:18).

1. **At which moments in the life of Jesus is the Holy Spirit present?**

2. **At the baptism of Jesus, how do the three Persons of the Trinity show themselves?**

3. **What connection do you see between the baptism of Jesus and your own Confirmation?**

What I Remember About the Holy Spirit

Look back on this part about the Holy Spirit and Pentecost.

Name: _____

Three important things I learned:

The 7 gifts of the Holy Spirit (no peeking!):

The gift I need most, and why:

A question I still have:

What I remember from the story of Pentecost:

My prayer to the Holy Spirit for this week:

What Is the Creed?

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

"Credo" is a Latin word that means "I believe." The Creed, also called the "Symbol of Faith," is a summary of what Christians believe. The word "symbol" comes from a Greek word for a sign of recognition: when Christians say the Creed, they recognize one another as united in the same faith.

We say the Creed at Sunday Mass, after the homily. It is also professed at Baptism, and at Confirmation you renew the faith of your Baptism.

- **Two main forms:** the Apostles' Creed, the ancient baptismal creed of the Church of Rome, and the Nicene Creed, which comes from the first two great councils.
- **Three parts:** God the Father and creation; Jesus Christ and salvation; the Holy Spirit, the Church, and eternal life.
- **Twelve articles:** according to an ancient tradition, the Apostles' Creed has twelve articles, like the twelve Apostles.

> **Remember**
> The Creed is not a list of things to learn by heart, but a statement of trust: "I believe in you, Lord."

1. **What does the word "Credo" mean?**

2. **What are the three main parts of the Creed?**

3. **At what moment of Mass do we say the Creed?**

4. **Why is it important that all Christians say the same Creed?**

The Apostles' Creed and the Nicene Creed

Complete the table with the words from the box to compare the two forms of the Creed.

Name: _____

"the holy catholic Church" · baptismal creed of the Church of Rome · "I believe in one God" · "the Lord, the giver of life" · Councils of Nicaea (325) and Constantinople (381) · longer and more detailed · "begotten, not made, consubstantial with the Father"

	Apostles' Creed	Nicene Creed
Origin		
Length	shorter	
First words	"I believe in God, the Father almighty, Creator of heaven and earth"	
About the Son	"his only Son, our Lord"	
About the Spirit	"I believe in the Holy Spirit"	
About the Church		"one, holy, catholic and apostolic Church"

1. **Which Creed do you hear most often at Mass in your parish?**

2. **Why do you think the Nicene Creed is more detailed?**

The Apostles' Creed

Fill in the Creed with the words from the box, then learn it by heart.

Name: _____

Pilate · sins · Virgin · saints · Son · heaven · Church · Father · Holy Spirit · living · body · everlasting · third · crucified · Creator

I believe in God,

the _____ almighty,

_____ of heaven and earth,

and in Jesus Christ, his only _____, our Lord,

who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,

born of the _____ Mary,

suffered under Pontius _____,

was _____, died and was buried;

he descended into hell;

on the _____ day he rose again from the dead;

he ascended into _____,

and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty;

from there he will come to judge the _____ and the dead.

I believe in the _____,

the holy catholic _____,

the communion of _____,

the forgiveness of _____,

the resurrection of the _____,

and life _____.

Amen.

Text: USCCB (usccb.org/prayers)

I Believe in God, the Father Almighty

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The first part of the Creed speaks about God the Father. Jesus showed us that God is a Father full of love, and he taught us to call him "Our Father." God is Father first because he is the Father of Jesus, his only Son, and also because he is the source of all life.

He is "almighty": nothing is impossible for him. But his power is the power of love: he never forces our freedom; he forgives and he saves.

- **Creator:** God created everything out of love, "heaven and earth," that is, everything that exists, visible and invisible.
- **Father:** we are his children, and we can talk to him with trust.
- **Almighty:** he can do all things, and he wants what is good for us.

1. **What does Jesus teach us about God when he calls him "Father"?**

2. **God's power is the power of love. What does that mean?**

3. **Write a short prayer to thank God the Father.**

I Believe in Jesus Christ, His Only Son

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The second part of the Creed, the longest, is about Jesus. In Hebrew, "Jesus" means "God saves." "Christ" comes from a Greek word that means "the Anointed One," the Messiah awaited by the people of Israel.

Jesus is truly God, the only Son of the Father, and truly man, born of the Virgin Mary. He lived among us, died on the cross to save us, and rose again. He is "our Lord": the one to whom we give our life.

- **True God:** he is the eternal Son of the Father.
- **True man:** he was hungry, he cried, he had friends.
- **Savior:** by his death and Resurrection, he frees us from sin and death.

1. **What do the names "Jesus" and "Christ" mean?**

2. **Why do we say that Jesus is "true God and true man"?**

3. **Which moment in the life of Jesus do you like best? Why?**

I Believe in the Holy Spirit

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The third part of the Creed begins with "I believe in the Holy Spirit." In the Nicene Creed, we call him "the Lord, the giver of life," and we say that he is adored and glorified with the Father and the Son and that he has spoken through the prophets.

After the Holy Spirit, the Creed speaks of the Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, and eternal life: these are the fruits of the Spirit's action.

- **Lord:** he is God, like the Father and the Son.
- **Giver of life:** he gives us new birth into God's life at Baptism.
- **He has spoken through the prophets:** he inspires the Word of God.

1. **Copy two expressions from the Creed that speak about the Holy Spirit.**

2. **Why is the Church named right after the Holy Spirit in the Creed?**

3. **How does the Holy Spirit "give life"?**

The Holy Trinity

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

We believe in one God in three Persons: the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit. This is the mystery of the Holy Trinity, the heart of the Christian faith. They are not three gods, but one God who is a communion of love.

Every time you make the Sign of the Cross, you profess your faith in the Trinity: "In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen."

The Son · The Holy Spirit · The Father

_____	_____	_____
He created the world out of love.	He became man to save us.	He makes us holy and gives us God's life.

At the baptism of Jesus	**The Sign of the Cross**	**One God**
The voice of the … is heard, the … is baptized, the … comes down like a dove.	I trace the cross while saying the three names.	Three Persons, one God, one communion of love.

1. **Fill in: at the baptism of Jesus, who speaks? Who is baptized? Who comes down like a dove?**

2. **Saint Patrick explained the Trinity with a three-leaf shamrock. Invent a comparison of your own.**

God, Creator of Heaven and Earth

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The Bible begins with the story of creation (see Genesis 1). This story does not try to explain how the world was formed, the way a science book would. It tells why the world exists: because God wanted it and created it out of love. And at each step, God sees that what he has made is good.

Man and woman are created in God's image (see Genesis 1:27): able to love, to think, to choose, and to have a relationship with him. God entrusts the earth to them so they will take care of it.

- **Creation and science:** faith and science are not enemies. Science looks for how the world works; faith says who made it and what it means.
- **Caring for creation:** Pope Francis wrote a letter, *Laudato Si'*, about caring for our common home.

1. **What does the story of creation want to tell us?**

2. **What does it mean to be created in God's image?**

3. **Name two concrete ways to take care of creation.**

The Life of Jesus

Complete each step in the life of Jesus with the words from the box.

Name: _____

cross · Apostles · heaven · Spirit · Mary · risen · Eucharist · Nazareth · Jordan · Bethlehem

The Annunciation — The angel Gabriel tells _____ that she will be the mother of the Savior.

The Nativity — Jesus is born in _____ ; shepherds come to worship him.

Childhood — Jesus grows up in _____ with Mary and Joseph.

The baptism — Jesus is baptized by John in the _____ River.

Public life — Jesus proclaims the Kingdom, heals the sick, and chooses twelve _____ .

The Last Supper — On Holy Thursday, Jesus takes bread and wine: he institutes the _____ .

The Passion — On Good Friday, Jesus dies on the _____ .

Easter — On the third day, Jesus is _____ .

The Ascension — Forty days after Easter, Jesus goes up to _____ .

Pentecost — Jesus sends the Holy _____ upon his disciples.

The Death and Resurrection of Jesus

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The Creed says that Jesus "suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried." Jesus did not run away from suffering: he gave his life freely, out of love for us, to free us from sin.

But death did not have the last word. "On the third day he rose again from the dead." On Easter Sunday, the women find the tomb empty; then Jesus appears alive to his disciples. The Resurrection is the heart of our faith: if Jesus is alive, death is no longer the end of everything.

- **Good Friday:** we remember the death of Jesus on the cross.
- **Holy Saturday:** a day of silence and waiting.
- **Easter Sunday:** the greatest Christian feast, the victory of life.
- **Every Sunday:** it is a little Easter.

1. **Why did Jesus freely choose to die on the cross?**

2. **Why is the Resurrection the heart of the Christian faith?**

3. **Why do Christians gather on Sunday?**

The Ascension and the Return of Christ

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Forty days after Easter, Jesus is taken up to heaven before the eyes of his Apostles: this is the Ascension (see Acts 1:9-11). The Creed says that "he ascended into heaven, and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty."

Jesus does not abandon us: he goes ahead of us to the Father and sends us the Holy Spirit. He promised to come back in glory at the end of time: "from there he will come to judge the living and the dead." This judgment will be a judgment of love: we will be judged on love.

- **"Seated at the right hand of the Father":** an image that says Jesus shares God's glory and power.
- **While we wait for his return:** Christians are sent to be his witnesses to the ends of the earth (see Acts 1:8).

1. **How many days after Easter do we celebrate the Ascension?**

2. **Why is the Ascension not a sad "goodbye"?**

3. **How can you be a witness to Jesus while we wait for his return?**

The Holy Catholic Church

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

In the Apostles' Creed, we say: "I believe in ... the holy catholic Church." The Church is the People of God gathered by Christ. Saint Paul compares it to a body: Christ is the head, and we are the members (see 1 Corinthians 12).

In the Nicene Creed, we say that we believe in "one, holy, catholic and apostolic Church": these are the four "marks" of the Church.

- **One:** one Lord, one faith, one Baptism.
- **Holy:** because Christ makes it holy, even though its members are sinners.
- **Catholic:** this word means "universal": the Church is sent to all peoples.
- **Apostolic:** it is founded on the Apostles, and the bishops are their successors.

1. **Copy the four "marks" of the Church.**

2. **What does the word "catholic" mean?**

3. **How can the Church be "holy" when its members are sinners?**

4. **Saint Paul compares the Church to a body. What is your place in this body?**

The Communion of Saints

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



"I believe in ... the communion of saints." This means that all the baptized form one family, united to Christ: those living on earth, those who have died and are being purified, and the saints who are already with God in heaven.

In this great family, we share everything: prayer, the sacraments, love. We can pray for those who have died, and the saints pray for us. No one is alone in the Church.

- **November 1:** on All Saints' Day, we celebrate all the saints, known and unknown.
- **November 2:** on All Souls' Day, we pray for all the faithful departed.
- **At every Mass:** we pray in communion with the Virgin Mary and all the saints.

1. **Who belongs to the communion of saints?**

2. **Think of someone who has died, in your family or among the people you know. Who do you want to pray for?**

3. **Which saint would you like to pray to for help? Why?**

The Forgiveness of Sins

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



"I believe in ... the forgiveness of sins." Sin means refusing to love God and others, doing wrong on purpose. It hurts our relationship with God and with others.

God is greater than our sins. The first sacrament of forgiveness is Baptism, which washes away all sins. Afterward, when we sin, Jesus offers us the sacrament of Reconciliation: the priest, in the name of Christ, gives us God's forgiveness.

- **The parable of the Prodigal Son (see Luke 15:11-32):** the father runs to his son who is coming home and takes him in his arms. That is how God welcomes us when we come back to him.
- **The Our Father:** "and forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us."

1. **What does the word "forgiveness" mean to you?**

2. **What are the two sacraments through which God forgives sins?**

3. **In the parable of the Prodigal Son, what does the father do when his son comes back? What does it teach us about God?**

The Resurrection of the Body and Life Everlasting

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Creed ends with a great hope: "I believe in … the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting." Since Jesus rose from the dead, we too will rise. "The body" means that our whole person, body and soul, is called to live with God.

Eternal life does not begin only after death: it begins now, when we live in God's love. Heaven is being with God forever, in a happiness we cannot even imagine.

- **Heaven:** perfect communion with God and with all the saints.
- **Purgatory:** a purification for those who die in God's friendship but still need to be purified.
- **Hell:** the final and free refusal of God's love. God does not want anyone to be lost.

> **A Word From Jesus**
> "I am the resurrection and the life" (John 11:25)

1. **What does "the resurrection of the body" mean?**

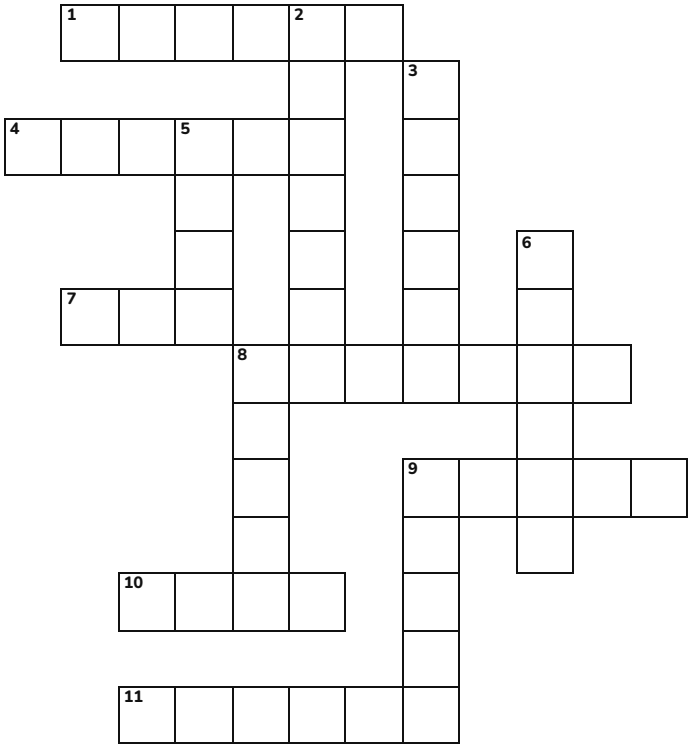
2. **Why can we say that eternal life begins now?**

3. **How do you imagine heaven?**

The Words of the Creed

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

1. "the holy catholic ..." (6)

4. Jesus suffered under Pontius ... (6)

7. Jesus Christ, his only ..., our Lord. (3)

8. One God in three Persons. (7)

9. A statement of faith; its Latin name means "I believe." (5)

10. "the resurrection of the ..." (4)

11. "the communion of ..." (6)

Down ↓

2. "... of heaven and earth." (7)

3. Jesus was born of the ... Mary. (6)

5. The last word of the Creed. (4)

6. God the ..., Creator of heaven and earth. (6)

8. On the ... day he rose again from the dead. (5)

9. Jesus died on it to save us. (5)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

The Articles of the Creed

Put these phrases of the Apostles' Creed back in the right order by numbering them from 1 to 10.

Name: _____

- [ ] and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
- [ ] the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints,
- [ ] from there he will come to judge the living and the dead.
- [ ] he ascended into heaven, and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty;
- [ ] I believe in God, the Father almighty, Creator of heaven and earth,
- [ ] suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried;
- [ ] who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary,
- [ ] he descended into hell; on the third day he rose again from the dead;
- [ ] the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting. Amen.
- [ ] I believe in the Holy Spirit,

1. **Say the whole Creed to an adult. Adult's signature:**

The Creed Quiz

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

1. **What does "Credo" mean?**
   ☐ I pray ☐ I believe ☐ I sing
2. **How many Persons are there in the Trinity?**
   ☐ one ☐ two ☐ three
3. **Under which Roman governor did Jesus suffer?**
   ☐ Herod ☐ Pontius Pilate ☐ Caesar Augustus
4. **On which day did Jesus rise?**
   ☐ the first day ☐ the third day ☐ the seventh day
5. **What does the word "catholic" mean?**
   ☐ ancient ☐ universal ☐ Roman
6. **What does "the forgiveness of sins" mean?**
   ☐ God takes away our sins ☐ the list of our sins ☐ the punishment of sins
7. **The Nicene Creed comes from...**
   ☐ two councils ☐ Pope Francis ☐ the Gospels
8. **Which word ends the Creed?**
   ☐ Alleluia ☐ Amen ☐ Hosanna
9. **Which phrase of the Creed is the hardest for you to understand? Ask your catechist about it.**

Explaining My Faith to a Friend Who Doesn't Believe

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

At recess, Nathan finds out that Chloe is going to be confirmed. He laughs: "You still believe those stories? God is something people made up because they're scared. You can't see him, so he doesn't exist."

Chloe feels a little uncomfortable. She doesn't want to argue, but she doesn't want to pretend she doesn't believe, either.

To Help You

Saint Peter asks Christians to always be ready to explain the hope that is in them, but with gentleness and respect (see 1 Peter 3:15-16). We don't force anyone to believe: we bear witness to what we live.

1. **How does Chloe feel? What could she answer Nathan, with gentleness and respect?**

2. **"You can't see him, so he doesn't exist." Find examples of real things that we cannot see.**

3. **What in your life makes you believe in God?**

4. **Why is witness through actions sometimes stronger than words?**

Why Do We Say "I Believe"?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

At Mass, we say the Creed all together, but each of us says "I believe," not "We believe."

What the Church Says

Faith is a personal act: it is each person's free answer to God who reveals himself. But no one can believe alone: "I believe" leans on the faith of the whole Church (see CCC 166-167).

1. **Why do we say "I believe" and not "we believe"?**

2. **Can you believe all alone, without others? Why?**

3. **Is it normal to have doubts when you believe? What can you do with your doubts?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

The Council of Nicaea (325)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

At the beginning of the 4th century, a priest from Alexandria named Arius taught that Jesus was not really God, but only the most perfect of creatures. This idea was dividing Christians.

In 325, Emperor Constantine gathered the bishops in Nicaea, in today's Turkey: this was the first ecumenical, that is, universal, council. The bishops declared that the Son has the same nature as the Father: he is truly God. In 381, the Council of Constantinople completed the text, especially about the Holy Spirit. It is the Creed we still say at Mass.

- **A council:** a great assembly of bishops gathered to teach and decide together.
- **2025:** the Church celebrated 1,700 years since the Council of Nicaea.

> **In the Nicene Creed**
> "begotten, not made, consubstantial with the Father"

1. **What did Arius teach? Why was it serious?**

2. **What did the bishops declare at Nicaea?**

3. **Why is it important for the Church to be united in the same faith?**

My Creed in My Own Words

Now that you have discovered the Creed, write your own profession of faith. Keep the three parts.

Name: _____

I believe in God the Father, who...

I believe in Jesus Christ, who...

I believe in the Holy Spirit, who...

I believe in the Church, and I hope...

The phrase of the Creed that touches me the most:

The 7 Sacraments in Three Families

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The sacraments are visible signs through which Christ gives us his life. There are seven of them. The Church groups them in three families (see CCC 1210-1211). Complete each family with the sacraments from the box.

Reconciliation, Anointing of the Sick · Holy Orders, Matrimony · Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist

The sacraments of Christian initiation: they bring us into the Christian life

_____

The sacraments of healing: they care for the soul and the body

_____

The sacraments at the service of communion: they commit us to serving others

_____

1. **Which sacraments have you already received? Which one will you receive soon?**

2. **Why do you think Confirmation is in the first family?**

3. **Which sacraments can you receive only once?**

The Three Sacraments of Christian Initiation

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

"Initiation" means "beginning" or "entering." The three sacraments of Christian initiation lay the foundations of the whole Christian life. The Catechism compares them to natural life: we are born, we grow, and we are fed (see CCC 1212).

- **Baptism: being born.** Through water and the Spirit, we are born into God's life. We become children of God and members of the Church.
- **Confirmation: growing.** The Holy Spirit strengthens the life we received at Baptism and makes us witnesses to Christ.
- **Eucharist: being fed.** The Body and Blood of Christ feed our Christian life all along the way.

> **In the Early Church**
> Adults who became Christians received all three sacraments on the same night, during the Easter Vigil. This is still the case today for adults who ask for Baptism.

1. **What does the word "initiation" mean?**

2. **Fill in the blanks: Baptism is .....; Confirmation is .....; the Eucharist is .....**

3. **Why do we need to be "fed" by the Eucharist often, and not just once?**

4. **Which sacrament of initiation did you receive most recently? What do you remember about it?**

Baptism

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Baptism is the first of the sacraments, the door that opens onto the others. The word "baptize" comes from Greek and means "to plunge." Whoever is baptized is plunged into the death and Resurrection of Christ: he or she dies to sin and is born to a new life.

The priest or deacon pours water on the head three times (or immerses the person in water), says the person's name, and then: "I baptize you in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit."

- **What Baptism gives:** it takes away original sin and all sins, and it makes us children of God, members of the Body of Christ, and temples of the Holy Spirit.
- **Only once:** Baptism marks the soul with a spiritual seal that can never be erased.
- **Jesus asked for it:** "Go, therefore, and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the holy Spirit" (Matthew 28:19).

1. **What does the word "baptize" mean?**

2. **What words does the priest or deacon say when baptizing?**

3. **Find out: when and where were you baptized? Who were your godparents?**

4. **Why do we say that Baptism is the "door" to the other sacraments?**

The Signs of Baptism

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Each gesture of Baptism has a meaning. Write the name of the sign that matches each explanation.

The lighted candle · The white garment · The Sign of the Cross · The Our Father · The water · The sacred chrism

_____

It washes and gives life: a sign of new life and of the forgiveness of sins.

_____

Traced on the forehead at the start of the celebration: you belong to Christ.

_____

Perfumed oil on the head: you are united to Christ, priest, prophet, and king.

_____

You have "put on Christ": a sign of new life and purity.

_____

It is lit from the Paschal candle: the risen Christ is the light of your life.

_____

Now a child of God, you can call him Father with all Christians.

1. **Which sign of Baptism do we find again at Confirmation?**

2. **Ask your parents if they kept your white garment or your baptismal candle. What did they do with it?**

The Eucharist

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



On the evening of Holy Thursday, during his Last Supper with his disciples, Jesus took bread, gave thanks, broke it, and gave it to them, telling them that it was his body, given for them. After the meal he took the cup: it was the new covenant in his blood, poured out for them. And he asked his disciples to do this in memory of him (see Luke 22:19-20).

At every Mass, through the words of the priest and the power of the Holy Spirit, the bread and wine truly become the Body and Blood of Christ. This is the Real Presence of Jesus.

- **"Eucharist":** this Greek word means "thanksgiving," in other words, "thank you."
- **Source and summit:** the Second Vatican Council teaches that the Eucharist is the source and summit of the whole Christian life.
- **The tabernacle:** it holds the consecrated Hosts for the sick and for Adoration.

1. **What does the word "Eucharist" mean?**

2. **What did Jesus do and say at the Last Supper?**

3. **What do the bread and wine become during Mass?**

4. **How do you prepare to receive Holy Communion?**

The Main Parts of the Mass

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The Mass has four main parts. Write the name of each part from its description.

The Liturgy of the Eucharist · The Concluding Rites · The Liturgy of the Word · The Introductory Rites

_____

The Entrance Chant, the Sign of the Cross, the Penitential Act (we ask for forgiveness), and the Gloria.

↓

_____

The readings, the Responsorial Psalm, the Gospel, the homily, the Creed, and the Prayer of the Faithful.

↓

_____

The Preparation of the Gifts, the Eucharistic Prayer with the consecration, the Our Father, the Lamb of God, and Holy Communion.

↓

_____

The blessing and the dismissal: the priest sends us out on mission in the peace of Christ.

1. **For you, what is the most important moment of the Mass? Why?**

2. **Why does the Mass end with a "dismissal" that sends us out into the world?**

3. **During which part of the Mass is it hardest for you to pay attention? What could you do?**

Confirmation, Sacrament of the Spirit

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Confirmation gives the fullness of the Holy Spirit, as he was given to the Apostles on the day of Pentecost. It does not add a "second Spirit": it makes the grace received at Baptism grow and brings it to completion.

The Catechism of the Catholic Church explains its effects; here they are in simple words (see CCC 1303):

- **Children of God:** it helps us feel even more like beloved children, who can call God "Abba," Father.
- **United to Christ:** it makes our friendship with Jesus stronger.
- **The gifts:** it makes the seven gifts of the Holy Spirit grow in us.
- **The Church:** it binds us more deeply to the community of Christians.
- **Witnesses:** it gives us the courage to live and share our faith, in words and in actions, without ever being ashamed of the Cross of Jesus.

1. **Does Confirmation give a "second Spirit"? Explain.**

2. **Which effect of Confirmation are you looking forward to most? Why?**

3. **In your everyday life, what does it mean "not to be ashamed of the Cross of Jesus"?**

Compare Baptism, Confirmation, and the Eucharist

Complete the table.

Name: _____

the bishop · only once · sacred chrism · food for the journey · "This is my body"

	Baptism	Confirmation	Eucharist
The sign	water		bread and wine
The words	"I baptize you in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit."	"Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit."	
Who celebrates?	the priest or deacon		the priest
How many times?		only once	often, at least every Sunday
What it gives	the life of a child of God	the strength of the Spirit to be a witness	

1. **What do Baptism and Confirmation have in common?**

2. **Why can the Eucharist be received often?**

Reconciliation

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The sacrament of Reconciliation has several names: the sacrament of forgiveness, of Penance, and of Confession. Through it, God forgives the sins committed after Baptism and reconciles us with himself and with the Church.

On the evening of Easter, the risen Jesus said to his Apostles: "Receive the holy Spirit. Whose sins you forgive are forgiven them, and whose sins you retain are retained" (John 20:22-23). Today, when you go to Confession, the priest gives God's forgiveness in the name of Christ.

- **1. Examination of conscience:** I look at my life in the light of God's love.
- **2. Sorrow (contrition):** I am truly sorry for my sins and I decide to change.
- **3. Confession:** I tell my sins to the priest. He must keep them completely secret (the seal of confession).
- **4. Absolution:** the priest gives me God's forgiveness in the name of Christ.
- **5. Penance:** I do what the priest has asked me to do to make up for my sins and start again.

1. **Give three names for this sacrament.**

2. **What are the five steps of Reconciliation?**

3. **Why can you trust the priest when you go to Confession?**

Getting Ready for Confession: Examination of Conscience

Take some quiet time. Look back on your life with these questions. This page is just for you: you don't have to show it to anyone.

Name: _____

Begin with this prayer: "Holy Spirit, give me light, so that I can see what has taken me away from God and from others."

With God:

- ☐ Did I take time to pray?
- ☐ Did I respect God's name?
- ☐ Did I go to Mass on Sunday?
- ☐ Was I ashamed of my faith?

With others:

- ☐ Did I obey my parents?
- ☐ Did I make fun of someone?
- ☐ Did I take what wasn't mine?
- ☐ Did I lie?
- ☐ Was I jealous or mean?
- ☐ Did I refuse to forgive?

With myself:

- ☐ Did I take care of my body?
- ☐ Did I do my work?
- ☐ Did I use screens well?
- ☐ Was I lazy or selfish?

What I want to tell the priest:

My prayer asking God for forgiveness:

My resolution after Confession:

The Anointing of the Sick

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Jesus took great care of the sick. He healed them, touched them, and raised them up. The Church continues this mission through the sacrament of the Anointing of the Sick. Saint James already wrote that anyone who is sick should call for the priests of the Church, so that they can pray over the person and anoint him or her with oil in the name of the Lord (see James 5:14-15).

This sacrament is not only for the dying: it is given to people who are seriously ill, to those about to have major surgery, and to elderly people whose strength is failing.

- **The gesture:** the priest lays his hands on the sick person in silence, then anoints the forehead and the hands with the oil of the sick.
- **What it gives:** peace, courage, and the strength of the Holy Spirit to live through illness with Christ; it also forgives sins; and sometimes, if God wills, it brings healing of the body.
- **Who gives it?** only priests and bishops.

1. **Who is the sacrament of the Anointing of the Sick for?**

2. **What does this sacrament give to the sick person?**

3. **Do you know someone who is sick or elderly? How can you take care of that person or pray for him or her?**

Matrimony

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

From the very beginning of the Bible, God creates man and woman to love each other and become one (see Genesis 2:24). Jesus made the union of man and woman a sacrament: their love becomes a sign of Christ's love for his Church.

In Matrimony, the spouses themselves give each other the sacrament by exchanging their consent before God, before the priest or deacon, and before witnesses. The priest or deacon receives their consent in the name of the Church and blesses the couple.

- **Forever:** marriage is a covenant that lasts a lifetime: Jesus teaches that no one must separate what God has joined (see Matthew 19:6).
- **Faithful:** the spouses promise to be faithful to each other.
- **Open to life:** they welcome the children God gives them and raise them in the faith.
- **A domestic church:** the Christian family is a little Church where we learn to pray and to love.

1. **Who gives the sacrament of Matrimony?**

2. **What do the spouses promise each other?**

3. **What is a "domestic church"? How can your family be one?**

Holy Orders

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The sacrament of Holy Orders consecrates men to serve the Church in the name of Christ. It has three degrees: the episcopate (bishops), the presbyterate (priests), and the diaconate (deacons). The bishop confers this sacrament by the laying on of hands and the prayer of consecration.

The priest no longer belongs to himself: he acts "in the person of Christ" when he celebrates Mass and gives forgiveness. He proclaims the Word of God and takes care of the people entrusted to him.

- **The bishop:** a successor of the Apostles, he leads a diocese.
- **The priest:** a co-worker of the bishop, he celebrates the sacraments and serves a parish, often as its pastor.
- **The deacon:** he is ordained for service: he baptizes, proclaims the Gospel, preaches, witnesses marriages, leads funerals, and serves the poor. A permanent deacon may be married.

1. **What are the three degrees of the sacrament of Holy Orders?**

2. **Which gesture of Holy Orders do we also find at Confirmation?**

3. **Which priest or deacon do you know? What question would you like to ask him about his vocation?**

4. **Pray for the priests of your parish. Write your prayer.**

Each Sacrament and Its Sign

Draw a line from each item on the left to its match on the right.

Name: _____

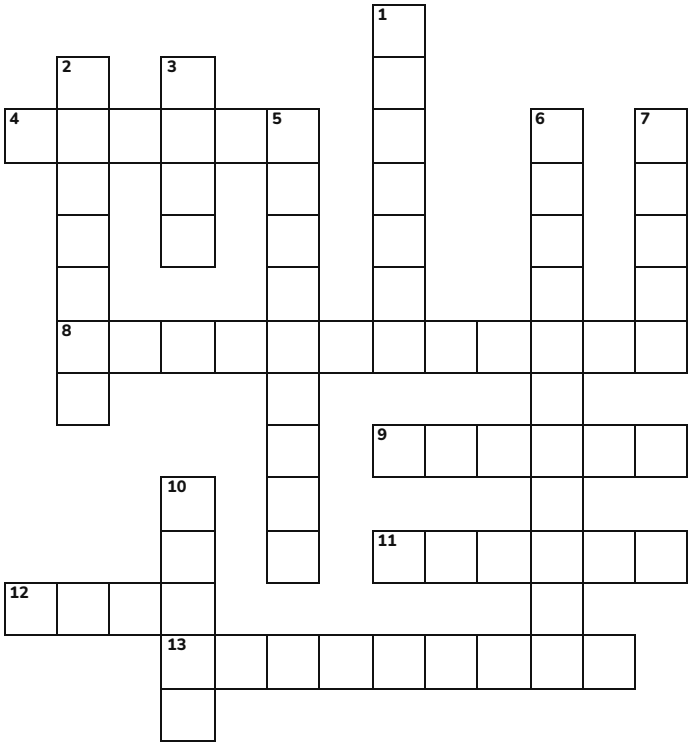
Baptism	the words of forgiveness (absolution)
Confirmation	water
Eucharist	the laying on of hands by the bishop
Reconciliation	the oil of the sick
Anointing of the Sick	sacred chrism
Matrimony	bread and wine
Holy Orders	the exchange of consent

1. **Which sacraments use oil?**

The Sacraments

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

4. Sacred ...: the oil of Confirmation. (6)

8. The sacrament of the Holy Spirit that you are preparing for. (12)

9. Holy ...: the sacrament of bishops, priests, and deacons. (6)

11. He celebrates Mass and gives God's forgiveness. (6)

12. The bread consecrated at Mass. (4)

13. This Greek word means "thanksgiving." (9)

Down ↓

1. The first sacrament, the door to the Christian life. (7)

2. The cup that holds the wine at Mass. (7)

3. The Anointing of the ... (4)

5. The spouses give each other this sacrament. (9)

6. The sacrament of Reconciliation gives God's ... (11)

7. The number of sacraments. (5)

10. The sign of Baptism. (5)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

The Sacraments Quiz

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

1. **How many sacraments are there?**
   ☐ three ☐ seven ☐ ten
2. **Which sacrament is the "door" to the others?**
   ☐ the Eucharist ☐ Baptism ☐ Matrimony
3. **What does "Eucharist" mean?**
   ☐ meal ☐ thanksgiving ☐ prayer
4. **Who gives the sacrament of Matrimony?**
   ☐ the priest ☐ the spouses ☐ the witnesses
5. **Which are the sacraments of healing?**
   ☐ Baptism and Confirmation ☐ Reconciliation and Anointing of the Sick ☐ Holy Orders and Matrimony
6. **Can the priest repeat what he hears in Confession?**
   ☐ yes, to the bishop ☐ no, never ☐ only to the parents
7. **How many degrees does the sacrament of Holy Orders have?**
   ☐ one ☐ two ☐ three
8. **Where are the consecrated Hosts kept?**
   ☐ in the tabernacle ☐ in the sacristy ☐ in the ambo
9. **Which sacrament would you like to know better? Why?**

True or False About the Sacraments

Mark each statement T (true) or F (false). Then rewrite the false ones to make them true.

Name: _____

1	A sacrament is a visible sign through which Christ gives us his life.	**T**	**F**
2	You can be baptized several times.	**T**	**F**
3	Sunday Mass celebrates the Resurrection of Christ.	**T**	**F**
4	Only the bishop can give God's forgiveness.	**T**	**F**
5	The Anointing of the Sick is only for the dying.	**T**	**F**
6	A deacon can celebrate a baptism.	**T**	**F**
7	Jesus is truly present in the consecrated Host.	**T**	**F**
8	Baptism, Confirmation, and Holy Orders are received only once.	**T**	**F**
9	You can receive Holy Communion without being baptized.	**T**	**F**

My corrections:

The Holy Oils and the Chrism Mass

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

During Holy Week, the bishop gathers the priests of his diocese at the cathedral for the Chrism Mass. There he blesses the oils that will be used in the parishes all year long, and he consecrates the sacred chrism. The priests also renew the promises they made at their ordination.

- **The oil of catechumens:** it strengthens those preparing for Baptism in their fight against evil.
- **The oil of the sick:** it is used for the sacrament of the Anointing of the Sick.
- **The sacred chrism:** olive oil mixed with perfume. It is used at Baptism, at Confirmation, for the ordination of priests and bishops, and to consecrate altars and churches.

> **Did You Know?**
> The word "chrism" comes from the Greek "chrisma," which also gave us the word "Christ": "the one who was anointed." Anyone marked with sacred chrism is called to spread the pleasing fragrance of Christ all around.

1. **What are the three oils blessed at the Chrism Mass?**

2. **Which oil will you be anointed with on the day of your Confirmation?**

3. **Why do we use a perfumed oil? What does it mean for your life?**

4. **Find out: when and where is the Chrism Mass celebrated in your diocese?**

A 12-Year-Old Friend Wants to Be Baptized

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

Ethan is 12. His parents are not believers, and he has never been baptized. Ever since he started going with his friend Gabe to the parish youth group, he has been asking lots of questions. One day he tells Gabe: "I'd like to be baptized too. But it's too late, isn't it? That's for babies."

To Help You

It is never too late to be baptized. School-age children who ask for it follow a path of preparation in the parish, called the catechumenate, with steps celebrated with the community. Then they can receive Baptism, Confirmation, and the Eucharist, often in the same celebration at the Easter Vigil. Their parents must give their permission.

1. **What can Gabe answer Ethan?**

2. **Whom can Ethan talk to in order to start his preparation?**

3. **How can Gabe walk with Ethan on this journey?**

4. **What strikes you about Ethan's wish? What does it tell you about your own Baptism?**

Why Go to Mass Every Sunday?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Jake: "I can pray to God at home. I don't need to go to Mass." Claire: "Mass isn't just praying: it's meeting Jesus and other Christians."

What the Church Says

Sunday is the day of the Lord's Resurrection. Catholics are called to take part in Mass every Sunday and on holy days of obligation (see CCC 2180-2181). There Christ feeds his people with his Word and his Body.

1. **What does Mass give you that praying alone at home does not?**

2. **What helps you go to Mass on Sunday? What keeps you from going?**

3. **How could you make Mass more alive for you (taking part, singing, serving...)?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

The Objects Used at Mass

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Write the name of each object or piece of church furniture from its description.

The Paschal candle · The ciborium · The sanctuary lamp · The tabernacle · The altar · The paten · The ambo · The chalice

_____

The table where the priest celebrates the sacrifice of Christ.

_____

The stand from which the Word of God is proclaimed.

_____

The cup in which the wine becomes the Blood of Christ.

_____

The small plate that holds the large Host.

_____

The container that holds the Hosts for Communion.

_____

The small box where the consecrated Hosts are kept.

_____

A small light, often red, that shows that Jesus is present in the tabernacle.

_____

The large candle lit at Easter, a sign of the risen Christ.

1. **At your next Mass, look for three of these objects. Which ones did you find?**

My Life With the Sacraments

Take stock of the sacraments you have received and of those still ahead of you.

Name: _____

My Baptism: date: _____ **Place:** _____

My First Communion: date: _____ **Place:** _____

My First Reconciliation: date: _____ **My Confirmation: planned date:** _____

The sacrament I receive most often:

What the Eucharist gives me:

What Reconciliation gives me:

What I hope for from Confirmation:

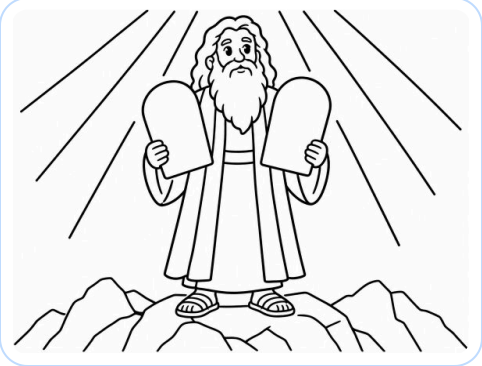
What I discovered about the sacraments in this part:

My resolution: when will I next receive God's forgiveness and the Eucharist?

Moses and the Gift of the Law at Sinai

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



After freeing his people from slavery in Egypt, God leads them through the desert to Mount Sinai. There he makes a covenant with them. Moses goes up the mountain and receives from God the Ten Commandments, written on two tablets of stone (see Exodus 19-20).

The Commandments begin with a reminder: God presents himself as the Lord who brought his people out of Egypt, the house of slavery (see Exodus 20:2). Before giving rules, God reminds them that he set his people free. The Commandments are the path to staying free.

- **The Decalogue:** this is another name for the Ten Commandments; it means "ten words."
- **The Covenant:** a commitment of love between God and his people: God promises to be their God, and the people promise to be his people.
- **Jesus:** he does not abolish the Commandments; he fulfills them and gives them their full depth (see Matthew 5:17).

1. **Where did Moses receive the Ten Commandments?**

2. **Why does God first remind the people that he set them free?**

3. **What does the word "Decalogue" mean?**

4. **How can the Commandments make us free?**

From Egypt to the Promised Land

Complete the story of the Exodus with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Passover · Sinai · forty · slaves · burning · Promised · Red · Pharaoh · manna

Step 1 The Hebrews are _____ in Egypt.

Step 2 Baby Moses is saved from the water by the daughter of _____ .

Step 3 God speaks to Moses from a _____ bush that does not burn up.

Step 4 After the ten plagues, the people celebrate the _____ and leave Egypt.

Step 5 The people cross the _____ Sea on dry land.

Step 6 In the desert, God feeds his people with _____ .

Step 7 On Mount _____ , God gives the Ten Commandments.

Step 8 The people walk in the desert for _____ years.

Step 9 Joshua leads the people into the _____ Land.

1. **Which episode of the Exodus do you like best? Why?**

The Two Tablets: Love God, Love Your Neighbor

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The Ten Commandments were written on two tablets of stone. The first commandments are about our love for God; the others, about our love for our neighbor. Jesus summed them up in two commandments:

"You shall love the Lord, your God, with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your mind. This is the greatest and the first commandment. The second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself. The whole law and the prophets depend on these two commandments."

(Matthew 22:37-40)

Commandments 1 to 3 · Commandments 4 to 10

First tablet: love God

_____

Second tablet: love your neighbor

_____

A commandment from the first tablet

_____

_____

A commandment from the second tablet

_____

_____

1. **Why can't love of God and love of neighbor be separated?**

2. **Can we say we love God if we don't love others? Explain.**

The 1st Commandment: "I am the LORD your God: you shall not have strange Gods before me"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



God is the one true God. To adore him is to recognize that he is God, the Creator, and to give him first place in your life. We adore him through prayer, praise, and trust.

- **What goes against it:** putting money, fame, screens, or yourself before God; superstition, magic, fortune-telling.
- **What I can do:** beginning and ending my day with a prayer; thanking God for what he gives me.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 2nd Commandment: "You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



God's name is holy. In the Bible, a name stands for the person. To respect God's name is to respect God himself. We say it to pray and to praise, never to swear, mock, or insult.

- **What goes against it:** blasphemy (speaking of God with contempt or insults), swearing, false oaths.
- **What I can do:** saying the name of Jesus with love; making the Sign of the Cross with respect.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 3rd Commandment: "Remember to keep holy the LORD'S Day"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Sunday is the day of Christ's Resurrection. To keep it holy is to take part in Mass, to rest, and to make time for family, for others, and for God.

- **What goes against it:** missing Mass without a serious reason; turning Sunday into a day like any other.
- **What I can do:** going to Mass with my family; visiting someone who is alone; sharing a good time.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

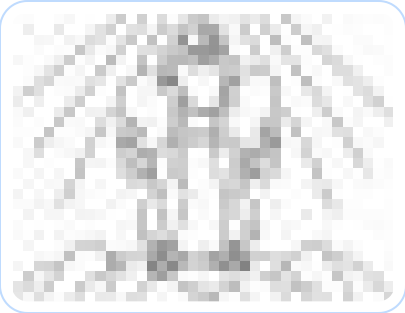
3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 4th Commandment: "Honor your father and your mother"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



To honor your parents is to respect them, love them, obey them while you live in their home, and take care of them when they grow old. This commandment also covers grandparents, teachers, and those in authority.

- **What goes against it:** talking back, disobedience, ingratitude.
- **What I can do:** saying thank you; helping at home without being asked; praying for my family.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 5th Commandment: "You shall not kill"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Human life is sacred from beginning to end, because it comes from God. This commandment asks us to respect and protect all life, our own and that of others, from conception to natural death.

- **What goes against it:** violence, hitting, bullying, hatred, revenge, and anything that puts health and life in danger.
- **What I can do:** standing up for someone who is attacked; taking care of my body; calming down a fight.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 6th Commandment: "You shall not commit adultery"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



God created man and woman to love each other. This commandment asks us to respect our own body and the bodies of others, and to be faithful. For married couples, it means faithfulness in marriage. For you, it means learning to love truly, with respect and modesty.

- **What goes against it:** unfaithfulness, using another person's body like an object, images or words that spoil the beauty of love.
- **What I can do:** respecting my body and the bodies of others; refusing mockery and degrading images.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 7th Commandment: "You shall not steal"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

This commandment asks us to respect other people's belongings and to share. The goods of the earth are meant for everyone: we must take care of them and think of the poorest.

- **What goes against it:** stealing, cheating, damaging what belongs to others, not giving back what we borrowed, wasting.
- **What I can do:** giving back what I borrowed; sharing my snack; giving to a charity.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 8th Commandment: "You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

God is Truth. This commandment asks us to be truthful in our words and actions, and to respect other people's good name.

- **What goes against it:** lying, calumny (saying false bad things about someone), detraction (repeating true bad things for no good reason), rumors.
- **What I can do:** telling the truth even when it is hard; refusing to spread a rumor.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 9th Commandment: "You shall not covet your neighbor's wife"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

To covet is to strongly desire what belongs to someone else. This commandment invites us to keep a pure heart, to respect couples and families, and to look at others with respect.

- **What goes against it:** looks and thoughts that turn another person into an object, jealousy that destroys relationships.
- **What I can do:** asking God for a pure heart; choosing carefully what I watch.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The 10th Commandment: "You shall not covet your neighbor's goods"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

This commandment touches the heart: it invites us not to envy what others have and to be happy with what we have. Jealousy makes us sad; gratitude makes us happy.

- **What goes against it:** envy, jealousy, always wanting more, constantly comparing ourselves with others.
- **What I can do:** thanking God for three things every night; being glad when others are happy.

1. **Explain this commandment in your own words.**

2. **Give an example of a situation, at school or at home, where this commandment is at stake.**

3. **Is this commandment easy or hard for you to live? Why?**

4. **My resolution for this week:**

The Commandments and Real-Life Situations

Draw a line from each situation to the commandment that is at stake.

Name: _____

I say "Oh my God!" for no reason, like a swear word.	8th Commandment
I copy a classmate's homework and pass it off as mine.	3rd Commandment
I sulk when my mom asks me to clean up.	10th Commandment
I repeat a rumor about a girl in my class.	2nd Commandment
I'd rather sleep in than go to Mass.	4th Commandment
I'm jealous of my friend's new phone.	1st Commandment
I spend all my free time on screens and forget God.	7th Commandment

Lying to Protect a Friend?

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

Harper and Leo have been friends since kindergarten. At recess, Leo broke a window of the gym playing ball where it wasn't allowed. The principal asks Harper: "You were there. Do you know who did this?"

Leo begged her: "Don't say anything, or my parents will punish me."

What the Church Says

The 8th Commandment asks us to tell the truth. To lie is to say what is false in order to deceive. But not everyone has a right to know everything: sometimes we can wisely keep silent. True friendship helps the other person do good, not hide wrongdoing.

1. **What are Harper's options?**

2. **If Harper lies to protect Leo, is she really helping him? Why?**

3. **What could she say to Leo before she answers the principal?**

4. **Which gift of the Holy Spirit can help Harper?**

Sports, Video Games, and Sunday Mass

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

Tom plays on a sports team. This season, several games are on Sunday morning. On the other Sundays, he would rather play video games online with his friends.

His mom reminds him that Mass is at 10:30 a.m. Tom sighs: "God will understand. He's nice. Besides, I'll pray tonight."

To Help You

The 3rd Commandment invites us to keep Sunday holy. There are often other Mass times (the Saturday evening Vigil Mass or Sunday evening). Sunday is also a day for rest, family, and getting together.

1. **What do you think of Tom's words: "God will understand"?**

2. **What practical solutions can Tom find so he doesn't miss Mass?**

3. **How could he live his Sunday as a truly different day?**

4. **And you, what sometimes keeps you from going to Mass? What can you do?**

Bullying in the Classroom

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

Since the start of the school year, Caleb has been a target of mockery in class. Kids imitate the way he talks, hide his backpack, and a group has started an online chat to make fun of him. Caleb doesn't say anything, but he gets more and more stomachaches in the morning.

Camila sees everything. She doesn't take part, but she doesn't say anything either: "It's not my problem, and if I speak up, they'll go after me."

What the Church Says

The 5th Commandment protects the life and dignity of every person. Repeated mockery and bullying hurt deeply. Keeping silent in the face of evil already lets it grow. Jesus always stood up for the weakest. Bullying should always be reported to a trusted adult.

1. **Why does bullying go against the 5th Commandment?**

2. **What do you think of Camila's attitude?**

3. **What could Camila do to help Caleb without putting herself in danger?**

4. **Which gift of the Holy Spirit can you ask for to have this courage?**

The Wallet Found on the Street

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

On his way home from school, Noah finds a wallet on the ground with $20 and a bus pass belonging to an eighth grader. Nobody saw him pick it up.

His friend says: "Keep the money, she's the one who lost it. Finders keepers!"

To Help You

The 7th Commandment asks us to respect what belongs to others. Keeping something we found when we could give it back is like taking it. Giving back what we found is an act of justice and charity.

1. **"Finders keepers!" Do you agree? Why?**

2. **What can Noah do to give the wallet back?**

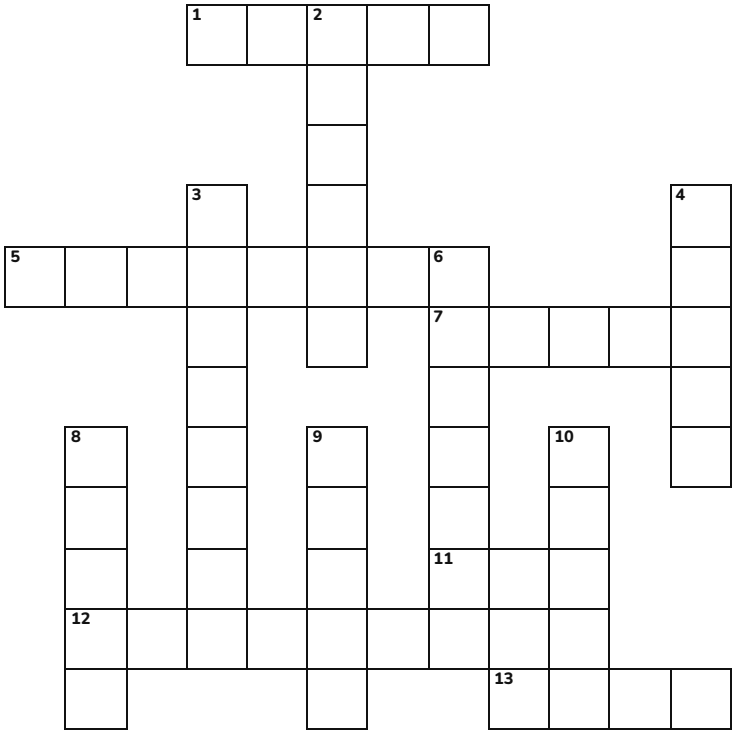
3. **Imagine how the owner feels when she gets her wallet back.**

4. **Have you ever been in a similar situation? What did you do?**

The Ten Commandments

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

1. He received the Ten Commandments. (5)

5. The commitment of love between God and his people. (8)

7. We ... God alone: we worship and praise him. (5)

11. The number of Commandments. (3)

12. The 4th Commandment asks you to honor your ... (7)

13. "You shall not ..." (5th Commandment). (4)

Down ↓

2. The Lord's Day, which we keep holy. (6)

3. Jesus asks you to love your ... as yourself. (8)

4. "You shall not ..." (7th Commandment). (5)

6. The Commandments were written on two ... of stone. (7)

8. The country from which God freed his people. (5)

9. The 8th Commandment forbids ... (saying what is false in order to deceive). (5)

10. The mountain where God gave the Law. (5)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

The Commandments Quiz

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

1. **How many Commandments are there?**
   ☐ seven ☐ ten ☐ twelve
2. **What is another name for the Ten Commandments?**
   ☐ the Decalogue ☐ the Creed ☐ the Gospel
3. **What were they written on?**
   ☐ a papyrus scroll ☐ two tablets of stone ☐ a wooden door
4. **Which commandment talks about Sunday?**
   ☐ the 1st ☐ the 3rd ☐ the 7th
5. **Spreading a false rumor about someone goes against the…**
   ☐ 5th Commandment ☐ 8th Commandment ☐ 10th Commandment
6. **Jesus sums up the Commandments in…**
   ☐ a single word ☐ two commandments of love ☐ three prayers
7. **Being jealous of what others have goes against the…**
   ☐ 10th Commandment ☐ 2nd Commandment ☐ 4th Commandment
8. **Bullying goes against the…**
   ☐ 3rd Commandment ☐ 5th Commandment ☐ 9th Commandment
9. **Which commandment seems most important to you for living together? Why?**

The Greatest Commandment (Matthew 22:37-40)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

A scholar of the law asks Jesus which commandment in the law is the greatest. Jesus does not pick just one of the ten: he sums them all up in two.

- **Love God with all your heart:** give him first place, pray to him, trust him.
- **Love your neighbor as yourself:** want for others the good you want for yourself.
- **As yourself:** love yourself too, as a person wanted and loved by God.

> **Jesus' Answer**
> "You shall love the Lord, your God, with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your mind. This is the greatest and the first commandment. The second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself. The whole law and the prophets depend on these two commandments."
>
> Matthew 22:37-40

1. **What are the two commandments that sum up the whole Law?**

2. **What does it mean to love God with all your heart, soul, and mind?**

3. **Who is your "neighbor"? Give some examples.**

4. **Why should you also love yourself?**

The New Commandment: "Love One Another"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



On the evening of the Last Supper, after washing his disciples' feet, Jesus gives them his farewell words. He gives them a "new" commandment: to love one another as he has loved them, that is, even to the point of giving his life.

- **Why "new"?** because from now on the measure of love is the love of Jesus himself, who kneels down to wash feet and gives his life.
- **The sign of Christians:** it is not a cross around the neck, but love for one another.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "I give you a new commandment: love one another. As I have loved you, so you also should love one another. This is how all will know that you are my disciples, if you have love for one another."
>
> John 13:34-35

1. **What is "new" about this commandment of Jesus?**

2. **According to Jesus, how will people recognize his disciples?**

3. **How can you "wash the feet" of others today, that is, serve them?**

The Commandments: Freedom or Rules?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Hugo: "The Commandments are just a list of things you can't do. We're not free!" Isabel: "It's like the rules of the road: without them, everyone would have accidents."

To Help You

God gave the Commandments to a people he had just freed from slavery. They are like the guardrails on a bridge: they don't keep us from moving forward; they keep us from falling. Being free doesn't mean doing whatever we want; it means being able to choose what is good.

1. **Whom do you agree with: Hugo or Isabel? Why?**

2. **What would happen in your class if no one respected the 7th or the 8th Commandment?**

3. **What is true freedom, in your opinion?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

The 8th Commandment on Social Media

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

In the class group chat, someone posts a photo of Jade taken in the cafeteria, with a mocking caption and a false rumor: "She cheated on the history test." Within minutes, dozens of students share it and comment on it.

Arthur hesitates: he thinks it's funny, but he knows it isn't true.

What the Church Says

The 8th Commandment forbids calumny (saying false bad things about someone) and detraction (repeating bad things for no good reason). Online, what we write travels very fast and very far, and it stays online for a long time. Each of us is responsible for what we post, comment on, and share.

1. **Why does this post go against the 8th Commandment?**

2. **What can Arthur actually do?**

3. **Write three rules for being an honest and respectful Christian online.**

4. **What can be done to repair the harm done to Jade?**

Examination of Conscience With the Commandments

Look back on your life with each commandment. Write down what is going well and what needs to improve. This page is just for you.

Name: _____

1. Does God have first place in my life? Did I pray?

2. Did I respect God's name?

3. Did I keep Sunday holy?

4. Did I respect and help my parents?

5. Was I violent, mean, or mocking? Did I take care of my life?

6. Did I respect my body and the bodies of others?

7. Did I take or damage what wasn't mine?

8. Did I lie or spread rumors?

9. Did I look at others with respect?

10. Was I jealous or envious?

What I want to ask God's forgiveness for:

What I want to change:

My Rule of Life

A rule of life is a short list of simple resolutions for living as a friend of Jesus. Write yours.

Name: _____

Many saints wrote a rule of life: Saint Benedict for his monks, Saint Francis for his brothers. Yours should be short, practical, and doable.

With God (prayer, Mass, reading the Bible):

With my family:

With my friends and at school:

With screens:

With those who are lonely, poor, or sick:

The commandment that will guide me first:

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

The Sermon on the Mount (Matthew 5:1-12)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



At the beginning of his public life, Jesus sees the crowds, goes up the mountain, and sits down. His disciples come to him, and he begins to teach them. This is the "Sermon on the Mount" (Matthew 5-7). It begins with eight sayings about happiness: the Beatitudes.

"Beatitude" means "perfect happiness." Jesus announces that true happiness does not come from wealth, power, or success, but from a heart turned toward God and toward others. The Beatitudes are like a portrait of Jesus himself.

- **Moses and Jesus:** Moses received the Law on a mountain; Jesus gives the new Law on a mountain.
- **How many?** Matthew lists eight, followed by a saying addressed directly to the disciples (see Matthew 5:11-12).

The First Beatitude

"Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven."

Matthew 5:3

1. **What does the word "beatitude" mean?**

2. **What connection can you make between Moses at Sinai and Jesus on the mountain?**

3. **According to the world, what makes people happy? According to Jesus?**

"Blessed are the poor in spirit"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Being poor in spirit means not putting your trust in money or in your own strength, but in God. It means knowing that you need him and that you need others.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Francis of Assisi left everything to live in poverty, and he was full of joy.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven."
>
> Matthew 5:3

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are they who mourn"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Jesus does not say that sadness is good, but that God is close to those who suffer and will comfort them. He also calls us to weep with those who weep.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Bernadette, often sick and misunderstood, found her comfort with Mary.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are they who mourn, for they will be comforted."
>
> Matthew 5:4

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are the meek"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The meek are not weak. They refuse violence and anger and answer evil with good. Jesus calls himself meek and humble of heart (see Matthew 11:29).

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Francis de Sales had a quick temper, yet he became the saint of gentleness.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are the meek, for they will inherit the land."
>
> Matthew 5:5

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

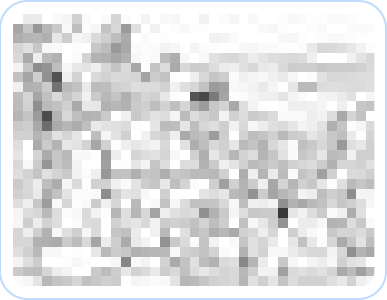
2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



To hunger and thirst for righteousness is to long for everyone to be treated with respect, and to act for that. It is also to long to live according to God's will.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Louis, King of France, judged cases under an oak tree, listening to the humblest people.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they will be satisfied."
>
> Matthew 5:6

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

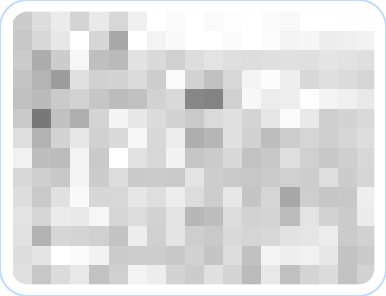
2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are the merciful"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Being merciful means having a heart that is touched by the misery of others, that forgives and helps. It means doing for others what God does for us.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Teresa of Calcutta took in dying people abandoned in the streets.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are the merciful, for they will be shown mercy."
>
> Matthew 5:7

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are the clean of heart"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



A clean heart is a simple and honest heart, without hypocrisy or hidden motives, that seeks God and looks at others with respect.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Carlo Acutis, a teenager like you, wanted to keep a pure heart and went to Mass every day.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are the clean of heart, for they will see God."
>
> Matthew 5:8

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are the peacemakers"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

A peacemaker doesn't just love peace: he or she builds it, by reconciling people, calming quarrels, and forgiving.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saint Catherine of Siena traveled a great deal to bring peace between the states of her time, and she urged the Pope to return to Rome.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God."
>
> Matthew 5:9

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

"Blessed are they who are persecuted for the sake of righteousness"

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Some Christians suffer because they stay faithful to Christ and stand up for what is right. Jesus promises them the Kingdom. Even today, Christians are persecuted around the world.

- **A saint who lived it:** Saints Peter and Paul died as martyrs in Rome out of faithfulness to Christ.

> **Jesus' Words**
> "Blessed are they who are persecuted for the sake of righteousness, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven."
> Matthew 5:10

1. **Explain this beatitude in your own words.**

2. **Who around you, or in the news, lives this beatitude?**

3. **How can you live it this week, in practice?**

The Beatitudes and Their Promises

Draw a line from each beatitude to its promise (Matthew 5:3-9). The eighth beatitude (Matthew 5:10) has the same promise as the first.

Name: _____

Blessed are the poor in spirit,	for they will be comforted.
Blessed are they who mourn,	for they will inherit the land.
Blessed are the meek,	for they will be satisfied.
Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness,	for they will see God.
Blessed are the merciful,	for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
Blessed are the clean of heart,	for they will be called children of God.
Blessed are the peacemakers,	for they will be shown mercy.

The Beatitudes

Fill in the Beatitudes with the words from the box, then learn them by heart.

Name: _____

comforted · meek · righteousness · persecuted · clean · peacemakers · merciful · poor

Blessed are the _____ in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Blessed are they who mourn, for they will be _____ .

Blessed are the _____ , for they will inherit the land.

Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for _____ , for they will be satisfied.

Blessed are the _____ , for they will be shown mercy.

Blessed are the _____ of heart, for they will see God.

Blessed are the _____ , for they will be called children of God.

Blessed are they who are _____ for the sake of righteousness, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Matthew 5:3-10

1. **Which beatitude seems hardest to live? Why?**

Being a Peacemaker on the Playground

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

At recess, a fight breaks out between Malik and Theo over a disputed goal. Insults fly. The others form a circle and shout: "Fight! Fight!" Some film it with their phones.

Sofia knows both boys well. She knows Malik has been on edge ever since his parents split up.

To Help You

"Blessed are the peacemakers, for they will be called children of God" (Matthew 5:9). Building peace takes courage, gentleness, and good judgment: separating the two, listening to each one, looking for a fair solution, and sometimes calling an adult.

1. **What could Sofia do to be a peacemaker?**

2. **Why is filming the fight a bad idea?**

3. **What can you say to Malik and Theo after the fight to help them make up?**

4. **Tell about a time when you were a peacemaker, or could have been one.**

Blessed, Really? Happiness According to Jesus

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

An ad says: "Happiness is having the latest phone." Jesus says: "Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." Who is right?

1. **What is happiness, for you?**

2. **Why doesn't the happiness offered by ads last?**

3. **Do the Beatitudes promise happiness only after death, or also now?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

My Favorite Beatitude

Review this part on the Beatitudes.

Name: _____

My favorite beatitude (copy it out):

Why I chose it:

A person who lives it, and how:

I write my own beatitude for today: "Blessed are those who... for..."

I illustrate my beatitude:

My prayer to Jesus:

Theological Virtues and Cardinal Virtues

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

A virtue is a habit of doing good that grows stronger with practice (see CCC 1803). The three theological virtues come directly from God and turn us toward him. The four cardinal virtues are like the "hinges" (in Latin, *cardo*) on which the whole moral life turns. Write the name of each virtue.

Fortitude · Justice · Temperance · Hope · Charity · Faith · Prudence

_____

Theological virtue: believing in God and in all that he has revealed.

_____

Theological virtue: longing for heaven and trusting in Christ's promises.

_____

Theological virtue: loving God above all things and our neighbor as ourselves.

_____

Cardinal virtue: seeing what is truly good and choosing the right way to do it.

_____

Cardinal virtue: giving God and others what is due to them.

_____

Cardinal virtue: holding firm in hard times and continuing to do good.

_____

Cardinal virtue: keeping balance and self-control with pleasures.

And me?

The virtue I want to work on: .....

1. **Why are the first three virtues called "theological"?**

Faith

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Faith is the virtue by which we believe in God and in all that he has told us and revealed. To believe is not only to know things about God: it is to trust him and place your life in his hands. Faith is a gift from God and, at the same time, our free answer to him. It grows when we feed it with prayer, the Word of God, and the sacraments.

- **Its family:** theological virtue
- **In my life:** keep praying even when I don't feel anything; dare to say that I am a Christian.
- **A model:** Abraham, the "father of believers," left his homeland trusting in God's promise (see Genesis 12).

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

Hope

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Hope is the virtue by which we long for heaven and eternal life, putting our trust in Christ's promises and in the help of the Holy Spirit. It is not just optimism ("everything will be fine"): it is the certainty that God is faithful and that love has the last word, even in hard times.

- **Its family:** theological virtue
- **In my life:** not give up after a failure; pray about a difficult situation instead of giving up.
- **A model:** Saint Bernadette, often sick, kept her peace by hoping for heaven.

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

Charity

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Charity is the virtue by which we love God above all things, for his own sake, and our neighbor as ourselves, for the love of God. Saint Paul says it is the greatest of the virtues (see 1 Corinthians 13:13). It is not only a feeling: it shows itself in concrete acts of service and forgiveness.

- **Its family:** theological virtue, the greatest of the three
- **In my life:** help without waiting for thanks; forgive someone who hurt me.
- **A model:** Saint Teresa of Calcutta served the poorest of the poor with boundless love.

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

The Hymn to Love (1 Corinthians 13)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

In his first letter to the Christians of Corinth, Saint Paul wrote one of the most beautiful texts about love. It is often read at weddings, but it speaks to everyone. Here, "love" is the virtue we call charity.

- **Paul's last word:** "So faith, hope, love remain, these three; but the greatest of these is love" (1 Corinthians 13:13)

> **The Word of God**
> Love is patient, love is kind. It is not jealous, [love] is not pompous, it is not inflated, it is not rude, it does not seek its own interests, it is not quick-tempered, it does not brood over injury, it does not rejoice over wrongdoing but rejoices with the truth. It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things. Love never fails.
>
> 1 Corinthians 13:4-8

1. **Underline in the text what love does, and circle what it does not do.**

2. **Which sentence speaks to you the most? Why?**

3. **Replace "love" with your name: "... is patient, ... is kind..." Which sentence is the hardest for you?**

4. **Why is love (charity) "the greatest of these"?**

Prudence

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Prudence is not fear or shyness! It is the virtue that helps us see clearly: to recognize, in each situation, what is truly good, and to choose the right way to do it. It is called the "charioteer of the virtues" because it guides all the others. To be prudent, you need to think, ask for advice, and pray.

- **Its family:** cardinal virtue, the "charioteer" of the virtues
- **In my life:** not answer a hurtful message right away; ask for advice before an important decision.
- **A model:** Saint Joseph listened to God in his dreams and made the right decisions to protect Mary and Jesus.

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

Justice

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Justice is the virtue that leads us to give God and others what is due to them. Toward God, it is the virtue of religion: adoring him and praying to him. Toward others, it means respecting everyone's rights, being honest, keeping our promises, and caring for the common good.

- **Its family:** cardinal virtue
- **In my life:** share fairly; not cheat; stand up for someone who is treated unfairly.
- **A model:** Saint Louis, King of France, ruled justly by listening to everyone, rich or poor.

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

Fortitude

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Fortitude, or courage, is the virtue that helps us hold firm in hard times and keep doing good, even when it is difficult or when people make fun of us. It helps us overcome fear and resist temptation. The Holy Spirit's gift of fortitude makes it even stronger.

- **Its family:** cardinal virtue
- **In my life:** finish what I started; say no when the whole group says yes to something wrong.
- **A model:** Saint Joan of Arc stayed faithful to her mission to the very end.

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

Temperance

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Temperance is the virtue that helps us keep balance in using pleasant things: food, games, screens, shopping. It makes us masters of our wants instead of their slaves. It does not take away pleasure: it balances it so that we stay free.

- **Its family:** cardinal virtue
- **In my life:** set a screen-time limit and stick to it; not take a third helping of dessert.
- **A model:** Saint Carlo Acutis limited his own video game time so that he could stay free.

1. **Explain this virtue in your own words.**

2. **Tell about a time when you needed this virtue.**

3. **What helps me live it / what gets in the way:**

4. **My small step to help it grow this week:**

The Virtues and Their Examples

Draw a line from each item on the left to its match on the right.

Name: _____

Faith	I hold firm when someone pushes me to do wrong.
Hope	I help my brother without expecting anything back.
Charity	I share the candy equally.
Prudence	I don't lose heart: God is faithful.
Justice	I think and ask for advice before deciding.
Fortitude	I turn off the game console at the agreed time.
Temperance	I trust God and I pray even when it is hard.

Which Virtue for This Choice?

Read the four situations. For each one, choose the virtue that would help the most and explain why.

Name: _____

Four Situations

A. Paul promised to help his grandfather on Saturday, but his friends invite him to the movies.

B. Lena gets a mean message. She wants to answer right away with an insult.

C. Adam failed his math test and tells himself: "I'm hopeless, I'll never get it."

D. Zoe spends her evenings on her phone and can't sleep anymore.

The 7 Virtues

faith · hope · charity · prudence · justice · fortitude · temperance

1. **Situation A: which virtue? Why?**

2. **Situation B: which virtue? Why?**

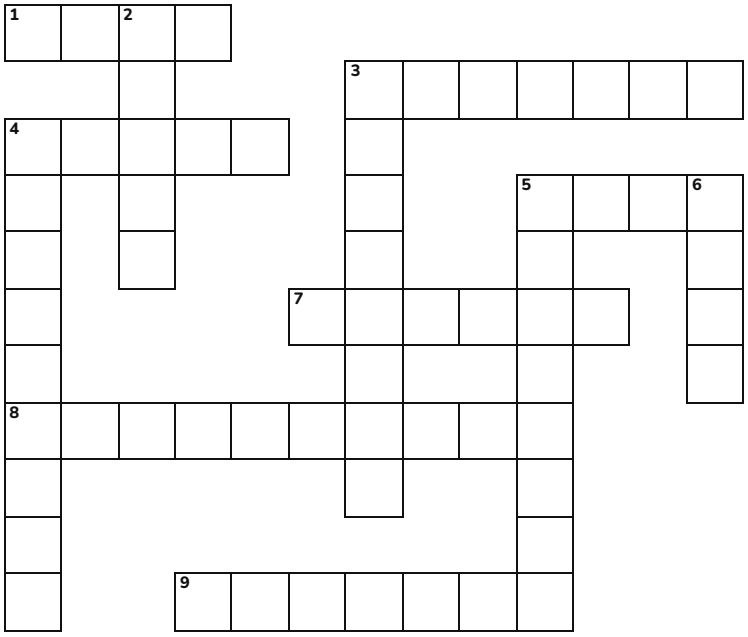
3. **Situation C: which virtue? Why?**

4. **Situation D: which virtue? Why?**

The Virtues

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

1. Longing for heaven and counting on Christ's promises. (4)

3. The greatest of the three theological virtues. (7)

4. Believing in God and trusting him. (5)

5. The Apostle who wrote the hymn to love. (4)

7. A firm habit of doing good. (6)

8. Keeping balance with pleasures. (10)

9. Giving each one what is due. (7)

Down ↓

2. The capital sin opposed to humility. (5)

3. The four "hinge" virtues of the moral life are the ... virtues. (8)

4. The courage to hold firm. (9)

5. The "charioteer" of the virtues. (8)

6. The word the NABRE uses for charity in 1 Corinthians 13. (4)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

The Seven Deadly (Capital) Sins and the Virtues That Fight Them

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The "capital" sins (from the Latin *caput*, head) are called that because they are at the head of many other sins. The Church counts seven (see CCC 1866). For each one, a virtue helps to fight it.

- **Pride:** thinking you are better than others and do not need God → humility.
- **Greed:** clinging to money and things → generosity.
- **Envy:** being sad about other people's happiness → kindness.
- **Anger:** losing your temper and wanting revenge → gentleness and patience.
- **Lust:** seeking pleasure without respecting love and the body → chastity.
- **Gluttony:** eating and drinking without measure → temperance.
- **Sloth:** running away from effort and neglecting God → zeal and perseverance.

1. **Why are these sins called "capital"?**

2. **Which capital sin tempts you most often? Which virtue can fight it?**

3. **Give a concrete example of humility in your life.**

The Virtues Quiz

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

1. **How many theological virtues are there?**
   ☐ two ☐ three ☐ four
2. **Which ones?**
   ☐ faith, hope, charity ☐ prudence, justice, fortitude ☐ gentleness, joy, peace
3. **How many cardinal virtues are there?**
   ☐ three ☐ four ☐ seven
4. **Which virtue is the "charioteer" of the virtues?**
   ☐ temperance ☐ prudence ☐ fortitude
5. **According to Saint Paul, the greatest virtue is...**
   ☐ faith ☐ hope ☐ love (charity)
6. **Giving each one what is due is...**
   ☐ justice ☐ temperance ☐ faith
7. **Which virtue fights gluttony?**
   ☐ justice ☐ temperance ☐ hope
8. **A virtue is...**
   ☐ a quality you either have or don't have ☐ a habit of doing good that grows with practice ☐ a reward
9. **Which virtue do you admire most in someone close to you?**

My Virtue Challenge of the Week

A virtue grows like a muscle: with training. Give yourself a one-week challenge.

Name: _____

The virtue I choose:

- ☐ faith
- ☐ charity
- ☐ justice
- ☐ temperance
- ☐ hope
- ☐ prudence
- ☐ fortitude
- ☐ humility

My concrete challenge (what, when, with whom):

_____

_____

Monday: _____ **Tuesday:** _____

Wednesday: _____ **Thursday:** _____

Friday: _____ **Saturday:** _____

Sunday: _____ **Review:** _____

What was easy:

_____

_____

What was hard:

_____

_____

What I learned about myself:

_____

_____

My prayer for next week:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

My Virtues Portrait

Look back on this part: which virtues are already strong in you, and which ones need to grow?

Name: _____

Virtues already strong in me	Virtues that need to grow

What the people close to me would say about me (ask them!):

The virtue I ask the Holy Spirit for at my Confirmation:

I draw a tree: the roots are the theological virtues, the branches the cardinal virtues.

My prayer:

What Is Mercy?

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Latin word for mercy, *misericordia*, joins *miseri* (people in distress) and *cor* (heart). To have mercy is to have a heart that lets itself be touched by the distress of others and acts to relieve it.

God is rich in mercy (see Ephesians 2:4). The whole Bible tells how he forgives his people and lifts them up. Jesus is the face of the Father's mercy: he eats with sinners, heals the sick, and forgives those who crucified him. He asks us to be merciful just as our Father is merciful (see Luke 6:36).

- **Mercy received:** God always forgives us when we come back to him.
- **Mercy given:** we are called to forgive and to help, as God does for us.
- **The works of mercy:** the Church counts fourteen: seven corporal (for the body) and seven spiritual (for the soul).

1. **Where does the word "mercy" come from? What does it mean?**

2. **Name a Gospel story in which Jesus shows God's mercy.**

3. **Have you ever received mercy from someone? Tell about it.**

The Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25-37)

Read the parable in your Bible (Luke 10:25-37), then check the right answer.

Name: _____

A scholar of the law asks Jesus who his neighbor is. Jesus answers with a story: a man is going down from Jerusalem to Jericho and falls into the hands of robbers, who leave him half-dead. A priest passes by, then a Levite: they see the man and pass by on the other side. But a Samaritan comes near, treats his wounds, and takes him to an inn.

1. **What does the scholar of the law want to know?**
   - ☐ who his neighbor is
   - ☐ who is the greatest
   - ☐ how many times to forgive
2. **On which road does the story take place?**
   - ☐ from Nazareth to Bethlehem
   - ☐ from Jerusalem to Jericho
   - ☐ from Rome to Athens
3. **Who passes by without stopping?**
   - ☐ a priest and a Levite
   - ☐ two soldiers
   - ☐ some shepherds
4. **Why is the Samaritan's kindness surprising?**
   - ☐ because Jews and Samaritans did not get along
   - ☐ because he was a doctor
   - ☐ because he was rich
5. **Where does the Samaritan take the wounded man?**
   - ☐ to the Temple
   - ☐ to an inn
   - ☐ to his own house
6. **What does Jesus tell the scholar at the end?**
   - ☐ to go and act the same way
   - ☐ to stay and pray
   - ☐ not to judge
7. **In your life, who is "the wounded man by the side of the road"? How can you come close to him?**

Jesus in the Least of His Brothers (Matthew 25:31-46)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

Near the end of Matthew's Gospel, Jesus speaks about the Last Judgment. The King gathers all the nations and says to those on his right:

- **Jesus hides in the least:** the hungry, the stranger, the sick, the prisoner.
- **We will be judged on love:** not on our diplomas or our money, but on the love we gave in concrete ways.

> **The Word of Jesus**
>
> "For I was hungry and you gave me food, I was thirsty and you gave me drink, a stranger and you welcomed me, naked and you clothed me, ill and you cared for me, in prison and you visited me."
>
> "Amen, I say to you, whatever you did for one of these least brothers of mine, you did for me."
>
> Matthew 25:35-36, 40

1. **Copy the six situations of need that Jesus talks about.**

2. **What does Jesus mean when he says "you did for me"?**

3. **Choose one situation and say what you can do about it, concretely.**

The 7 Corporal Works of Mercy

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The corporal works of mercy come from Matthew 25 and from the tradition of the Church (see CCC 2447). Write the name of each work from the example.

Shelter the homeless · Bury the dead · Give drink to the thirsty · Visit the sick · Visit the imprisoned · Clothe the naked · Feed the hungry

_____

Take part in a collection for the food pantry.

_____

Support a clean-water project in a poor country.

_____

Give clothes in good condition to a charity.

_____

Collect blankets for a homeless shelter, or welcome a new neighbor.

_____

Visit a grandparent who is in the hospital.

_____

Pray for prisoners and for those who visit them.

_____

Go with a grieving family to a funeral.

My idea

_____

The 7 Spiritual Works of Mercy

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

The spiritual works of mercy take care of the soul and the heart of others (see CCC 2447). Write the name of each work from the example.

Pray for the living and the dead · Comfort the sorrowful · Forgive injuries · Bear wrongs patiently · Admonish the sinner · Counsel the doubtful · Instruct the ignorant

_____

Help a friend who is unsure how to make the right choice.

_____

Explain a lesson to a classmate who didn't understand it.

_____

Gently tell a friend that he is going the wrong way.

_____

Stay close to someone who is sad.

_____

Make peace with someone who hurt me.

_____

Stay kind to my little brother when he annoys me.

_____

Entrust my family and those who have died to God.

My idea

_____

The Corporal Works in Everyday Life

Draw a line from each item on the left to its match on the right.

Name: _____

I share my snack with a classmate who has none.	Visit the imprisoned
I bring a bottle of water to a worker in the hot sun.	Feed the hungry
I give a coat that no longer fits me to the parish clothing drive.	Visit the sick
I help collect blankets for a homeless shelter.	Clothe the naked
I call my grandmother, who is in the hospital.	Shelter the homeless
I write a card to a prisoner with my youth group.	Bury the dead
I go to our neighbor's funeral with my parents.	Give drink to the thirsty

The Spiritual Works in Everyday Life

Draw a line from each item on the left to its match on the right.

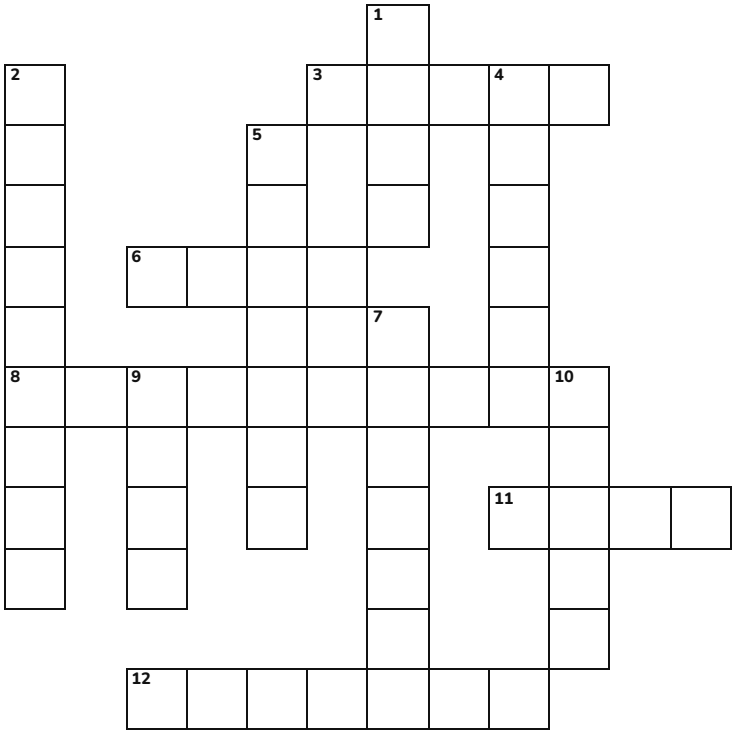
Name: _____

I help my friend choose between two options.	Admonish the sinner
I explain fractions to my little sister.	Forgive injuries
I tell a friend that cheating is wrong.	Instruct the ignorant
I stay with a friend who is crying.	Pray for the living and the dead
I don't hold a grudge after an argument.	Counsel the doubtful
I stay patient with my cousin who never stops talking.	Comfort the sorrowful
I pray for my grandfather, who has died.	Bear wrongs patiently

The Works of Mercy

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

3. A heart touched by the distress of others. (5)

6. … the dead. (4)

8. Visit the …: those who are in prison. (10)

11. Visit the …: those who suffer in their bodies. (4)

12. … the homeless. (7)

Down ↓

1. … the hungry. (4)

2. He took care of the wounded man by the side of the road. (9)

4. … the naked. (6)

5. … injuries. (7)

7. … the sorrowful. (7)

9. … for the living and the dead. (4)

10. Give … to the thirsty. (5)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

A New Student Alone in the Cafeteria

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

A new student, Kenji, arrived in the middle of the year. He comes from another country and does not speak English well yet. In the cafeteria, he eats alone at the end of the table. Some kids imitate his accent.

Gabby wants to go and sit with him, but she is afraid of what her friends will say.

To Help You

"a stranger and you welcomed me" (Matthew 25:35). Welcoming the stranger is a work of mercy. A simple smile can change everything for someone who feels alone.

1. **Which work of mercy can Gabby live out?**

2. **What is holding her back? How can she overcome this fear?**

3. **Think of three concrete things to do to help Kenji feel welcome.**

4. **Have you ever felt alone or left out? What helped you?**

An Elderly, Sick Neighbor

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

Mrs. Miller, Rafael's neighbor across the hall, is 86 years old. Since her fall, she hardly ever goes out. Her children live far away. Rafael sometimes sees her when she opens the door to get her mail: she looks sad and tired.

Rafael wonders: "What could I do? I'm just a kid."

To Help You

Visiting the sick and people who are alone is a work of mercy. It is not only for adults: a visit with your parents, a drawing, or a small service can be a great gift.

1. **Which works of mercy can Rafael live out with Mrs. Miller?**

2. **Make a list of five small services he could do for her.**

3. **Why is it important to ask his parents first?**

4. **Do you know an elderly person or someone who lives alone? What could you do for them?**

A Classmate Makes Fun of My Faith

Read the situation, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

The Situation

In class, Liam said he was getting ready for his Confirmation. Since then, Max calls him "Father Liam" and mockingly makes the Sign of the Cross when he walks by. Liam is hurt. He wants to get back at Max by making fun of him in front of the whole class.

To Help You

Jesus asks us to love our enemies and pray for those who persecute us (see Matthew 5:44). Forgiving injuries and bearing wrongs patiently are works of mercy. That does not mean accepting everything: you can speak calmly and ask an adult for help if the teasing continues.

1. **How does Liam feel? Do you understand why he wants revenge?**

2. **Which works of mercy can he live out in this situation?**

3. **What could he say to Max, calmly and without being ashamed of his faith?**

4. **Which gift of the Holy Spirit will help him?**

The Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32)

Read the parable in your Bible (Luke 15:11-32), then check the right answer.

Name: _____

A father has two sons. The younger one asks for his share of the inheritance, goes off to a distant country, and spends it all. Penniless, he takes care of pigs and goes hungry. He decides to go back to his father and ask for forgiveness. His father sees him from far away, is filled with compassion, runs to hug him, and throws a big party. The older son, however, gets angry.

1. **What does the younger son ask his father for?**
   - ☐ his share of the inheritance
   - ☐ a job
   - ☐ a house
2. **What does he do with his money?**
   - ☐ he puts it in the bank
   - ☐ he spends all of it
   - ☐ he gives it to the poor
3. **What job does he do when he is broke?**
   - ☐ he takes care of pigs
   - ☐ he fishes
   - ☐ he sells wheat
4. **What does the father do when he sees his son coming back?**
   - ☐ he waits for him to apologize
   - ☐ he runs to hug him
   - ☐ he shuts the door
5. **How does the older son react?**
   - ☐ he is happy
   - ☐ he gets angry
   - ☐ he leaves home too
6. **What does this parable teach us?**
   - ☐ God is a Father who forgives and waits for us to come back
   - ☐ you should never leave home
   - ☐ money makes you happy
7. **In this parable, which character are you sometimes most like? Why?**

Is Forgiving the Same as Forgetting?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Nina: "I forgave her, but I can't forget what she did to me. So I didn't really forgive her?"

To Help You

Forgiving does not mean forgetting or saying that the wrong was not serious. It means giving up revenge and wishing good for the person who hurt us. Forgiveness can take time: we can ask God for it in prayer. On the cross, Jesus said: "Father, forgive them, they know not what they do" (Luke 23:34).

1. **Can you forgive without forgetting? Explain.**

2. **Why is it sometimes so hard to forgive?**

3. **What can you do when you are not yet able to forgive?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

My Team Service Project

With your religious education group, choose and plan a concrete project of mercy.

Name: _____



Examples: a food drive, a visit to a nursing home, cards for people who are sick, a snack for children, help for the parish.

Project name: _____ **Work of mercy:** _____

For whom: _____ **Date:** _____

What we are going to do, step by step:

What we need (supplies, help from adults, permissions):

Who does what on the team:

After the project: what we lived and felt:

My Month of Mercy

Each day, one small work of mercy. Check the box when you have done it.

Name: _____

1 I smile at someone who is alone. ☐	**2** I share my snack. ☐	**3** I pray for someone who is sick. ☐	**4** I help at home without being asked. ☐	**5** I forgive a small offense. ☐
6 I comfort someone. ☐	**7** I write to a grandparent. ☐	**8** I sort clothes to give away. ☐	**9** I explain a lesson to a classmate. ☐	**10** I pray for those who have died. ☐
11 I stay patient with my brother or sister. ☐	**12** I welcome someone new. ☐	**13** I do a favor for a neighbor. ☐	**14** I say thank you to three people. ☐	**15** I don't say bad things about others. ☐
16 I smile at someone who is alone. ☐	**17** I share my snack. ☐	**18** I pray for someone who is sick. ☐	**19** I help at home without being asked. ☐	**20** I forgive a small offense. ☐
21 I comfort someone. ☐	**22** I write to a grandparent. ☐	**23** I sort clothes to give away. ☐	**24** I explain a lesson to a classmate. ☐	**25** I pray for those who have died. ☐
26 I stay patient with my brother or sister. ☐	**27** I welcome someone new. ☐	**28** I do a favor for a neighbor. ☐	**29** I say thank you to three people. ☐	**30** I don't say bad things about others. ☐

My month in review:

The Works of Mercy I Have Practiced

Look back on this part about mercy.

Name: _____

The corporal works of mercy I have practiced:

The spiritual works of mercy I have practiced:

The hardest one, and why:

A person I met thanks to these works:

What I have understood about God’s mercy:

My prayer: "Jesus, you are the face of the Father’s mercy..."

What Is a Saint?

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



A saint is a person who let God's love transform his or her whole life. The saints are not superheroes without faults: they are men, women, and children who said "yes" to God, each in his or her own way.

All the baptized are called to holiness (Second Vatican Council, *Lumen Gentium*, no. 40). The Church officially recognizes some saints to give them to us as models and as intercessors: they pray for us before God.

- **Famous saints and unknown saints:** on November 1, All Saints' Day, we celebrate all the saints, even those whose names nobody knows.
- **A patron saint:** the saint whose name you bear; he or she watches over you and shows you a path.
- **Holiness in everyday life:** Pope Francis speaks of the "saints next door": ordinary people who live the Gospel every day.

1. **What is a saint, in your opinion?**

2. **Why does the Church give us the saints as models?**

3. **Do you know a "saint next door"? Who is it, and why?**

The Road to Canonization

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Before the Church officially declares that a person is a saint, it studies that person's life very carefully. This road has four steps. Write the title of each step.

Saint · Servant of God · Venerable · Blessed

_____

The local bishop opens an investigation into the person's life, a few years after his or her death.

↓

_____

The pope recognizes that the person lived the virtues in a heroic way.

↓

_____

Beatification: usually, a miracle obtained through the person's prayers must be recognized (this is not needed for martyrs).

↓

_____

Canonization: the pope declares that the person is in heaven and can be celebrated in the whole Church.

1. **What is the difference between being declared Blessed and being declared a saint?**

2. **Why does the Church take so much time before declaring someone a saint?**

St. Thérèse of Lisieux

Read about Thérèse's life and color her portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Full Name: Thérèse Martin; religious name: Sister Thérèse of the Child Jesus and of the Holy Face

Born: January 2, 1873, in Alençon, France

Convent: entered the Carmelite convent of Lisieux on April 9, 1888, at age 15

Died: September 30, 1897, in Lisieux, at age 24

Saint: canonized on May 17, 1925, by Pope Pius XI

Feast Day: October 1

Titles: patroness of the missions and Doctor of the Church (known in the United States as "the Little Flower")

Her Symbols: roses, the crucifix, the Carmelite habit

Life in Brief

Thérèse was the youngest of the five daughters of Louis and Zélie Martin, who were also declared saints in 2015. She lost her mother at age 4. At 15, she got permission to enter the Carmelite convent of Lisieux. There she discovered her "little way": doing every little thing in her day with great love and trusting God the way a child trusts a loving father. She prayed and offered her efforts for missionaries all over the world. Sick with tuberculosis, she died at 24. Her book, *Story of a Soul*, is read all over the world.

> **"I will spend my heaven doing good on earth."**
> Saint Thérèse of Lisieux, quoted by Pope Francis (General Audience, June 7, 2023)

1. **Explain in your own words what Thérèse's "little way" is.**

2. **Thérèse never left her convent. So why is she the patroness of the missions?**

3. **Which gift of the Holy Spirit do you recognize in her life? Explain your choice.**

4. **My "little way": what small act of love will I do this week?**

St. Louis, King of France

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Name: Louis IX, King of France
Born: April 25, 1214, in Poissy
King: at age 12, in 1226; at first his mother, Blanche of Castile, ruled for him
Died: August 25, 1270, near Tunis
Saint: canonized in 1297 by Pope Boniface VIII
Feast Day: August 25
His Symbols: the crown, the cloak with lilies, the crown of thorns

Life in Brief

Raised by his mother in the love of God, Louis became king very young. He wanted to rule according to the Gospel: he personally judged cases under an oak tree at Vincennes, listening to rich and poor alike; he founded hospitals and served poor people at his own table. He built the Sainte-Chapelle in Paris to house Christ's crown of thorns. He went on two crusades and died of illness near Tunis. He left his son advice on how to be a Christian king.

1. **How did Saint Louis live out justice?**

2. **Why did he build the Sainte-Chapelle?**

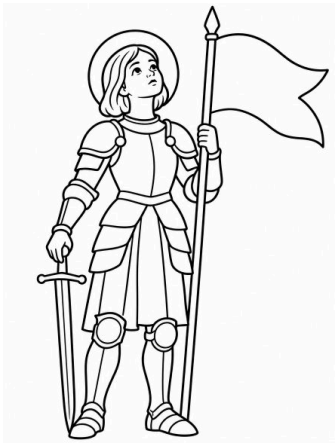
3. **Can someone be powerful and holy at the same time? Explain with the example of Saint Louis.**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Joan of Arc

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: around 1412, in Domrémy (Lorraine, France)

Her Mission: to free the city of Orléans and have King Charles VII crowned at Reims

Died: May 30, 1431, in Rouen, at age 19

Cleared: her trial was overturned in 1456

Saint: canonized on May 16, 1920, by Pope Benedict XV

Feast Day: May 30

Title: secondary patroness of France

Her Symbols: armor, a banner, a sword

Life in Brief

Joan was a devout young peasant girl from Lorraine. Around age 13, she heard voices: Saint Michael, Saint Catherine, and Saint Margaret asked her to go and help the King of France, at a time when much of the country was occupied during the Hundred Years' War. At 17, she was allowed to lead an army: Orléans was freed in May 1429, and the king was crowned at Reims in July. Captured in battle, she was tried in Rouen by an unjust court and burned at the stake. She died calling out the name of Jesus.

> **"If I am not, may it please God to put me in it; if I am, may it please God to keep me there."**
> Saint Joan of Arc, trial of 1431, quoted by Benedict XVI (General Audience, January 26, 2011)

1. **What gave Joan the courage to carry out her mission?**

2. **Her judges asked her if she was in God's grace. Explain her answer (see the quotation).**

3. **Which gift of the Holy Spirit do you see in her life?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. John Vianney, the Curé of Ars

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: May 8, 1786, in Dardilly, near Lyon, France
Priest: ordained in 1815, despite great difficulty with his studies
Pastor of Ars: from 1818, in a small country village
Died: August 4, 1859, in Ars
Saint: canonized in 1925 by Pope Pius XI
Feast Day: August 4
Title: patron saint of parish priests

Life in Brief

John grew up during the French Revolution, a time when priests had to hide. He wanted to become a priest, but he found it very hard to learn Latin. Thanks to the patience of Father Balley, he was finally ordained. Sent to the small village of Ars, he prayed, fasted, and visited every family. Little by little, the village changed. Crowds came from all over France to go to Confession with him: he spent long hours in the confessional every day. He is the patron saint of all parish priests in the world.

> **"The priesthood is the love of the heart of Jesus."**
> Saint John Vianney, quoted by Benedict XVI (Letter for the Year for Priests, June 16, 2009)

1. **What difficulties did John face in becoming a priest?**

_____

_____

2. **Why did so many people come to Ars?**

_____

3. **What does his life teach you about perseverance?**

_____

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

_____

St. Bernadette Soubirous

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: January 7, 1844, in Lourdes, France

The Apparitions: 18 apparitions of the Virgin Mary at the Grotto of Massabielle, in 1858

Religious Sister: with the Sisters of Charity of Nevers, from 1866

Died: April 16, 1879, in Nevers, at age 35

Saint: canonized on December 8, 1933, by Pope Pius XI

Her Symbols: the rosary, the grotto, the spring

Life in Brief

Bernadette was the oldest child of a very poor family who lived in an old jail cell. She could not read or write and was preparing for her First Communion. On February 11, 1858, while gathering wood near the Grotto of Massabielle, she saw a "Lady" dressed in white. The Lady asked her to pray for sinners, to drink from the spring, and to have a chapel built. On March 25, the Lady revealed her name: "I am the Immaculate Conception." Bernadette later became a religious sister in Nevers, where she lived humbly and was often sick.

> **"I am the Immaculate Conception."**
> Words of Our Lady to Bernadette (March 25, 1858), quoted by Benedict XVI at Lourdes (September 14, 2008)

1. **What did the Virgin Mary ask Bernadette to do?**

2. **Why could Bernadette not have made up the name "Immaculate Conception"?**

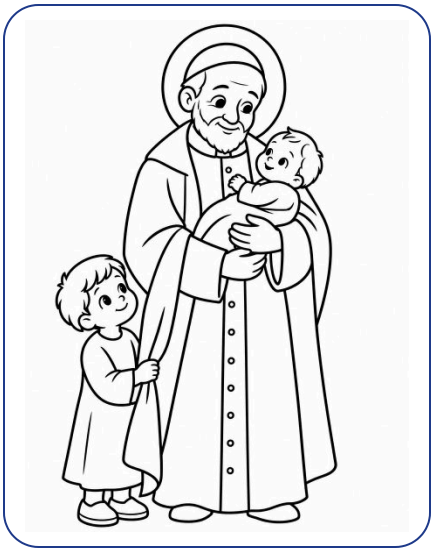
3. **How did Bernadette live after the apparitions?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Vincent de Paul

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: 1581, in Pouy, in southwestern France

Priest: ordained in 1600

Founder: of the Congregation of the Mission (the Vincentians) and, with Saint Louise de Marillac, of the Daughters of Charity

Died: September 27, 1660, in Paris

Saint: canonized in 1737

Feast Day: September 27

Title: patron saint of charitable works

Life in Brief

Vincent was the son of farmers and looked after the flocks. As a young priest, he first looked for a comfortable life. But when he discovered how poor the people in the countryside were, he changed his life completely. He organized groups of women to visit the sick, sent priests to preach in the villages, and, with Louise de Marillac, founded the Daughters of Charity, who served the poor in the streets and in hospitals. He also took in the abandoned children of Paris. He showed that charity must be well organized to really help. Today, many US parishes have a St. Vincent de Paul Society that helps people in need.

1. **What changed Vincent's life?**

2. **Name three charitable works founded by Saint Vincent.**

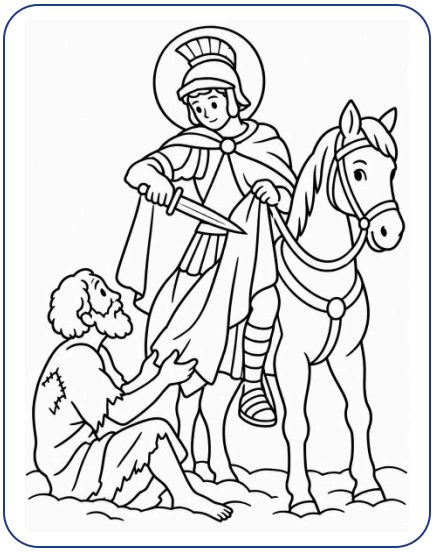
3. **Which works of mercy did he live out?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Martin of Tours

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: around 316, in Pannonia (today Hungary)

Soldier: in the Roman army, in Gaul

Monk: he founded at Ligugé, near Poitiers, one of the first monasteries in Gaul

Bishop: of Tours from 371

Died: November 8, 397, in Candes

Feast Day: November 11

His Symbols: the horse, the shared cloak, the sword

Life in Brief

The son of a Roman officer, Martin became a soldier very young. One winter evening in Amiens, he met a poor man who was almost naked and shivering. Martin had no money left: he cut his cloak in two with his sword and gave half to the man. The next night, he saw Christ in a dream, wearing that piece of cloak. He was baptized, left the army, and became a disciple of Saint Hilary of Poitiers. As a monk and then as Bishop of Tours, he traveled through the countryside to proclaim the Gospel. Thousands of churches and villages in France bear his name.

1. **Tell what Martin did in Amiens.**

2. **Why does Martin's dream remind us of Matthew 25:40?**

3. **What did he share? What could you share?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Geneviève

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: around 420, in Nanterre, near Paris

Consecrated: to God from her youth, after meeting Saint Germanus of Auxerre

In 451: she encouraged the people of Paris to pray as Attila's army approached

Died: around 500, in Paris

Feast Day: January 3

Title: patroness of Paris

Her Symbols: the candle, the sheep

Life in Brief

Geneviève was a young girl from Nanterre. Saint Germanus, Bishop of Auxerre, passing through, noticed her faith and encouraged her to give her life to God. Living in Paris, she spent her days in prayer and fasting. In 451, Attila and his Huns were coming near the city, and the people wanted to flee. Geneviève convinced them to stay and pray: Attila turned away from Paris. Later, during a siege, she brought wheat by boat on the river to feed the starving city. The people of Paris chose her as their patroness.

1. **How did Geneviève help the people of Paris when Attila came?**

2. **Which work of mercy did she live out during the siege of Paris?**

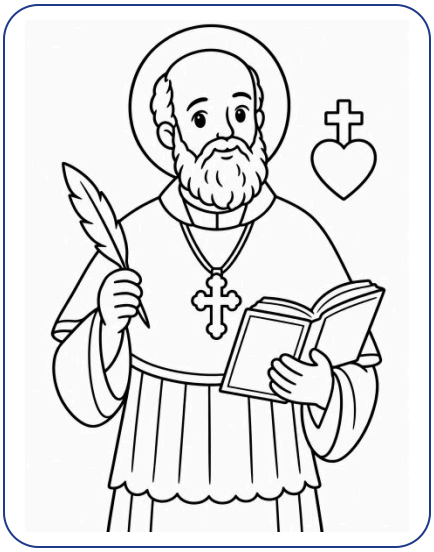
3. **Why can we say that prayer is a strength?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Francis de Sales

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: August 21, 1567, at the castle of Sales, in Savoy

Bishop: of Geneva, living in Annecy, from 1602

Writer: *Introduction to the Devout Life* (1609)

Founder: with Saint Jane Frances de Chantal, of the Order of the Visitation (1610)

Died: December 28, 1622, in Lyon

Feast Day: January 24

Titles: Doctor of the Church, patron saint of journalists and writers

Life in Brief

The oldest son of a noble family, Francis studied law in Paris and in Padua. His father dreamed of a brilliant career for him, but Francis wanted to be a priest. Sent to the Chablais, a region whose people had become Protestant, he did not give up: since people refused to listen to him, he wrote short leaflets and slipped them under their doors. As a bishop, he was known for his gentleness and patience, even though he had a quick temper by nature. He taught that everyone, whatever their job, can become a saint.

1. **Why is Francis de Sales the patron saint of journalists?**

2. **According to him, who can become a saint?**

3. **How did he work on his character? What can you learn from that?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Margaret Mary Alacoque

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: July 22, 1647, in Burgundy, France
Religious Sister: at the Visitation monastery of Paray-le-Monial, from 1671
Apparitions: of the Sacred Heart of Jesus, between 1673 and 1675
Died: October 17, 1690, in Paray-le-Monial
Saint: canonized in 1920 by Pope Benedict XV
Feast Day: October 16
Her Symbol: the Heart of Jesus surrounded by flames

Life in Brief

Margaret Mary was a girl who was often sick and found her joy in prayer. She entered the Visitation monastery of Paray-le-Monial and lived humbly. For several years, Jesus appeared to her and showed her his Heart, burning with love for all people, a Heart that has loved people so much and is so little loved in return. He asked her to make this love known, to receive Communion on the first Friday of the month, and to have a feast celebrated in honor of his Heart. Despite doubts and mockery, she stayed faithful. Today, the Church celebrates the Most Sacred Heart of Jesus every year.

1. **What did Jesus show her? What did he ask of her?**

2. **What does the Heart of Jesus surrounded by flames mean?**

3. **How can you respond to the love of Jesus?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Bernard of Clairvaux

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: 1090, in Fontaine-lès-Dijon, in Burgundy, France
Monk: entered the Abbey of Cîteaux in 1112
Abbot: founder and abbot of Clairvaux from 1115
Died: August 20, 1153, in Clairvaux
Saint: canonized in 1174
Feast Day: August 20
Title: Doctor of the Church

Life in Brief

Bernard was a brilliant young nobleman. At 22, he decided to enter the Abbey of Cîteaux, where the monks lived simply in silence, prayer, and work. He brought about thirty companions with him, including several of his brothers! Three years later, he founded the Abbey of Clairvaux. His prayer and his preaching drew so many people that a great number of monasteries were founded all over Europe. He advised popes and kings, yet he kept a very simple life. He had a deep love for the Virgin Mary.

1. **What attracted Bernard to the life of a monk?**

2. **Why can we say he had a gift for inspiring others?**

3. **What place do silence and prayer have in your life?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Jane Frances de Chantal

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: January 23, 1572, in Dijon, France

Wife and Mother: married to the Baron de Chantal; mother of several children

Widow: very young, after her husband died in an accident

Founder: with Saint Francis de Sales, of the Visitation in Annecy in 1610

Died: December 13, 1641, in Moulins

Saint: canonized in 1767

Feast Day: August 12

Life in Brief

Jane Frances was a happy wife and mother. But her husband died in a hunting accident: she was left alone with her children, deeply shaken. She met Saint Francis de Sales, who became her spiritual director. With him, she founded the Order of the Visitation, to welcome women who wanted to give themselves to God, even if their health was weak or they were already older. She went through many losses and doubts, but she kept her trust in God. When she died, the order had dozens of monasteries.

1. **What trials did Jane go through?**

2. **What helped her keep her trust in God?**

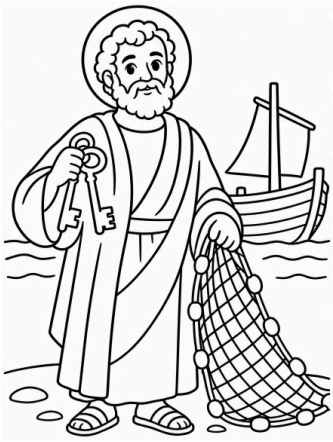
3. **Why is it important to have someone to guide you in your life of faith?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Peter

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Name: Simon, whom Jesus called "Peter"
Job: fisherman on the Sea of Galilee
Mission: leader of the Apostles, first Bishop of Rome, the first pope
Died: a martyr in Rome, around AD 64-67
Tomb: under St. Peter's Basilica in Rome
Feast Day: June 29, with Saint Paul
His Symbols: the keys, the net, the boat

Life in Brief

Simon was a fisherman when Jesus called him: "Come after me, and I will make you fishers of men" (Matthew 4:19). He became one of the Twelve. Generous and impulsive, he declared that Jesus is the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Jesus gave him the name Peter, which means "rock," and entrusted his Church to him. During the Passion, out of fear, Peter denied Jesus three times. But after the Resurrection, Jesus asked him three times whether he loved him and entrusted his flock to him. Filled with the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, Peter proclaimed Christ with courage, all the way to Rome, where he died a martyr.

> **"You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God."**
> Matthew 16:16

1. **What does the name "Peter" mean? Why did Jesus give it to him?**

_____

_____

2. **How did Jesus forgive Peter for denying him?**

_____

3. **What did Pentecost change for Peter?**

_____

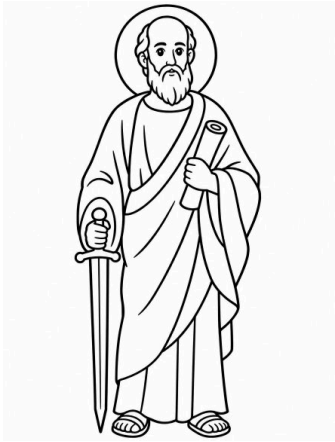
4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

_____

St. Paul

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Name: Saul, also called Paul

Born: in Tarsus, in Cilicia (today Turkey)

Conversion: on the road to Damascus

Mission: Apostle to the nations: he proclaimed Christ all over the Roman world

Died: a martyr in Rome, around AD 67

Feast Days: June 29; his Conversion on January 25

His Symbols: the sword, the book or scroll

Life in Brief

Saul was a very devout Jew who knew the Law perfectly. He persecuted the first Christians. One day, on the road to Damascus, a light from the sky blinded him and he heard a voice: "Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me?" It was the risen Jesus (Acts 9:4). Saul was converted, was baptized, and became the greatest missionary: he traveled by land and sea, founded communities, and wrote them letters that we still read at Mass. He was arrested and taken to Rome, where he died a martyr.

> **"...yet I live, no longer I, but Christ lives in me."**
> Galatians 2:20

1. **What did Saul do before his conversion?**

2. **What happened on the road to Damascus?**

3. **Why do we still read Saint Paul's letters today?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

The Blessed Virgin Mary

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Town: Nazareth, in Galilee

Mission: Mother of Jesus, Mother of God, and Mother of the Church

Feast Days: Immaculate Conception (December 8), Annunciation (March 25), Assumption (August 15), Mary, Mother of God (January 1)

Title: under the title of the Immaculate Conception, Patroness of the United States

Her Symbols: the blue veil, the stars, the lily, roses

Life in Brief

Mary was a young girl from Nazareth. God kept her free from sin from the first moment of her life: this is the Immaculate Conception. The angel Gabriel told her that she would be the mother of the Son of God, and she said "yes." She gave birth to Jesus in Bethlehem, raised him with Joseph, and stayed with him all the way to the cross. With the Apostles, she prayed while waiting for the Holy Spirit and received him at Pentecost. At the end of her life, she was taken up to heaven, body and soul: this is the Assumption. She is our Mother and prays for us.

> **"Behold, I am the handmaid of the Lord. May it be done to me according to your word."**
> Luke 1:38

1. **What is the Immaculate Conception? And the Assumption?**

2. **Why was Mary present at Pentecost?**

3. **What "yes" is God asking you to say right now?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Joseph

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Family: a descendant of King David
Job: carpenter in Nazareth
Mission: husband of Mary and foster father of Jesus
Titles: patron of the universal Church, of fathers, and of workers
Feast Days: March 19; St. Joseph the Worker on May 1
His Symbols: the lily, carpenter's tools, the Child Jesus

Life in Brief

Joseph was a righteous man. Engaged to Mary, he learned that she was expecting a child. In a dream, an angel told him that the child was from the Holy Spirit and asked him to take Mary into his home. Joseph obeyed. He protected Mary and Jesus: he took them to Bethlehem, then fled to Egypt to escape King Herod, before coming back to Nazareth. He taught Jesus his trade as a carpenter. In the Gospel, Joseph never says a word: he listens to God and acts. He is the saint of silence and trust.

1. **How does God speak to Joseph? How does Joseph respond?**

2. **Why is Joseph the patron of the universal Church?**

3. **What can you learn from his silence and his trust?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Francis of Assisi

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: 1181 or 1182, in Assisi, Italy
Founder: of the Order of Friars Minor (the Franciscans)
In 1223: he set up the first living Nativity scene at Greccio
Died: October 3, 1226, in Assisi
Saint: canonized in 1228
Feast Day: October 4
Title: patron saint of ecology

Life in Brief

The son of a rich cloth merchant, Francis loved parties and dreamed of glory. After a war, time as a prisoner, and an illness, he changed his life. In the small, abandoned church of San Damiano, he heard Christ asking him to repair his house. He gave up everything he owned and lived poorly to follow Jesus. Other young men joined him: they were the first Franciscans. He loved all of creation, which he called "Brother Sun" and "Sister Moon." He wrote the *Canticle of the Creatures*, a great hymn of praise to God. In many US parishes, animals are blessed on his feast day.

1. **What changed Francis' life?**

2. **Why is he the patron saint of ecology?**

3. **What link do you see between Francis and the gift of knowledge?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Clare of Assisi

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: 1194, in Assisi
Disciple: of Saint Francis, whom she joined in 1212, at age 18
Founder: of the Poor Ladies, later called the Poor Clares
Died: August 11, 1253, in Assisi
Saint: canonized in 1255
Feast Day: August 11
Her Symbol: the monstrance

Life in Brief

Clare was a young noblewoman from Assisi. Listening to Francis preach, she too decided to leave everything to follow the poor Christ. One night, at 18, she left her family's house and joined Francis, who cut her hair as a sign of her consecration. She settled at the monastery of San Damiano, where other women joined her to live in prayer, poverty, and joy. One day, when soldiers attacked the monastery, Clare, who was sick, had herself carried before them with the Blessed Sacrament: the soldiers ran away.

1. **What did Clare choose by following Saint Francis?**

2. **Why is she shown with a monstrance?**

3. **Can prayer be a real mission? Explain.**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Augustine

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: 354, in Tagaste, North Africa (today Algeria)
His Mother: Saint Monica, who prayed for him for years
Baptism: at Easter 387, in Milan, by Saint Ambrose
Bishop: of Hippo, in North Africa
Died: August 28, 430
Feast Day: August 28
Title: Doctor of the Church

Life in Brief

Augustine was a very intelligent young man, but he lived far from God and looked for happiness in pleasure, success, and fashionable ideas. His mother, Monica, prayed for him with tears for years. As a teacher in Milan, he listened to the sermons of Bishop Ambrose. One day, in a garden, he heard a child's voice singing, telling him to pick up and read. He opened the Bible and was converted. After his Baptism, he became a priest and then a bishop. In his book *Confessions*, he tells how God searched for him and found him.

> **"You have made us for yourself, and our heart is restless until it rests in you."**
> Saint Augustine, *Confessions* I, 1, 1 (quoted in CCC 30)

1. **Where did Augustine look for happiness before his conversion?**

_____

_____

2. **What role did his mother, Saint Monica, play?**

_____

3. **Explain the quotation in your own words.**

_____

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

_____

St. Catherine of Siena

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: March 25, 1347, in Siena, Italy
Family: one of the youngest in a very large family
Vocation: a lay member of the Dominican family
Died: April 29, 1380, in Rome, at age 33
Saint: canonized in 1461
Feast Day: April 29
Titles: Doctor of the Church, co-patroness of Europe

Life in Brief

From childhood, Catherine wanted to give her whole life to Jesus. She stayed with her family but joined the Dominican laypeople, who prayed and served the poor. She cared for the sick, even during plague epidemics. She could not write at first, but she dictated hundreds of letters, even to popes and kings. At that time, the pope lived in Avignon: Catherine begged him to come back to Rome, and he did in 1377. She believed that Christians who truly live as God wants can set the world on fire. She died at 33, worn out by her service to the Church.

1. **How did Catherine serve the Church?**

2. **Why did she write to the pope?**

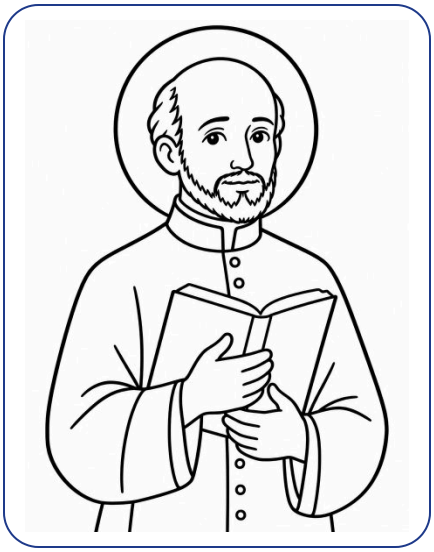
3. **Catherine was not afraid to speak up, even to the pope. When do you need courage to speak up?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Ignatius of Loyola

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: 1491, at the castle of Loyola, in the Basque Country of Spain
Soldier: wounded at the siege of Pamplona in 1521
Writer: *The Spiritual Exercises*
Founder: of the Society of Jesus (the Jesuits), approved in 1540
Died: July 31, 1556, in Rome
Saint: canonized in 1622
Feast Day: July 31
Motto: *Ad maiorem Dei gloriam* (Latin): for the greater glory of God

Life in Brief

Ignatius was a young nobleman who dreamed of military glory. In 1521, a cannonball shattered his leg. During his long recovery, he asked for stories of knights, but the only books available were a life of Christ and lives of the saints. Reading them, he found a deep joy and decided to serve Christ. He prayed a great deal, then studied in Paris, where he met friends such as Francis Xavier. Together, they founded the Society of Jesus, which sends missionaries and opens schools all over the world.

1. **What event changed Ignatius' life?**

2. **What did he discover by reading the life of Christ and of the saints?**

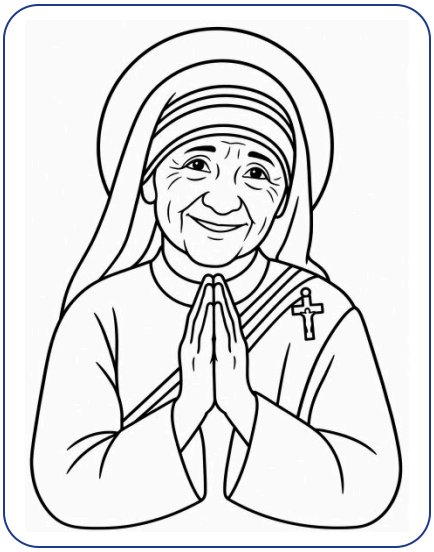
3. **What does his motto mean? How can you live it every day?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Teresa of Calcutta

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Name: Agnes Gonxha Bojaxhiu, who became Mother Teresa
Born: August 26, 1910, in Skopje (today North Macedonia)
Founder: of the Missionaries of Charity, in 1950, in Calcutta (India)
Prize: Nobel Peace Prize in 1979
Died: September 5, 1997, in Calcutta
Saint: canonized on September 4, 2016, by Pope Francis
Feast Day: September 5

Life in Brief

At 18, Agnes became a religious sister and went to India, where she taught at a school in Calcutta. In 1946, on a train, she felt a call from Jesus: to serve the poorest of the poor. She left her school, put on a simple white sari with a blue border, and went into the poorest neighborhoods. She took in dying people abandoned in the street so that they could die surrounded by love, then people with leprosy and orphaned children. Today, the Missionaries of Charity serve the poor all over the world. She spent long moments in adoration before the Blessed Sacrament.

1. **What call did Mother Teresa receive in 1946?**

2. **Why did she spend time in adoration before serving the poor?**

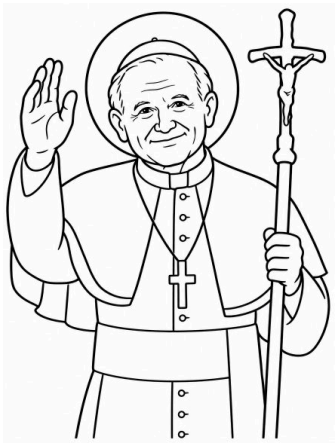
3. **Who are the "poorest" around you?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. John Paul II

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Name: Karol Wojtyła
Born: May 18, 1920, in Wadowice, Poland
Pope: elected on October 16, 1978
Died: April 2, 2005, in Rome
Saint: canonized on April 27, 2014, by Pope Francis
Feast Day: October 22
He Started: World Youth Day

Life in Brief

Karol lost his mother at age 9, then his brother and his father. During World War II, he worked in a quarry and a factory, and secretly prepared to become a priest. He became a bishop, then Archbishop of Kraków. In 1978, he was elected pope: the first Polish pope. He traveled all over the world, gathered millions of young people at World Youth Day, and defended the dignity of every person. In 1981, he was badly wounded by gunshots in St. Peter's Square; he forgave the man who shot him and visited him in prison.

> **"Do not be afraid. Open wide the doors for Christ."**
> Saint John Paul II, homily of October 22, 1978

1. **What trials did Karol live through in his youth?**

2. **How did John Paul II live out forgiveness?**

3. **What do his words "Do not be afraid" say to you?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Carlo Acutis

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: May 3, 1991, in London; he grew up in Milan, Italy
Passions: computers, video games, soccer, animals
His Work: an online exhibit on Eucharistic miracles
Died: October 12, 2006, at age 15, of leukemia
Tomb: in Assisi
Saint: canonized on September 7, 2025, by Pope Leo XIV
Feast Day: October 12

Life in Brief

Carlo was a teenager like any other: he loved computers, played video games, made videos with his dogs, and laughed with his friends. But from his First Communion, at age 7, he went to Mass every day and prayed the rosary. Gifted with computers, he created an exhibit on Eucharistic miracles that has traveled all over the world. He stood up for students who were bullied, helped the homeless in his neighborhood, and limited his own video game time so that he could stay free. When he suddenly became ill with leukemia, he offered his sufferings for the pope and for the Church.

> **"The Eucharist is the highway to heaven."**
> Saint Carlo Acutis, quoted by Pope Francis (Message for World Youth Day 2024)

1. **How was Carlo like young people your age?**

2. **What place did the Eucharist have in his life?**

3. **How did he use the internet? How can you use it for good?**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

St. Pier Giorgio Frassati

Read about this saint's life and color the portrait. Then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Quick Facts

Born: April 6, 1901, in Turin, Italy
Studies: mining engineering
Passions: the mountains, climbing, friends
Commitment: serving the poor with the St. Vincent de Paul Society
Died: July 4, 1925, at age 24
Saint: canonized on September 7, 2025, by Pope Leo XIV
Feast Day: July 4
Motto: *Verso l'alto* (Italian): to the heights

Life in Brief

Pier Giorgio came from a rich and well-known family in Turin. As a student, he was joyful, athletic, and full of humor: he loved climbing mountains with his friends. But he had a secret: he gave almost all his money to the poor, whom he visited in the poorest neighborhoods, often without his family knowing. He went to Mass every day, prayed the rosary, and worked for justice. He died within a few days of polio, probably caught from the sick people he visited. At his funeral, his family was amazed to see a crowd of poor people who had come to say goodbye.

1. **What was Pier Giorgio's "secret"?**

2. **What does his motto *Verso l'alto* mean?**

3. **Can someone be joyful, athletic, and holy? Explain with his example.**

4. **Which trait of this saint would you like to imitate? How?**

Saints of the Americas Through the Centuries

Place each saint of the Americas on the timeline, using the names from the box.

Name: _____

Frances Xavier · Peter Claver · Isaac Jogues · Rose · Junípero Serra · Damien · John Neumann · Elizabeth Ann Seton · Juan Diego · Kateri

1531 — Saint _____ sees Our Lady of Guadalupe on the hill of Tepeyac, near Mexico City.

Early 1600s — Saint _____ of Lima, the first canonized saint of the Americas, serves the poor in Peru.

1600s — Saint _____ serves the enslaved Africans who arrive at the port of Cartagena.

1640s — Saint _____ and his Jesuit companions die as martyrs in North America.

Late 1600s — Saint _____ Tekakwitha, the "Lily of the Mohawks," is baptized and lives a life of prayer.

1700s — Saint _____ founds missions along the coast of California.

Early 1800s — Saint _____, the first saint born in the United States, founds the Sisters of Charity in Maryland.

1850s — Saint _____, Bishop of Philadelphia, opens many Catholic schools.

1870s — Saint _____ of Molokai cares for people with leprosy in Hawaii.

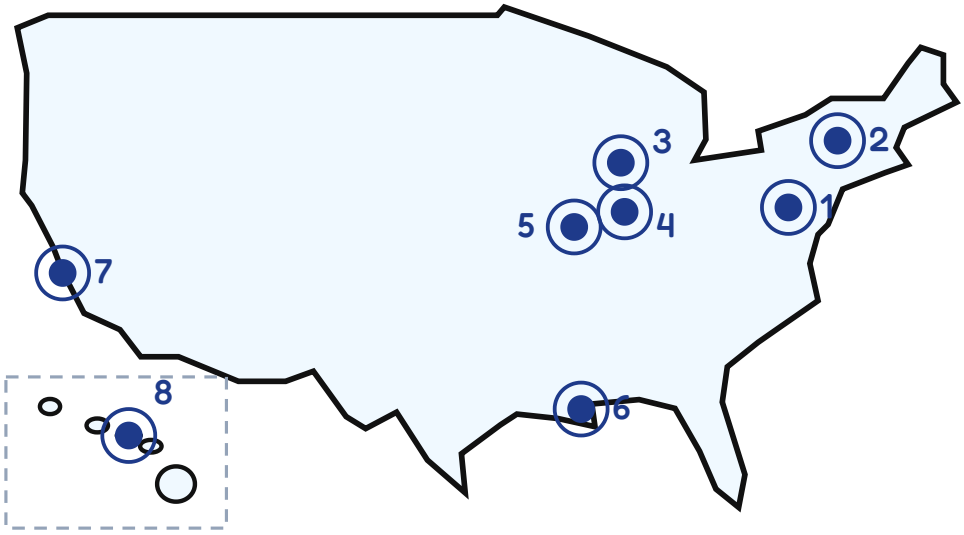
Late 1800s — Saint _____ Cabrini, patroness of immigrants, serves Italian immigrants in the United States.

Saints of the Americas: A Map of the United States

Each number on the map is a place linked to a saint. Complete the table with the saint's name (choose from the box) and explain the link in a few words.

Name: _____

St. Elizabeth Ann Seton · St. Kateri Tekakwitha · St. Frances Xavier Cabrini · St. Théodore Guérin · St. Rose Philippine Duchesne · St. Katharine Drexel · St. Junípero Serra · St. Damien of Molokai

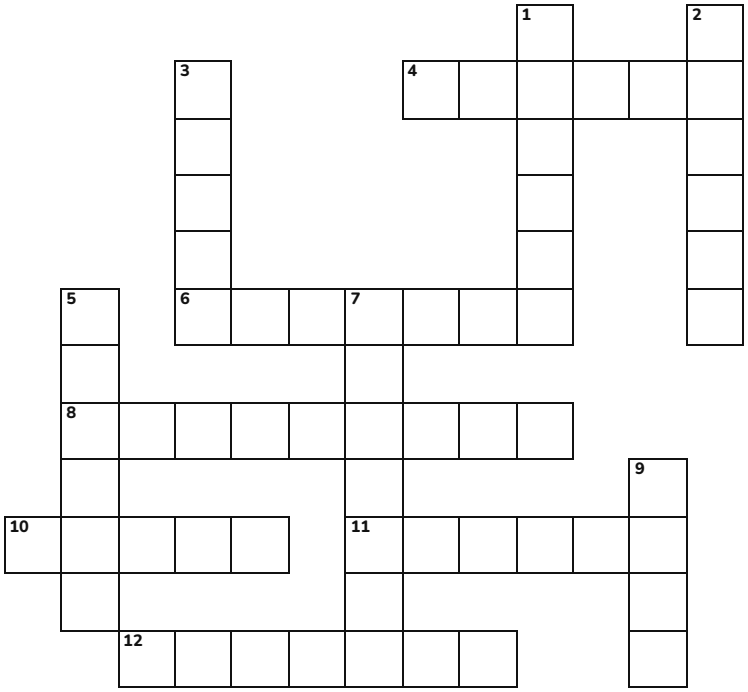


No.	Place	Saint	Why this place?
1	Emmitsburg, Maryland		
2	Auriesville, New York		
3	Chicago, Illinois		
4	Saint Mary-of-the-Woods, Indiana		
5	St. Charles, Missouri		
6	Louisiana		
7	Carmel, California		
8	Molokai, Hawaii		

Saints of the Americas

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

4. Peter ..., who served enslaved Africans in Cartagena. (6)

6. John ..., Bishop of Philadelphia, who opened many Catholic schools. (7)

8. Our Lady of ..., Patroness of the Americas. (9)

10. Junípero ..., who founded missions in California. (5)

11. The "Lily of the Mohawks." (6)

12. Mother ..., patroness of immigrants. (7)

Down ↓

1. He cared for people with leprosy in Hawaii. (6)

2. Katharine ..., who gave her fortune to open schools. (6)

3. Elizabeth Ann ..., the first saint born in the United States. (5)

5. Isaac ..., one of the North American Martyrs. (6)

7. The Hawaiian island where Saint Damien served. (7)

9. Saint Rose of ..., the first canonized saint of the Americas. (4)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

Who Am I? Saint Riddles

Read each riddle and check the right saint.

Name: _____

1. **I was a Roman soldier, and I cut my cloak in two for a poor man.**
   ☐ St. Louis ☐ St. Martin ☐ St. Paul
2. **I heard voices, and I freed the city of Orléans.**
   ☐ St. Geneviève ☐ St. Joan of Arc ☐ St. Clare
3. **I had trouble with Latin, but I became the patron saint of parish priests.**
   ☐ St. John Vianney ☐ St. Ignatius ☐ St. Augustine
4. **I saw "a Lady" in a grotto in 1858.**
   ☐ St. Thérèse ☐ St. Bernadette ☐ St. Catherine
5. **I was a teenager who loved computers and went to Mass every day.**
   ☐ St. Carlo Acutis ☐ St. Pier Giorgio Frassati ☐ St. John Paul II
6. **I persecuted Christians before meeting Jesus on the road to Damascus.**
   ☐ St. Peter ☐ St. Paul ☐ St. Joseph
7. **I was born in New York, became a widow with five children, and founded the Sisters of Charity.**
   ☐ St. Elizabeth Ann Seton ☐ St. Jane Frances de Chantal ☐ St. Clare
8. **I served the poorest of the poor in India.**
   ☐ St. Jane Frances de Chantal ☐ St. Teresa of Calcutta ☐ St. Margaret Mary
9. **Now make up your own riddle about a saint for your group.**

The Saints and Their Symbols

Draw a line from each saint to the object or symbol often shown with him or her.

Name: _____

St. Peter	the sword and the scroll
St. Paul	the birds and the wolf
St. Thérèse of Lisieux	the shared cloak
St. Martin	the lily and carpenter's tools
St. Clare	roses and the crucifix
St. Joseph	the monstrance
St. Francis of Assisi	the keys

1. **If you were shown with an object that expresses your faith, which one would you choose?**

Lourdes and the Apparitions of 1858

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



From February 11 to July 16, 1858, the Virgin Mary appeared eighteen times to Bernadette Soubirous, a poor 14-year-old girl, in the Grotto of Massabielle, on the bank of the river in Lourdes, France.

Mary asked for prayer and the conversion of sinners. She invited Bernadette to drink from a spring that flowed from the grotto, and she asked that people come in procession and that a chapel be built. On March 25, the feast of the Annunciation, the Lady revealed her name: "I am the Immaculate Conception." In 1862, the Bishop of Tarbes recognized that the apparitions were authentic.

- **Today:** Lourdes welcomes millions of pilgrims every year, especially people who are sick.
- **Healings:** the Church has officially recognized dozens of miraculous healings at Lourdes.
- **February 11:** feast of Our Lady of Lourdes and World Day of the Sick.

1. **How many times did Mary appear to Bernadette? Where?**

2. **What did the Virgin Mary ask for at Lourdes?**

3. **Why do you think so many sick people go on pilgrimage to Lourdes?**

4. **If you went to Lourdes, what intention would you entrust to Mary?**

The Martyrs, Witnesses to the End

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The word "martyr" comes from Greek and means "witness." A martyr is a Christian who would rather die than deny Christ. Martyrs do not look for death and do not take revenge: they bear witness to love until the end, often forgiving those who kill them, as Jesus did.

- **Saint Stephen:** the first martyr; he was stoned to death in Jerusalem while praying for those who killed him (see Acts 7).
- **The North American Martyrs:** Saint Isaac Jogues, Saint John de Brébeuf, and their companions, Jesuit missionaries killed in the 1640s in what is now New York State and Canada (feast day October 19 in the United States).
- **Saint Peter and Saint Paul:** martyrs in Rome in the first century.
- **Today:** Christians are still persecuted in many countries. In 2016, Father Jacques Hamel, a French priest, was killed while celebrating Mass.

An Often-Quoted Saying

"The blood of martyrs is the seed of Christians" (Tertullian, a Christian writer of the early 200s, quoted in CCC 852).

1. **What does the word "martyr" mean?**

2. **What do all martyrs have in common?**

3. **How can you be a "witness" to Christ in everyday life, without being a martyr?**

4. **Write a prayer for Christians who are persecuted today.**

Can You Become a Saint Today?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Sasha: "Saints lived way back in the old days. Today, with screens and everything, it's impossible." Louisa: "Carlo Acutis died in 2006, and he loved computers!"

To Help You

Pope Francis explains that to be holy, you do not need to be a bishop, a priest, or a religious sister or brother: we are all called to become saints by living with love and bearing witness to Christ in our everyday activities (see *Gaudete et Exsultate*, no. 14).

1. **Who do you agree with: Sasha or Louisa? Why?**

2. **What makes holiness hard today? What helps it?**

3. **What "small steps" toward holiness are possible for you at school?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

My Patron Saint Fact Sheet

Create a Quick Facts card for your patron saint, like the ones in this book. You can use your research from Part 1.

Name: _____

I draw his or her portrait with a symbol:

Name: _____ **Born:** _____

Died: _____ **Feast Day:** _____

Country: _____ **Symbols:** _____

Life in brief:

Something he or she said, or something said about him or her:

What he or she teaches me for my life as a confirmed Christian:

The Church, Body of Christ

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The Greek word for "Church," *ekklesia*, means "assembly of those who are called." The Church is not first of all a building: it is the People of God, all the baptized gathered together by Christ.

Saint Paul compares the Church to a body (see 1 Corinthians 12:12-27): there are many parts, each one has its place and its role, and Christ is the head. If one part suffers, all the parts suffer with it; if one part is honored, all share its joy.

- **The Body of Christ:** United to Christ by Baptism, we form one body.
- **The People of God:** God gathers men and women from every country and every culture.
- **The Temple of the Holy Spirit:** The Holy Spirit lives in the Church and gives it life, the way the soul gives life to the body.

1. **What does the word "Church" mean?**

2. **Why does Saint Paul compare the Church to a body?**

3. **Which "part" of the body are you? What talent can you use to serve others?**

4. **Why do we need one another in the Church?**

The Church: One, Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

In the Creed, we profess our faith in the Church, which is one, holy, catholic, and apostolic. These are the four "marks" of the Church. Write the right mark on each card.

Holy · Catholic · Apostolic · One

_____

One Lord, one faith, one Baptism; all united around the pope and the bishops.

_____

Christ founded it and makes it holy; it is made up of sinners called to become saints.

_____

Universal: sent to all the peoples of the earth, she proclaims the whole faith.

_____

Built on the Apostles; the bishops are their successors.

1. **Give an example that shows that the Church is "catholic," that is, universal.**

2. **Why can we say that you are connected to the Apostles?**

3. **What can you do for the unity of Christians?**

Two Thousand Years of Church History

Complete the great dates of Church history with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Lourdes · Milan · Monte Cassino · Baltimore · Nicaea · Vatican · Hope · Guadalupe · Trent · Nero · Pentecost

About 30 — _____ : the birth of the Church in Jerusalem.

64 — The first great persecution, under the emperor _____ .

313 — The Edict of _____ gives Christians freedom of worship.

325 — The Council of _____ declares that the Son is truly God.

About 529 — Saint Benedict founds the monastery of _____ in Italy.

1531 — Our Lady of _____ appears to Saint Juan Diego in Mexico.

1545–1563 — The Council of _____ responds to the Protestant Reformation.

1789 — The first diocese of the United States is created in _____ .

1858 — The Virgin Mary appears to Saint Bernadette at _____ .

1962–1965 — The Second _____ Council.

2025 — A Jubilee Year for the whole Church, with the theme "Pilgrims of _____ ."

The First Christians (Acts 2:42-47)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



After Pentecost, the first Christian community takes shape in Jerusalem. The Acts of the Apostles describes its life:

- **The teaching of the Apostles:** They listen to the Word of God and learn to know Jesus.
- **The communal life:** They love and support one another and share what they have.
- **The breaking of the bread:** This is one of the first names for the Mass, the Eucharist.
- **The prayers:** They pray together every day.

> **The Word of God**
> "They devoted themselves to the teaching of the apostles and to the communal life, to the breaking of the bread and to the prayers. … All who believed were together and had all things in common; they would sell their property and possessions and divide them among all according to each one's need."
>
> Acts 2:42, 44-45

1. **What are the four pillars of the life of the first Christians?**

2. **Which of these pillars is the most present in your life? Which one is the least present?**

3. **What could your parish or your group do to be more like the first community?**

The Persecutions and the Catacombs

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



For almost three centuries, being a Christian in the Roman Empire could cost you your life. Christians refused to worship the emperor and the Roman gods. In the year 64, the emperor Nero accused them of setting Rome on fire: many were put to death, among them, according to tradition, Saint Peter and Saint Paul. Other persecutions followed, until the early 4th century.

In Rome, Christians buried their dead in the catacombs, long tunnels dug underground. Sometimes they gathered there to pray near the tombs of the martyrs. Their drawings and symbols can still be seen today.

- **The fish:** In Greek, "fish" is *ichthys*; its letters are the first letters of "Jesus Christ, Son of God, Savior."
- **The Good Shepherd:** Jesus carrying a sheep on his shoulders.
- **The anchor:** A sign of firm hope in God.

1. **Why were Christians persecuted in the Roman Empire?**

2. **What are the catacombs?**

3. **Explain the symbol of the fish.**

4. **Draw or describe a symbol that could stand for your faith today.**

Constantine and the Edict of Milan (313)

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

In 312, before a decisive battle at the Milvian Bridge, near Rome, the emperor Constantine is said to have seen the sign of Christ in the sky. After his victory, he looked kindly on the Christians.

In 313, with the emperor Licinius, he issued the Edict of Milan: everyone was free to practice the religion of their choice. The persecutions stopped, and Christians could build churches openly. Constantine had great basilicas built, especially over the tomb of Saint Peter in Rome. In 321, he made Sunday a day of rest. He was baptized only at the end of his life.

- **The Chi-Rho:** A symbol made of the first two Greek letters of the name of Christ, often carved in churches.
- **A new era:** After the persecutions, the Church could organize freely and proclaim the Gospel everywhere in the Empire.

1. **What did the Edict of Milan change for Christians?**

2. **Why is Sunday important for Christians?**

3. **Is there religious freedom everywhere in the world today? What do you think?**

The Gospel Comes to the Americas

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



In the 1500s, missionaries sailed with the explorers to the Americas. Priests and religious brothers learned the native languages, taught the faith, and baptized many people. In 1531, on the hill of Tepeyac, near Mexico City, Our Lady appeared to Juan Diego, a humble Indigenous man. Her image on his cloak is honored today in the Basilica of Our Lady of Guadalupe.

Spanish missionaries also brought the faith to Florida and the Southwest. In the 1700s, Saint Junípero Serra founded missions along the coast of California. In 1789, Baltimore became the first diocese of the United States, with John Carroll as its first bishop.

- **Our Lady of Guadalupe:** Patroness of the Americas; her feast day is December 12.
- **St. Juan Diego:** The humble witness of Guadalupe; he was canonized in 2002, and his feast day is December 9.
- **The Church in the United States:** It is made up of Catholics from every continent, who brought their faith, their saints, and their customs.

1. **Who brought the Gospel to the Americas?**

2. **What happened on the hill of Tepeyac in 1531?**

3. **Who founded the missions of California? Which was the first diocese of the United States?**

4. **Who handed on the faith to your family? Ask an adult to tell you your family's story.**

Monks and Monasteries

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



From the first centuries, some Christians left everything to live only for God, in prayer and work: they became the first monks. Around 529, Saint Benedict founded the monastery of Monte Cassino, in Italy, and wrote a Rule that still guides thousands of monks today. His motto: "Pray and work."

In the Middle Ages, monasteries spread all over Europe: Cluny (910), Cîteaux (1098), Clairvaux (1115)... The monks prayed several times a day, welcomed pilgrims and the poor, farmed the land, and copied ancient books by hand. Without them, many texts from ancient times would have been lost.

- **The hours of prayer:** Morning Prayer, Evening Prayer, Night Prayer before going to sleep...
- **Hospitality:** The Rule of Saint Benedict asks the monks to welcome every guest as Christ himself.
- **Today:** There are still many monasteries, in the United States too; you can go there on a retreat.

1. **What is Saint Benedict's motto? What does it mean?**

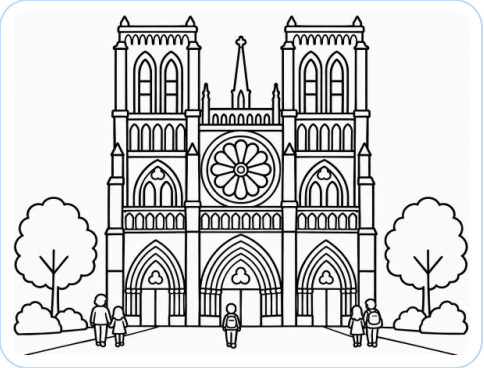
2. **What did the monks bring to society in the Middle Ages?**

3. **What do you think of their life? What attracts you or surprises you?**

The Cathedrals of the Middle Ages

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



From the 12th century on, the cities of Europe built huge Gothic cathedrals: Chartres, Notre-Dame de Paris, Cologne... Building them sometimes took more than a century. Generations of workers, stonecutters, and glassmakers labored on them for the glory of God.

A cathedral is the church where the bishop's chair (in Greek, *cathedra*) is found. Its vaults reaching toward the sky and its stained-glass windows full of light are meant to lift our hearts to God.

- **The "Bible of the poor":** The stained-glass windows and the sculptures told the sacred story to those who could not read.
- **The cross-shaped plan:** Many churches are shaped like a cross, and the sanctuary often faces east, where the sun rises, a sign of the risen Christ.
- **In the United States:** Many cathedrals were built in the Gothic style, like St. Patrick's Cathedral in New York.

1. **What is a cathedral? Where does the word come from?**

2. **Why were stained-glass windows called the "Bible of the poor"?**

3. **What is the cathedral of your diocese? Have you ever visited it?**

The Council of Trent

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

In the 16th century, the Church went through a serious crisis. There were abuses: some priests and bishops lived badly, and indulgences were sold. In 1517, the German monk Martin Luther protested and wanted to reform the Church. A separation followed: this was the beginning of the Protestant churches.

To respond to this crisis, the pope called a council in the city of Trent, in Italy. With some interruptions, it lasted from 1545 to 1563. It explained the Catholic faith clearly (the seven sacraments, the Real Presence of Christ in the Eucharist, the role of Tradition and Scripture) and began a great reform of the Church.

- **Seminaries:** The council asked for seminaries to be founded to train future priests better.
- **The catechism:** A catechism was published to teach the faith.
- **Saints of the reform:** Saint Ignatius of Loyola, Saint Charles Borromeo, Saint Teresa of Ávila, and Saint Francis de Sales renewed the Church from within.

1. **Why was the Council of Trent called?**

2. **Name two important decisions of this council.**

3. **Today, Catholics and Protestants sometimes pray together for unity. What do you think about that?**

The Second Vatican Council

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____

In 1959, Pope Saint John XXIII surprised the world by announcing a council. He wanted to "open the windows" of the Church to proclaim the Gospel better to the modern world. The Second Vatican Council opened on October 11, 1962, and ended in 1965, under Pope Saint Paul VI. More than 2,000 bishops from all over the world took part.

The council reminded everyone that all the baptized are called to holiness and to mission, not only priests and religious. It allowed Mass to be celebrated in the language of each country, encouraged reading the Bible, and promoted dialogue with other Christians and other religions.

- **Four great documents:** On the liturgy, on the Church, on the Word of God, and on the Church in the modern world.
- **For you:** If you go to Mass in English and laypeople read the Word of God at Mass, it is thanks to Vatican II.

1. **Which pope opened the Second Vatican Council? Which one closed it?**

2. **What did the council change for the Mass?**

3. **"All the baptized are called to holiness and to mission." What does that mean for you?**

4. **What does "open the windows of the Church" mean?**

Pope, Bishops, Priests, Deacons, and Laypeople

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

In the Church, each person has a different mission at the service of all. Write the title of each mission.

The priests · The pope · The deacons · The laypeople · The bishops

_____

Bishop of Rome and successor of Saint Peter, he is the shepherd of the whole Church and the guardian of its unity.

↓

_____

Successors of the Apostles, each one leads a diocese, teaches the faith, and celebrates the sacraments.

↓

_____

Co-workers of the bishops, they celebrate Mass, give God's forgiveness, and take care of parishes.

↓

_____

Ordained for the service of the Word, the liturgy, and charity.

↓

_____

All the baptized: they bear witness to Christ in their family, their work, and society.

↓

Religious men and women

They give their whole life to God in poverty, chastity, and obedience.

1. **Which group do you belong to? What is your mission?**

The Pope and the Vatican

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



The pope is the Bishop of Rome, the successor of Saint Peter, to whom Jesus said: "...you are Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church" (Matthew 16:18). He is the visible sign of the unity of all the Catholics in the world.

The pope lives in Vatican City, the smallest country in the world, which is located in the heart of Rome. There you find St. Peter's Basilica, built over the Apostle's tomb, and St. Peter's Square, where pilgrims come to listen to the pope. Pope Leo XIV, born in Chicago and the first pope from the United States, was elected on May 8, 2025, after the death of Pope Francis.

- **The conclave:** When a pope dies, the cardinals gather in the Sistine Chapel to elect his successor. White smoke announces the election.
- **The Swiss Guard:** It has protected the pope since 1506.
- **Catholics in the world:** About 1.4 billion, on every continent.

1. **Why is the pope the successor of Saint Peter?**

2. **What is the name of the pope today? Find out about one of his messages to young people.**

3. **Write a prayer for the pope.**

My Parish and My Diocese

Find out from your parish, its website, or an adult, and fill in the cards.

Name: _____

A parish is a community of Christians in one area, entrusted to a pastor. Many parishes together form a diocese, entrusted to a bishop.

The name of my parish

_____

My church and its patron

_____

The name of my pastor

_____

Sunday Mass times

_____

My diocese

_____

My bishop

_____

The cathedral of my diocese

_____

The Director of Religious Education or a group in my parish

_____

1. **What do you like about your parish? What would you like to see there?**

The Floor Plan of a Church

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Write the name of each part of the church from its description. Then find them in your own church.

The ambo · The sacristy · The baptismal font · The stained-glass windows · The confessional · The bell tower · The holy water font · The narthex · The altar · The sanctuary · The tabernacle · The nave

_____ The entrance area, just inside the doors.	_____ You dip your fingers in it to make the Sign of the Cross.	_____ The large part where the people sit in the pews.
_____ The area around the altar.	_____ The table of the Eucharistic sacrifice.	_____ The place of the Word of God.
_____ It keeps the presence of Christ.	_____ Baptism is celebrated there.	_____ There you receive God's forgiveness.
_____ Its bells call people to prayer.	_____ There the Mass is prepared.	_____ They tell the sacred story.

1. **On the back of the page, draw the floor plan of your church with these places.**

The Liturgical Year and Its Colors

Complete the diagram with the words from the box.

Name: _____

Over the year, the Church remembers the whole life of Christ. The priest wears vestments of different colors for the seasons and the feasts. Write the color for each season or feast.

red · violet · white · red · violet · white · white · green

Advent

_____

Christmas Time

_____

Ordinary Time

_____

Lent

_____

Palm Sunday and Good Friday

_____

Easter Time

_____

Pentecost and the feasts of martyrs

_____

The feasts of the Virgin Mary and of saints who were not martyrs

_____

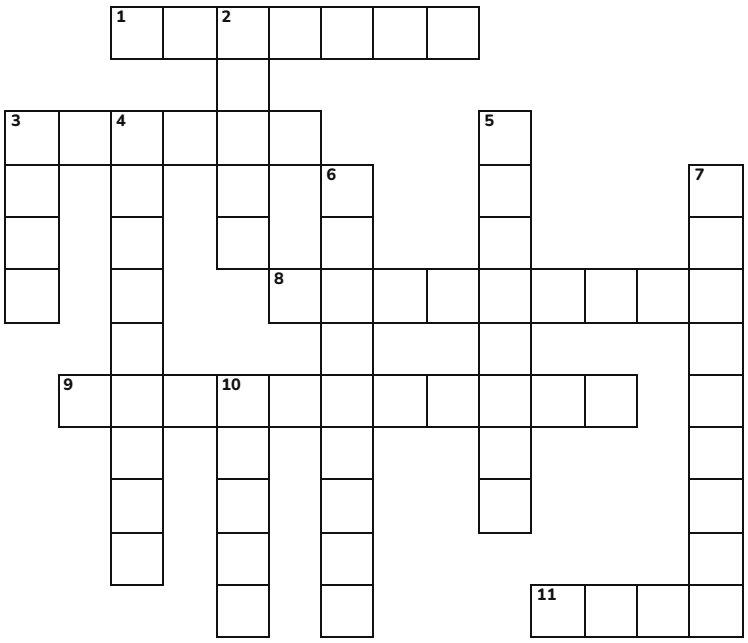
1. **What do you think each of these colors means: violet, white, green, red? (On two Sundays, rose may also be worn.)**

2. **What color will the bishop wear on the day of your Confirmation? Why?**

Church History

Fill in the grid using the clues.

Name: _____



Across →

1. The smallest country in the world, where the pope lives. (7)

3. The council of 325. (6)

8. The church where the bishop's chair is found. (9)

9. The emperor of the Edict of Milan. (11)

11. The successor of Saint Peter. (4)

Down ↓

2. The council that responded to the Protestant Reformation. (5)

3. The emperor who persecuted the Christians in 64. (4)

4. The underground tunnels of the first Christians in Rome. (9)

5. He wrote the Rule for monks at Monte Cassino. (8)

6. Our Lady of … appeared to Saint Juan Diego in 1531. (9)

7. The first diocese of the United States (1789). (9)

10. Saint Junípero …, founder of missions in California. (5)

Tip: write the words in capital letters. The number in parentheses is the number of letters.

The Church History Quiz

Check the right answer for each question.

Name: _____

1. **On what day was the Church born?**
   ☐ at Christmas ☐ at Pentecost ☐ on All Saints' Day
2. **What did the fish (ichthys) mean for the first Christians?**
   ☐ Jesus Christ, Son of God, Savior ☐ the miraculous catch of fish ☐ the Friday meal
3. **Who gave Christians freedom of worship in 313?**
   ☐ Nero ☐ Constantine ☐ Charlemagne
4. **To whom did Our Lady of Guadalupe appear in 1531?**
   ☐ St. Bernadette ☐ St. Juan Diego ☐ St. Martin
5. **What is Saint Benedict's motto?**
   ☐ "Pray and work" ☐ "Go and repair my house" ☐ "To the heights"
6. **Who called the Second Vatican Council?**
   ☐ St. John XXIII ☐ St. John Paul II ☐ Pope Francis
7. **Where does the pope live?**
   ☐ in Jerusalem ☐ in Vatican City ☐ in Avignon
8. **Why do cathedrals have stained-glass windows?**
   ☐ only to look nice ☐ to tell the sacred story in pictures ☐ to hide the walls
9. **Which period of Church history would you like to know better? Why?**

Key Dates in Church History

Number these events from the oldest (1) to the most recent (10).

Name: _____

- [ ] St. Benedict founds Monte Cassino
- [ ] The apparitions at Lourdes
- [ ] Our Lady of Guadalupe appears to St. Juan Diego
- [ ] The Edict of Milan
- [ ] Baltimore becomes the first US diocese
- [ ] The Council of Trent
- [ ] Nero's persecution
- [ ] Pentecost in Jerusalem
- [ ] The Second Vatican Council
- [ ] The Council of Nicaea

1. **Which event seems the most important to you? Why?**

Missionaries Bring the Gospel to the World

Read the page, then answer the questions.

Name: _____



Before going up to heaven, Jesus sent his disciples: "Go, therefore, and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the holy Spirit" (Matthew 28:19). Ever since, missionaries have set out to proclaim the Gospel all over the world.

- **St. Paul:** He traveled across the Roman Empire in the 1st century.
- **St. Francis Xavier:** A Jesuit and a companion of Saint Ignatius, he proclaimed Christ in India and Japan in the 16th century; he is patron of the missions, with Saint Thérèse of Lisieux.
- **Missionaries to North America:** Saints Isaac Jogues and his companions in the 1600s, Saint Junípero Serra in California in the 1700s, and Saint Frances Xavier Cabrini, who served immigrants in the United States.
- **Blessed Pauline Jaricot:** A young woman from Lyon, France, who in 1822 founded the Society for the Propagation of the Faith to support the missions through prayer and gifts; she was beatified in 2022.
- **And you?** Mission begins where you live: at school, at home, with your friends.

1. **What command does Jesus give his disciples before going up to heaven?**

2. **How did Pauline Jaricot help the missions without going far away?**

3. **How can you be a missionary where you live?**

What Is the Church for Today?

Think it over on your own, then discuss in a group. Listen to others with respect.

Name: _____

Ava: "I believe in God, but I don't need the Church." Jack: "Without the Church, I would never have known Jesus or received the sacraments."

To Help You

The Church hands on the Word of God, celebrates the sacraments, gathers believers together, and serves the poorest (schools, hospitals, charities, Catholic Charities...). She is made up of men and women who are sinners, but Christ promised to stay with her until the end of the world.

1. **Can you believe in God without the Church? Explain.**

2. **What has the Church given you personally?**

3. **What would you say to someone who criticizes the Church because of the faults of some of its members?**

Arguments For	Arguments Against

My conclusion:

My Place in the Church

Look back on this part about the Church and its history.

Name: _____

What I discovered about the history of the Church:

The person or event that struck me the most:

What the Church gives me:

What I can give the Church (my talents, my time, my prayer):

My concrete commitment after my Confirmation:

My prayer for the Church:

My Spiritual Journal: How It Works

These pages are yours. They help you pray, look back on your life with God, and keep a record of your journey.

Name: _____



A spiritual journal is not homework: no one grades it. You can write, draw, glue in pictures, or copy sentences from the Bible. Choose a calm moment (in the evening, on Sunday) and a quiet place, and always begin with the Sign of the Cross and a short prayer to the Holy Spirit.

You don't have to fill in everything at once. Come back to these pages during your preparation and after your Confirmation.

Journal of: _____ **Started on:** _____

Why I am starting this journal:

_____

_____

_____

My cover page: I draw or write what stands for my faith today.

My Morning and Bedtime Prayer

To pray is to talk to God and to listen to him. Prepare your morning and bedtime prayers.

Name: _____

In the morning, I place my day in God's hands. At bedtime, I thank him, I ask his forgiveness, and I entrust to him the people I love. You can use the Our Father and the Hail Mary, and add your own words.

My morning prayer (in my own words):

My bedtime prayer (thank you, I'm sorry, please):

When and where I pray:

This week, I prayed on:

- ☐ Monday
- ☐ Tuesday
- ☐ Wednesday
- ☐ Thursday
- ☐ Friday
- ☐ Saturday
- ☐ Sunday

I Meditate on a Gospel Passage

Follow the four steps of *lectio divina*, the "prayerful reading" of the Bible that monks have practiced for centuries.

Name: _____

Ideas for passages: the call of the disciples (Matthew 4:18-22), the calming of the storm (Mark 4:35-41), Zacchaeus (Luke 19:1-10), the Samaritan woman (John 4:5-42), the disciples on the road to Emmaus (Luke 24:13-35).

Passage I chose: _____ **Date:** _____

1. I read slowly: what is this text about? Who are the characters?

2. I meditate: which word or sentence touches me? What is God telling me?

3. I pray: I answer God in my own words.

4. I contemplate: I stay in silence with God for a few moments. What I felt:

Today I Say Thank You to God

Saying thank you makes the heart joyful. Write each day what you thank God for.

Name: _____

"Eucharist" means "thanksgiving," that is, "thank you." Gratitude is at the heart of the Christian life.

Thank you for... (1): _____ **Thank you for... (2):** _____

Thank you for... (3): _____ **Thank you for... (4):** _____

Thank you for... (5): _____ **Thank you for... (6):** _____

Thank you for... (7): _____ **Thank you for... (8):** _____

Thank you for... (9): _____ **Thank you for... (10):** _____

A person I want to thank, and how I will do it:

My prayer of praise:

My Questions About the Faith

Having questions is normal: it is even the sign of a growing faith. Write down your questions and look for answers.

Name: _____

My questions	The answers I found (and where)

The person I will take my questions to (catechist, priest, sponsor…):

_____

A question I entrust to God in prayer:

The Moments When I Felt God Close

God makes himself present in our lives, often quietly. Write down the moments when you felt his presence.

Name: _____

During Mass or a sacrament:

In nature:

Through a person:

In a hard time:

In prayer or in silence:

I draw one of these moments:

I Look Back on My Week With God

Each evening, take five minutes to look back on your day with God: what was beautiful, what was hard, and what you want to tell him.

Name: _____

Monday: _____ **Tuesday:** _____

Wednesday: _____ **Thursday:** _____

Friday: _____ **Saturday:** _____

Sunday: _____ **Week of:** _____

The best moment of my week:

The hardest moment:

Where did I see God at work?

What I want to ask forgiveness for:

What I entrust to God for next week:

My Prayer Intentions

Write down the people and situations you want to entrust to God. Check them off when your prayer has been answered, in one way or another.

Name: _____

For whom?	For what?

The intentions of the Church and of the world (the pope, the sick, peace...):

What I noticed: how God answered my prayers:

My Favorite Passage From the Word of God

Choose a Bible passage that speaks to you in a special way and keep it in your heart.

Name: _____

Book: _____ **Chapter and verses:** _____

I copy the passage:

Why this passage touches me:

What it invites me to live:

I illustrate this passage:

My Forgiveness Notebook

Forgiveness sets us free. This page is for you alone: it helps you prepare for Confession or for making peace with someone.

Name: _____

What I regret doing or saying:

Whom I want to ask for forgiveness:

Whom I want to forgive, even if it is hard:

What helps me to forgive:

The date of my next Confession:

After being forgiven, what I felt:

My prayer: "Lord, teach me to forgive as you do..."

My Resolutions for After Confirmation

Confirmation is not an ending; it is a sending. Make concrete resolutions to keep living as a witness to Christ.

Name: _____

I commit to:

- ☐ going to Mass on Sunday
- ☐ reading the Gospel
- ☐ joining a youth group
- ☐ helping the poorest
- ☐ praying every day
- ☐ going to Confession regularly
- ☐ serving in my parish
- ☐ talking about my faith without shame

My main resolution:

_____

_____

What could keep me from keeping it:

_____

_____

Who will help me (sponsor, friends…):

_____

_____

The gift of the Holy Spirit I ask for to succeed:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

My Prayer to the Holy Spirit

Before your Confirmation, write your own prayer to the Holy Spirit. You can say it on the day of the celebration.

Name: _____

Prayer to the Holy Spirit

Come, Holy Spirit, fill the hearts of your faithful
and kindle in them the fire of your love.
Send forth your Spirit and they shall be created,
and you shall renew the face of the earth.

Come, Holy Spirit (USCCB)

My prayer to the Holy Spirit (I thank him, I ask for his gifts, I entrust my life to him):

I decorate my prayer (dove, flames, the seven gifts...):

I Look Back on My Road to Confirmation

Your preparation is coming to an end. Look back on the road you have traveled with the Holy Spirit.

Name: _____

What I discovered about God during my preparation:

What I discovered about myself:

The activity or moment that struck me the most:

The people who walked with me and whom I want to thank:

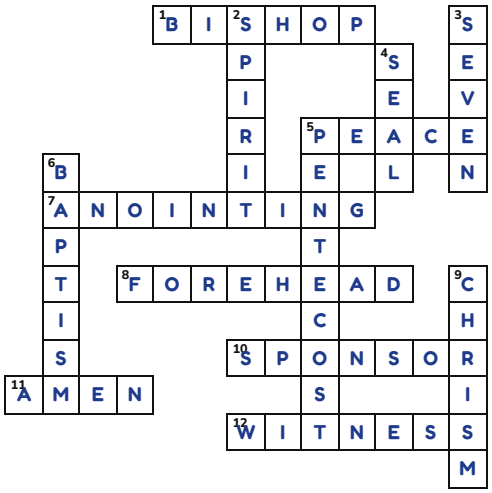
What I ask God for the rest of my life:

My "yes" to God, in my own words:

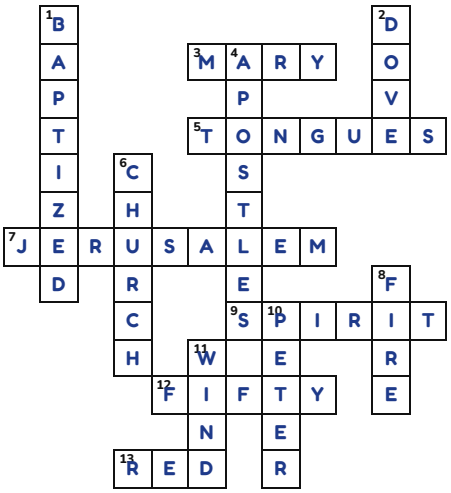
Answer Key

Answers to the games, quizzes, and fill-in-the-blank activities, in the order of the book.

Activity 5 · Confirmation Vocabulary page 9



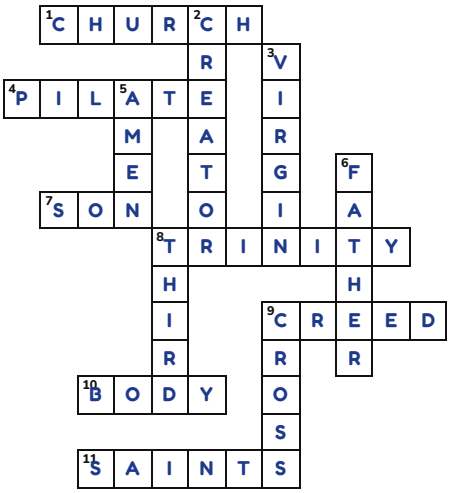
Activity 25 · Pentecost page 29



Activity 41 · The Fruits of the Spirit page 45

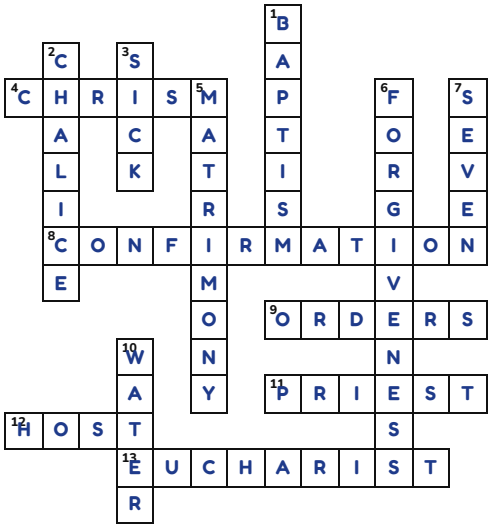
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Activity 62 · The Words of the Creed page 66

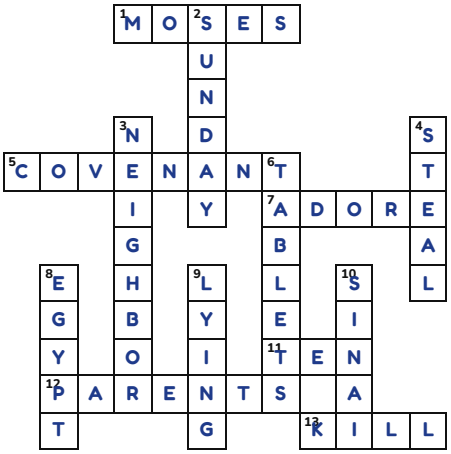


Answer Key

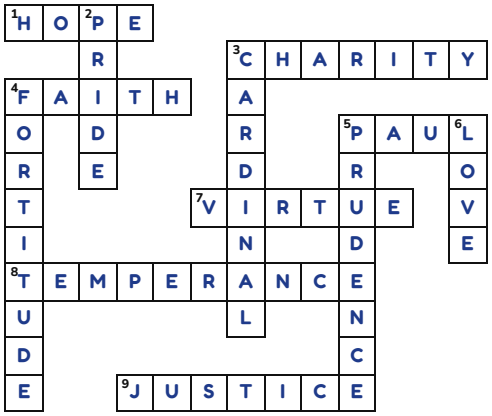
Activity 83 · The Sacraments page 87



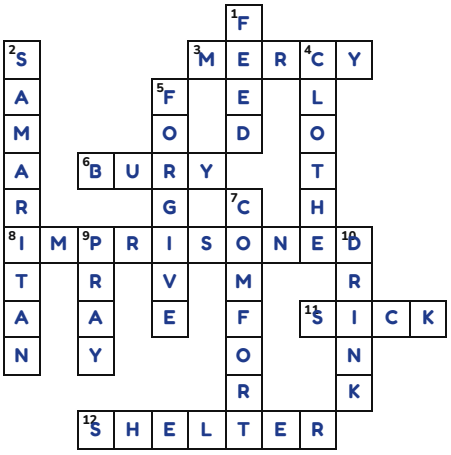
Activity 109 · The Ten Commandments page 113



Activity 142 · The Virtues page 146

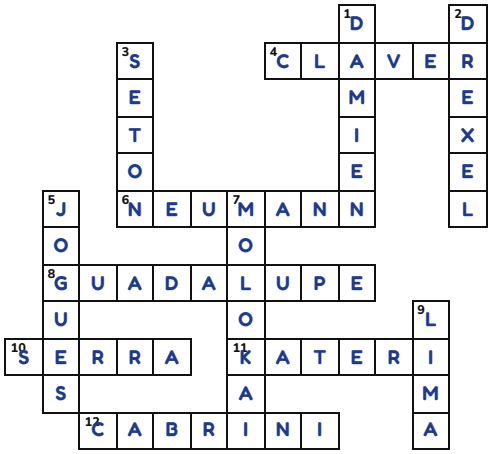


Activity 154 · The Works of Mercy page 158

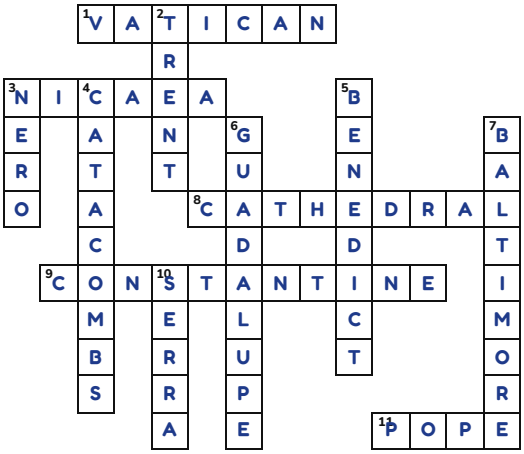


Answer Key

Activity 192 · Saints of the Americas page 196



Activity 215 · Church History page 219



Activity 2 · What Is Confirmation? page 6

1. a sacrament · 2. three · 3. Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist · 4. the bishop · 5. sacred chrism · 6. only once · 7. Baptism · 8. the Holy Spirit

Activity 3 · The Rite of Confirmation page 7

The presentation of the candidates · The renewal of baptismal promises · The laying on of hands · The anointing with chrism · The Prayer of the Faithful

Activity 8 · What Makes a Good Sponsor page 12

1. 16 years old · 2. a confirmed Catholic who has received the Eucharist · 3. no · 4. one of your godparents from Baptism · 5. to help you live as a witness to Christ · 6. places a hand on your shoulder · 7. keeps praying for you and encouraging you

Activity 14 · True or False About Confirmation page 18

1. False (you receive it only once: it marks the soul forever) · 2. True · 3. True · 4. False (parents cannot be sponsors) · 5. True · 6. False (you can be confirmed once you reach the age of reason; in the United States the age depends on the diocese) · 7. True · 8. False (Confirmation leads to the Eucharist, the heart of Christian life) · 9. True

Activity 15 · The Signs of Confirmation and What They Mean page 19

The laying on of hands → The Holy Spirit comes down upon you · Sacred chrism → The oil that strengthens and spreads the fragrance of Christ · The cross traced on the forehead → You are sealed as belonging to Christ · Being called by name → God calls you personally · The sign of peace → You are in communion with the bishop and the whole Church · The color red → The fire of the Spirit, as at Pentecost

Activity 23 · The Story of Pentecost (Acts 2:1-13) page 27

1. all in one place together · 2. a noise like a strong driving wind · 3. tongues as of fire · 4. speak in different tongues · 5. hear them speaking in their own language · 6. That they have had too much new wine

Activity 24 · From Easter to Pentecost: The Fifty Days page 28

Day 1: risen · The days that follow: appears · Day 40: Ascension · Days 40 to 50: pray · Day 50: Pentecost · The same day: baptized · Today: red

Answer Key

Activity 27 · The Wheel of the 7 Gifts of the Holy Spirit page 31

Wisdom · Understanding · Counsel · Fortitude · Knowledge · Piety · Fear of the Lord

Activity 35 · Each Gift in a Real-Life Situation page 39

I refuse to join the group making fun of a classmate. → fortitude · I look at the ocean and thank God. → knowledge · I don't know which activity to choose, so I ask God for advice. → counsel · A Gospel sentence speaks to me personally. → understanding · I talk to God with the trust of a child. → piety · I understand that love matters more than money. → wisdom · I am silent with respect before the tabernacle. → fear of the Lord

Activity 37 · The Big Quiz on the 7 Gifts page 41

1. seven · 2. Isaiah · 3. wonder and respect before God · 4. counsel · 5. piety · 6. understand the Word of God · 7. fortitude · 8. at Baptism, and they are strengthened at Confirmation

Activity 39 · The Tree of the Fruits of the Spirit page 43

Charity · Joy · Peace · Patience · Kindness · Goodness · Generosity · Gentleness · Faithfulness · Modesty · Self-control · Chastity

Activity 44 · The Holy Spirit in the Bible page 48

1. True · 2. False (in the form of a dove) · 3. True · 4. False (he promised to send him to his disciples) · 5. True · 6. True · 7. False (he is God, with the Father and the Son) · 8. True · 9. False (they proclaimed Jesus with courage)

Activity 48 · The Apostles' Creed and the Nicene Creed page 52

Origin: baptismal creed of the Church of Rome · Origin: Councils of Nicaea (325) and Constantinople (381) · Length: longer and more detailed · First words: "I believe in one God" · About the Son: "begotten, not made, consubstantial with the Father" · About the Spirit: "the Lord, the giver of life" · About the Church: "the holy catholic Church"

Activity 49 · The Apostles' Creed page 53

Father · Creator · Son · Virgin · Pilate · crucified · third · heaven · living · Holy Spirit · Church · saints · sins · body · everlasting

Activity 53 · The Holy Trinity page 57

The Father · The Son · The Holy Spirit

Activity 55 · The Life of Jesus page 59

The Annunciation: Mary · The Nativity: Bethlehem · Childhood: Nazareth · The baptism: Jordan · Public life: Apostles · The Last Supper: Eucharist · The Passion: cross · Easter: risen · The Ascension: heaven · Pentecost: Spirit

Activity 63 · The Articles of the Creed page 67

1. I believe in God, the Father almighty, Creator of heaven and earth, → 2. and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, → 3. who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the Virgin Mary, → 4. suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died and was buried; → 5. he descended into hell; on the third day he rose again from the dead; → 6. he ascended into heaven, and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty; → 7. from there he will come to judge the living and the dead. → 8. I believe in the Holy Spirit, → 9. the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, → 10. the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and life everlasting. Amen.

Activity 64 · The Creed Quiz page 68

1. I believe · 2. three · 3. Pontius Pilate · 4. the third day · 5. universal · 6. God takes away our sins · 7. two councils · 8. Amen

Answer Key

Activity 69 · The 7 Sacraments in Three Families page 73

The sacraments of Christian initiation: they bring us into the Christian life: Baptism, Confirmation, Eucharist · The sacraments of healing: they care for the soul and the body: Reconciliation, Anointing of the Sick · The sacraments at the service of communion: they commit us to serving others: Holy Orders, Matrimony

Activity 72 · The Signs of Baptism page 76

The water · The Sign of the Cross · The sacred chrism · The white garment · The lighted candle · The Our Father

Activity 74 · The Main Parts of the Mass page 78

The Introductory Rites · The Liturgy of the Word · The Liturgy of the Eucharist · The Concluding Rites

Activity 76 · Compare Baptism, Confirmation, and the Eucharist page 80

The sign: sacred chrism · The words: "This is my body" · Who celebrates?: the bishop · How many times?: only once · What it gives: food for the journey

Activity 82 · Each Sacrament and Its Sign page 86

Baptism → water · Confirmation → sacred chrism · Eucharist → bread and wine · Reconciliation → the words of forgiveness (absolution) · Anointing of the Sick → the oil of the sick · Matrimony → the exchange of consent · Holy Orders → the laying on of hands by the bishop

Activity 84 · The Sacraments Quiz page 88

1. seven · 2. Baptism · 3. thanksgiving · 4. the spouses · 5. Reconciliation and Anointing of the Sick · 6. no, never · 7. three · 8. in the tabernacle

Activity 85 · True or False About the Sacraments page 89

1. True · 2. False (you receive Baptism only once) · 3. True · 4. False (every priest can give it) · 5. False (it is also given to the seriously ill and to the elderly) · 6. True · 7. True · 8. True · 9. False (you must be baptized and prepared to receive Communion)

Activity 89 · The Objects Used at Mass page 93

The altar · The ambo · The chalice · The paten · The ciborium · The tabernacle · The sanctuary lamp · The Paschal candle

Activity 92 · From Egypt to the Promised Land page 96

Step 1: slaves · Step 2: Pharaoh · Step 3: burning · Step 4: Passover · Step 5: Red · Step 6: manna · Step 7: Sinai · Step 8: forty · Step 9: Promised

Activity 93 · The Two Tablets: Love God, Love Your Neighbor page 97

First tablet: love God: Commandments 1 to 3 · Second tablet: love your neighbor: Commandments 4 to 10

Activity 104 · The Commandments and Real-Life Situations page 108

I say "Oh my God!" for no reason, like a swear word. → 2nd Commandment · I copy a classmate's homework and pass it off as mine. → 7th Commandment · I sulk when my mom asks me to clean up. → 4th Commandment · I repeat a rumor about a girl in my class. → 8th Commandment · I'd rather sleep in than go to Mass. → 3rd Commandment · I'm jealous of my friend's new phone. → 10th Commandment · I spend all my free time on screens and forget God. → 1st Commandment

Activity 110 · The Commandments Quiz page 114

1. ten · 2. the Decalogue · 3. two tablets of stone · 4. the 3rd · 5. 8th Commandment · 6. two commandments of love · 7. 10th Commandment · 8. 5th Commandment

Answer Key

Activity 126 · The Beatitudes and Their Promises page 130

Blessed are the poor in spirit, → for theirs is the kingdom of heaven. · Blessed are they who mourn, → for they will be comforted. · Blessed are the meek, → for they will inherit the land. · Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness, → for they will be satisfied. · Blessed are the merciful, → for they will be shown mercy. · Blessed are the clean of heart, → for they will see God. · Blessed are the peacemakers, → for they will be called children of God.

Activity 127 · The Beatitudes page 131

poor · comforted · meek · righteousness · merciful · clean · peacemakers · persecuted

Activity 131 · Theological Virtues and Cardinal Virtues page 135

Faith · Hope · Charity · Prudence · Justice · Fortitude · Temperance

Activity 140 · The Virtues and Their Examples page 144

Faith → I trust God and I pray even when it is hard. · Hope → I don't lose heart: God is faithful. · Charity → I help my brother without expecting anything back. · Prudence → I think and ask for advice before deciding. · Justice → I share the candy equally. · Fortitude → I hold firm when someone pushes me to do wrong. · Temperance → I turn off the game console at the agreed time.

Activity 144 · The Virtues Quiz page 148

1. three · 2. faith, hope, charity · 3. four · 4. prudence · 5. love (charity) · 6. justice · 7. temperance · 8. a habit of doing good that grows with practice

Activity 148 · The Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25-37) page 152

1. who his neighbor is · 2. from Jerusalem to Jericho · 3. a priest and a Levite · 4. because Jews and Samaritans did not get along · 5. to an inn · 6. to go and act the same way

Activity 150 · The 7 Corporal Works of Mercy page 154

Feed the hungry · Give drink to the thirsty · Clothe the naked · Shelter the homeless · Visit the sick · Visit the imprisoned · Bury the dead

Activity 151 · The 7 Spiritual Works of Mercy page 155

Counsel the doubtful · Instruct the ignorant · Admonish the sinner · Comfort the sorrowful · Forgive injuries · Bear wrongs patiently · Pray for the living and the dead

Activity 152 · The Corporal Works in Everyday Life page 156

I share my snack with a classmate who has none. → Feed the hungry · I bring a bottle of water to a worker in the hot sun. → Give drink to the thirsty · I give a coat that no longer fits me to the parish clothing drive. → Clothe the naked · I help collect blankets for a homeless shelter. → Shelter the homeless · I call my grandmother, who is in the hospital. → Visit the sick · I write a card to a prisoner with my youth group. → Visit the imprisoned · I go to our neighbor's funeral with my parents. → Bury the dead

Activity 153 · The Spiritual Works in Everyday Life page 157

I help my friend choose between two options. → Counsel the doubtful · I explain fractions to my little sister. → Instruct the ignorant · I tell a friend that cheating is wrong. → Admonish the sinner · I stay with a friend who is crying. → Comfort the sorrowful · I don't hold a grudge after an argument. → Forgive injuries · I stay patient with my cousin who never stops talking. → Bear wrongs patiently · I pray for my grandfather, who has died. → Pray for the living and the dead

Answer Key

Activity 158 · The Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32) page 162

1. his share of the inheritance · 2. he spends all of it · 3. he takes care of pigs · 4. he runs to hug him · 5. he gets angry · 6. God is a Father who forgives and waits for us to come back

Activity 164 · The Road to Canonization page 168

Servant of God · Venerable · Blessed · Saint

Activity 190 · Saints of the Americas Through the Centuries page 194

1531: Juan Diego · Early 1600s: Rose · 1600s: Peter Claver · 1640s: Isaac Jogues · Late 1600s: Kateri · 1700s: Junípero Serra · Early 1800s: Elizabeth Ann Seton · 1850s: John Neumann · 1870s: Damien · Late 1800s: Frances Xavier

Activity 191 · Saints of the Americas: A Map of the United States page 195

1. Emmitsburg, Maryland: St. Elizabeth Ann Seton (she founded the Sisters of Charity there) · 2. Auriesville, New York: St. Kateri Tekakwitha (she was born there; St. Isaac Jogues was martyred there) · 3. Chicago, Illinois: St. Frances Xavier Cabrini (she died there) · 4. Saint Mary-of-the-Woods, Indiana: St. Théodore Guérin (in 1839 she came from France to lead a new community of the Sisters of Providence there) · 5. St. Charles, Missouri: St. Rose Philippine Duchesne (she opened the first school of her order in America there) · 6. Louisiana: St. Katharine Drexel (in 1925 she founded Xavier University of Louisiana) · 7. Carmel, California: St. Junípero Serra (he is buried at the mission there) · 8. Molokai, Hawaii: St. Damien of Molokai (or St. Marianne Cope: they cared for people with leprosy there)

Activity 193 · Who Am I? Saint Riddles page 197

1. St. Martin · 2. St. Joan of Arc · 3. St. John Vianney · 4. St. Bernadette · 5. St. Carlo Acutis · 6. St. Paul · 7. St. Elizabeth Ann Seton · 8. St. Teresa of Calcutta

Activity 194 · The Saints and Their Symbols page 198

St. Peter → the keys · St. Paul → the sword and the scroll · St. Thérèse of Lisieux → roses and the crucifix · St. Martin → the shared cloak · St. Clare → the monstrance · St. Joseph → the lily and carpenter's tools · St. Francis of Assisi → the birds and the wolf

Activity 200 · The Church: One, Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic page 204

One · Holy · Catholic · Apostolic

Activity 201 · Two Thousand Years of Church History page 205

About 30: Pentecost · 64: Nero · 313: Milan · 325: Nicaea · About 529: Monte Cassino · 1531: Guadalupe · 1545-1563: Trent · 1789: Baltimore · 1858: Lourdes · 1962-1965: Vatican · 2025: Hope

Activity 210 · Pope, Bishops, Priests, Deacons, and Laypeople page 214

The pope · The bishops · The priests · The deacons · The laypeople

Activity 213 · The Floor Plan of a Church page 217

The narthex · The holy water font · The nave · The sanctuary · The altar · The ambo · The tabernacle · The baptismal font · The confessional · The bell tower · The sacristy · The stained-glass windows

Activity 214 · The Liturgical Year and Its Colors page 218

Advent: violet · Christmas Time: white · Ordinary Time: green · Lent: violet · Palm Sunday and Good Friday: red · Easter Time: white · Pentecost and the feasts of martyrs: red · The feasts of the Virgin Mary and of saints who were not martyrs: white

Answer Key

Activity 216 · The Church History Quiz page 220

1. at Pentecost · 2. Jesus Christ, Son of God, Savior · 3. Constantine · 4. St. Juan Diego · 5. "Pray and work" · 6. St. John XXIII · 7. in Vatican City · 8. to tell the sacred story in pictures

Activity 217 · Key Dates in Church History page 221

1. Pentecost in Jerusalem → 2. Nero's persecution → 3. The Edict of Milan → 4. The Council of Nicaea → 5. St. Benedict founds Monte Cassino → 6. Our Lady of Guadalupe appears to St. Juan Diego → 7. The Council of Trent → 8. Baltimore becomes the first US diocese → 9. The apparitions at Lourdes → 10. The Second Vatican Council